

2026

Michigan Fishing Regulations

Rules apply from April 1, 2026 – March 31, 2027



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2026
MICHIGAN
FISHING REGULATIONS

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The Michigan Department of Natural Resources is committed to the conservation, protection, management, use and enjoyment of the state's natural and cultural resources for current and future generations.

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The Michigan Natural Resources Commission (NRC) is a seven-member public body whose members are appointed by the Governor and subject to the advice and consent of the Senate. The NRC oversees the management of fish and wildlife in the State of Michigan. The commission conducts monthly, public meetings in locations throughout Michigan. Citizens are encouraged to become actively involved in these public forums. For more information visit Michigan.gov/NRC.

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Have a photo you think would look great on the cover of the next Michigan Fishing Regulations?

We're seeking photos that focus on places to fish, instead of people or fish species. Photos should be portrait orientation. If you've got one, email it to: DNR-Fisheries@Michigan.gov.

A complete listing of regulations and legal descriptions are available at Michigan.gov/DNR.

The State of Michigan allows appropriate advertising in its annual regulations to help offset costs of printing. Many states have adopted a similar strategy. Promotional advertising does not constitute endorsement by the Michigan Department of Natural Resources.

The Michigan Department of Natural Resources provides equal opportunities for employment and access to Michigan's natural resources. Both state and federal laws prohibit discrimination on the basis of race, color, national origin, religion, disability, age, sex, height, weight or marital status under the Civil Rights Acts of 1964 as amended (MI PA 453 and MI PA 220, Title V of the Rehabilitation Act of 1973 as amended, and the Americans with Disabilities Act). If you believe that you have been discriminated against in any program, activity, or facility, or if you desire additional information, please write: Human Resources, Michigan Department of Natural Resources, P.O. Box 30028, Lansing, MI 48909-7528 or the Michigan Department of Civil Rights, Cadillac Place, Suite 3-600, 3054 W. Grand Blvd., Detroit, MI 48202 or the Division of Federal Assistance, U.S. Fish and Wildlife Service, 4401 North Fairfax Drive, Mail Stop MBSP4020, Arlington, VA 22203.

This publication is available in alternative formats upon request.

How to use this publication:

1. Decide what species you're fishing for, on which waterbody (Great Lakes, inland lakes, rivers/streams), and in what county.
2. For fish other than trout, check out the "General Fishing Regulations" on page 12.
3. Inland trout & salmon regulations can be found starting on page 42. It's also helpful to check the online maps (Michigan.gov/FishingMaps).
4. Make sure to check the "Exceptions to General Fishing Regulations by County" content for special regulations (starting on page 28).
5. Make sure to read over the "Lawful Fishing Methods", "Unlawful Activities" and "Definitions & Terms" sections.
6. Finally, be sure to check the Table of Contents for other opportunities and important information.

And don't forget to buy a fishing license at Michigan.gov/DNRLicenses or in the Michigan DNR Hunt Fish App!



CLEAN.DRAIN.DRY.



CLEAN

- ✓ Boats, trailers, and gear
- ✓ Remove all weeds, mud, and hitchhiking contaminants from axels, wheels, undercarriage, motor, prop, nets, and gear before leaving boat landing



DRAIN

- ✓ Water from boat, bilge, motor, and live well
- ✓ Remove drain plug and open all water draining devices
- ✓ Trash unused bait



DRY

- ✓ Everything at least five days before going to other waters
- ✓ (Or) Decontaminate with high pressure water (120 F or warmer)

STOP INVASIVE SPECIES! LEARN MORE AT CLEANDRAINDRY.ORG



License Items & Fees

Purchase your fishing license (and more) online at Michigan.gov/DNRLicenses.

All fishing licenses are good for all species allowed for harvest as indicated in this digest. A \$1 surcharge is included in the resident annual, nonresident annual, and senior annual fishing licenses as well as the combo hunt and fish licenses, as noted with the asterisk (*). Revenue generated from these funds will be used to educate the public on the benefits of hunting, fishing and trapping in Michigan, and the impact of these activities on the conservation, preservation and management of the state's natural resources in accordance with statute. License fees are subject to change in accordance with statute and changes in the consumer price index. Learn more at Michigan.gov/DNR.

All Species Fishing Licenses	
Item Type	Fee
DNR Sportcard	\$1
Resident Annual	\$26*
Nonresident Annual	\$76*
Senior Annual (Residents 65 or older or Residents who are legally blind – see p. 6)	\$11*
Daily Fish (Resident or Nonresident) This license is valid for 24 hours and may be purchased as needed	\$10/day
Underwater Spearfishing (Resident or Nonresident) Required for the activity as described on p. 16.	Free (A DNR Sportcard may be needed. See p. 6.)
Voluntary Youth (Age 16 and under)	\$2*

Combo Hunt/Fish Licenses (Base, Annual Fishing, 2 Deer)	
Item Type	Fee
Hunt/Fish Resident	\$76*
Hunt/Fish Senior Resident	\$43*
Hunt/Fish Nonresident	\$266*

Fishing license fees are waived for Michigan residents who are veterans with 100% disability or active-duty military, and for individuals who have a developmental disability as defined in section 100a of the mental health code, 1974 PA 258, MCL 330.1100a. (see p. 6).

Who needs a Michigan fishing license?

A license is required when targeting fish, amphibians, crustaceans and reptiles in public waters of the state. If you are 17 years of age or older and fish in Michigan, you must purchase a fishing license. If you are under 17, you may fish without a license, but you are required to observe all fishing rules and regulations. If turning 17 at any point during the current season (April 1 – March 31), you'll need to buy a license.

Note: The youth fishing license is voluntary and not required for ages 16 and under (See p. 9).

Any adult actively assisting a minor must have a fishing license. However, adults without a fishing license may do the following:

- Help land a fish with a net or their hands
- Help unhook a fish
- Set up the fishing rod with the appropriate gear
- Bait the hook

- Fix tangles or snags
- Cast the line for young anglers; however, it should be stressed the young angler must be an active participant while the adult is only assisting

Where can you purchase a Michigan fishing license (or replace a lost one)?

1. Online at Michigan.gov/DNRLicenses
2. On the Michigan DNR Hunt Fish App
3. At a License Agent (find the list at Michigan.gov/DNRLicenseAgents)
4. At a DNR Customer Service Center (find the one closest to you on p. 73)

Need help? Problems buying your license online? Call the DNR's License Sales Help Desk: 517-284-6057.

Where does the fishing license revenue go?
For information concerning where fishing license funds are used, please see p. 72.

New regulations appear in red text throughout this publication.

Always call 888-367-7060 or check online at [Michigan.gov/Fishing](https://michigan.gov/Fishing) for the most recent regulation information.

Lake Superior Lake Trout and Splake Limit Change

Stannard Rock and Big Reef are now under new possession limits (pp. 20–21).

Upper Peninsula Walleye Protected Slot Limit (PSL) Lakes

Two lakes are covered under a new regulation category for Walleye (p. 13)

New Burbot Possession Limit

Burbot has a possession limit of 5 per day (p. 12).

Underwater Spearfishing Waters Expansion

Additional Great Lakes waters are now open to this activity (pp. 16-17)

Inland Trout & Salmon Regulations

Use of a bead fished on the hook or pegged or attached to the line no further than 4 inches above the eye of a single-pointed hook is now defined (p. 8).

Menominee River Lake Sturgeon Season

A new CIR season on Lake Sturgeon in the Menominee R. (from Grand Rapids Dam to the Sturgeon Falls Dam) from the 1st Saturday in June – 1st Sunday in March (pp. 15, 25) has been added.

License Fees

Michigan's fishing license fees may undergo changes after production of this digest.

Table Formatting

Table formatting has been updated for digital accessibility.

**REPORT ALL
POACHING**
800-292-7800
(CALL OR TEXT)

NOTICE: This brochure is not a legal notice or a complete collection of fishing regulations and laws. It is a condensed guide issued for anglers' convenience. Copies of Michigan's regulations can be obtained from [Michigan.gov/DNR](https://michigan.gov/DNR).



Marked and Tagged Fish

In evaluating fish stocks, the DNR and natural resource partners often mark fish with a visible tag, internal tag, or fin clips. If you catch a marked fish, please report it online at [Michigan.gov/EyesInTheField](https://michigan.gov/EyesInTheField).

Some tags have an associated monetary reward for their return. Anglers catching a reward-tagged fish should report the tag at [Michigan.gov/EyesInTheField](https://michigan.gov/EyesInTheField), and additionally follow any specific instructions on the tag (e.g., contact phone number, address, extraction of internal tag). Please do not remove any tags from Lake Sturgeon.

Many Great Lakes trout or salmon have been marked with a microscopic coded-wire tag implanted in the snout (part of head from behind the eyes forward) of the fish. Fish with these tags can be identified by the absence of the adipose fin. If you catch and keep a trout or salmon with **only** the adipose fin missing, it could have a coded-wire tag.

When creel clerks are present at the Great Lakes ports you fish, please let them know if you've harvested any potentially tagged fish. They can then collect the fish snouts and information needed for tag extraction and evaluation. More information about DNR fish marking studies can be found at [Michigan.gov/TaggedFish](https://michigan.gov/TaggedFish).



2026 Fishing Seasons

4 This table provides general hook-and-line fishing seasons/dates for the species listed. **There are many other fishing regulations associated with these species and seasons. Please refer to the rest of the Michigan Fishing Regulations for regulations concerning size limits, possession limits, and other restrictions.**

Largemouth & Smallmouth Bass

Type	Apr	May	Jun	Jul	Aug	Sep	Oct	Nov	Dec	Jan	Feb	Mar	More Info.
Catch-and-immediate-release on all waters	Open	Open	Open	Open	Open	Open	Open	Open	Open	Open	Open	Open	p. 12
Possession season on all waters, including Great Lakes (except as noted below)		Open Sat. before Mem. Day	Open	Open	Open	Open	Open	Open	Open; closes Dec 31				pp. 12-13
Possession season on Lake St. Clair & St. Clair & Detroit rivers			Open 3rd Sat.	Open	Open	Open	Open	Open	Open; closes Dec 31				p. 12

Muskellunge

Type	Apr	May	Jun	Jul	Aug	Sep	Oct	Nov	Dec	Jan	Feb	Mar	More Info.
Catch-and-immediate-release on all waters	Open	Open	Open	Open	Open	Open	Open	Open	Open	Open	Open	Open	pp. 12-14
Possession season on all Great Lakes & inland waters & St. Marys River- (except as noted below)			Open 1st Sat.	Open	Open	Open	Open	Open	Open	Open	Open	Open; closes March 15	pp. 12-14
Possession season on Lake St. Clair & St. Clair & Detroit rivers			Open 1st Sat.	Open	Open	Open	Open	Open	Open; closes Dec 31				pp. 12-14

Channel Catfish, Flathead Catfish, Cisco, Lake Whitefish, Round Whitefish, Smelt, Sunfishes, White Bass, Yellow Perch & Other Species

Type	Apr	May	Jun	Jul	Aug	Sep	Oct	Nov	Dec	Jan	Feb	Mar	More Info.
All waters not otherwise closed to fishing	Open	Open	Open	Open	Open	Open	Open	Open	Open	Open	Open	Open	pp. 12-14

Northern Pike & Walleye

Type	Apr	May	Jun	Jul	Aug	Sep	Oct	Nov	Dec	Jan	Feb	Mar	More Info.
Possession season on Lower Peninsula Great Lakes, Lake St. Clair & St. Clair & Detroit rivers	Open	Open	Open	Open	Open	Open	Open	Open	Open	Open	Open	Open	pp. 12–14
Possession season on Lower Peninsula inland waters	Open last Sat.	Open	Open	Open	Open	Open	Open	Open	Open	Open	Open	Open; closes March 15	pp. 12–14
Possession season on Upper Peninsula Great Lakes, inland waters & St. Marys River		Open May 15	Open	Open	Open	Open	Open	Open	Open	Open	Open	Open; closes March 15	pp. 12–14

Salmon & Trout

Type	Apr	May	Jun	Jul	Aug	Sep	Oct	Nov	Dec	Jan	Feb	Mar	More Info.
Great Lakes, Lake St. Clair, St. Marys River, St. Clair & Detroit rivers	Open	Open	Open	Open	Open	Open	Open	Open	Open	Open	Open	Open	pp. 18–21
(Inland) Type 3 & 4 streams and Type B, C, E & F lakes	Open	Open	Open	Open	Open	Open	Open	Open	Open	Open	Open	Open	pp. 42–65
Possession & fishing season (inland) Type 1 & 2 streams	Open last Sat.	Open	Open	Open	Open	Open; closes Sep 30							pp. 42–65
Possession & fishing season (inland) Type A & D lakes	Open last Sat.	Open	Open	Open	Open	Open	Open; closes Oct 31						pp. 42–65

Gear Restricted Streams — Please see pages 44–46 for information concerning seasons on these streams.

Great Lakes Lake Trout & Splake — See map and Lake Trout & Splake Regulations table, pages 20–21.

Lake Sturgeon — See Lake Sturgeon Regulations table, page 15.

Fishing License Requirements and Special Provisions

- You must purchase a license if you are 17 years of age or older.
- If you are under 17, you may fish without a license, but you are required to observe all fishing rules and regulations.
- When fishing, you must carry your license and the identification used to purchase that license and exhibit both upon request of a Michigan Conservation Officer, a Tribal Conservation Officer or any law enforcement officer.
- The Michigan Department of Natural Resources has an electronic license that allows an individual to display a copy of the fishing license using a smart phone or similar device.
- Your annual fishing license is valid from March 1 of a given year through March 31 of the following year.

To purchase a fishing license you must have:

- A valid Michigan Driver's License; or
- A valid Michigan ID Card (issued by the Secretary of State); or
- A valid driver's license from your state of residency; or
- A DNR Sportcard (issued by license dealers). If the information on your DNR Sportcard from a previous year is still accurate, you may continue to use it. **NOTE:** When purchasing a DNR Sportcard you will be asked to provide two proofs of Michigan residency.

To qualify for a resident fishing license, you must:

- Be a person who resides in a settled or permanent home or domicile within the boundaries of this state with the intention of remaining in this state, or
- Be a full-time student at a Michigan college or university, and reside in Michigan, or
- Serve full-time in the U.S. Military and be either officially stationed in Michigan or maintain residency in Michigan.

The ownership of land in Michigan by itself is not qualification for a resident license.

Other special provisions:

U.S. Military Personnel: Fishing license fees are waived for full-time, federal, active-duty U.S. military personnel who have maintained resident status. The individual must present military ID, leave papers, duty papers, military orders or other evidence verifying that he/she is an active-duty member of the military, along with a valid Michigan

driver's license or voter registration card. This license, available at DNR Customer Service Centers (see p. 73) and at license retail outlets statewide, is valid for the license year. Military members receiving a free license must present the license, along with proof of military status, if requested by a Conservation Officer. **NOTE:** Nonresident, active-duty military personnel officially stationed in Michigan qualify for Michigan resident rates.

Michigan Veterans with Disabilities: A resident veteran with a disability is eligible to obtain a fishing license, that does not require a separate application, free of charge if one of the following conditions is met: the person has been determined by the U.S. Department of Veteran Affairs to be permanently and totally disabled as a result of military service and entitled to veterans' benefits at the 100% rate, for a disability other than blindness, or the person has been rated by the U.S. Department of Veteran Affairs as individually unemployable.

Residents who are blind: A resident who is declared legally blind is eligible to purchase the senior fishing license.

Persons with developmental disabilities or residents of a home for the aged (licensed under the Public Health Code): A mentored hunting license (which includes an all-species fishing license) is free for an individual who has a developmental disability and a guardian appointed under chapter 6 of the mental health code, 1974 PA 258, MCL 330.1600 to 330.1644. A resident of a home for the aged licensed under the Public Health Code may obtain a permit from the DNR to fish without a license if the resident of the licensed home for the aged is a member of a group accompanied by 1 or more adults who hold a valid license to fish. Permits are available at DNR Customer Service Centers (see p. 73).

Automatically Renew!

When you purchase your Michigan fishing license online, you can choose to automatically renew next year!

CHANCES

Click Auto Renewals in the Hunt Fish App, or select it at checkout on Michigan.gov/DNRLicenses.



**AUTO
RENEWALS**

Description of Inland Waters

Inland waters are all waters within the jurisdiction of the state except the Great Lakes, and the bays and connecting waters. The connecting waters between Lake Superior and Lake Huron include that portion of the St. Marys River located within this state. The connecting waters of Lake Huron and Lake Erie include the St. Clair River (begins at the Fort Gratiot Light), Lake St. Clair and the Detroit River (beginning at the imaginary line extending due south of the Windmill Point Light, Wayne County, and ending at the imaginary east-west line drawn through the most southerly point of Celeron Island). Inland waters include all inland lakes, streams and tributaries to the Great Lakes.

Closed Seasons (Spawning Closures)

Michigan prohibits fishing for various species at certain times of the year. These seasonal closures generally coincide with spawning periods and are often referred to as spawning closures. Many anglers and managers tend to think of these regulations as providing specific protection to spawning fish, and the timing and length of closed seasons are generally related to the timing and duration of spawning seasons. These closures are indicated by lake or

stream in the county listing (see pp. 12–14, 28–31 and 48–65). Lakes and streams are closed to all fishing during the period listed.

Native American Fishing on Inland Waters

Federal treaties exist between the United States government and tribes residing in Michigan. Although the entire State of Michigan is covered by treaties, only two treaty areas are currently subject to fishing by tribal governments. The Treaty of Washington, signed in 1836, covers the eastern Upper Peninsula and the northern Lower Peninsula of Michigan. The Treaty of La Pointe, signed in 1842, covers the western Upper Peninsula and areas of northern Wisconsin.

Seasons and possession limits for tribal members may differ somewhat from state regulations. In addition, under a permit system, tribal members may use spears and may place impoundment nets on designated public waters. The use of gill nets is generally prohibited in inland waters. If you encounter these activities, do not disrupt the fishers or interfere with their nets. For more information please visit Michigan.gov/TribalCoordination.

DID YOU KNOW? Violators of fishing rules & regulations can face fines, jail time, loss of fishing equipment and/or revocation of their fishing license.

Species	Fine	Jail	Revocation of License / Permit
Violation under section 41105 Fish - 1st Offense	Up to \$100 (1st offense); OR	Up to 60 days (1st offense)	Optional
Violation under section 41105 Fish - 2nd or Subsequent Offense	\$50 - \$250; OR	20-90 days	Optional
Violation under section 48702a* Fish - 1st Offense	\$500 - \$1,000 (plus costs of prosecution)	Up to 93 days	Required
Violation under section 48702a* Fish - 2nd or Subsequent Offense	\$1,000 - \$2,500 (plus costs of prosecution)	Up to 1 year	Required

**NOTE: Violations under section 48702a could lead to a fine, jail or both.*

Artificial Flies: Known as wet and dry flies, streamers, or nymphs, is defined as a single-pointed hook, or not more than two single-pointed hooks connected in-line (the second hook commonly known as a stinger hook), crafted with natural, artificial and/or synthetic materials attached to the hook with thread. An artificial fly may not include a spinner, spoon, scoop, lip or any other fishing lure or bait attached. Material of any type cannot be attached above the eye of the hook. The fly or leader may be weighted, but no weight shall be attached to the terminal tackle in a manner that allows the weight to be suspended from or below the hook. Single-pointed hooks are restricted to measuring 1/2-inch or less from point to shank. **A bead is not a fly and is not allowed in flies only gear restricted waters.**

Artificial Lure/Bait: A man-made lure manufactured to imitate natural bait. Artificial lures include spoons, spinners, flies and plugs made of metal, plastic, wood and other non-edible materials. They also include plastic products made to resemble worms, eggs, fish and other aquatic organisms. **Use of a bead (bead fishing) is considered to be a lure.** NOTE: On the following waters from Aug. 1 – Nov. 15, terminal fishing gear is restricted to single-pointed hooks or jigs, measuring 1/2-inch or less from point to shank or treble hooks 3/8-inch or less from point to shank ONLY when attached to a body bait, plug, spinner or spoon. An artificial lure is not a device primarily constructed of lead: all waters of the Betsie R. (Benzie and Manistee Cos.), all waters of Bear Cr. (Manistee Co.), the Manistee R. from Tippy Dam downstream to Railroad Bridge below M-55 (T22N, R16W, S31; Manistee Co.), Big Sable R. from mouth upstream to Hamlin Lake Dam (Mason Co.), all waters of the Pere Marquette R. (Lake, Mason, Newaygo and Oceana Cos.), all waters of the Little Manistee R. (Lake, Manistee and Mason Cos.), White R. from mouth upstream to Hesperia Dam (Muskegon and Oceana Cos.), all waters of N. Br. White R. (Muskegon and Oceana Cos.) Muskegon R. upstream to Croton Dam (Muskegon and Newaygo Cos.), and all waters of the N. Br. Pentwater R. (Mason and Oceana Cos.), S. Br. Pentwater R. upstream to Hart Dam (Mason and Oceana Cos.).

Bead Fishing: Use of a bead fished on the hook or pegged or attached to the line no further than 4 inches above the eye of a single-pointed hook (restricted to measuring 1/2-inch or less from point to shank) is allowed and is considered to be a lure.

Cast Net: A net without walls or sides used by throwing to catch baitfish. Any size may be used. Only can be used to collect minnows, Alewife, Smelt, and shad from the Great Lakes, Lake St. Clair, St. Clair R., Detroit R., and St. Marys River. Use on any inland waters is prohibited (see p. 23).

Catch-and-Immediate-Release (CIR): The act of returning fish immediately to the water without injury and without holding in a livewell or similar device. Anglers may continue to fish CIR given they

have reached their daily possession limit for a given species.

Chumming: Luring or attempting to lure or attract fish by scattering organic material into the water (see p. 11). Material commonly used as chum includes fish eggs, corn, rice, noodles, oatmeal and maggots (see the NOTE above the table on p. 43).

Cisco: Also known as Lake Herring.

Competitive Fishing Event: Any organized competition among anglers involving prize distribution or the declaration of a winner that is not defined as a fishing tournament with specific rules applying to that particular event (see p. 70).

Daily Possession Limit: Also known as the bag limit. The total number of fish, amphibians or reptiles that may be caught and retained in one calendar day and includes those that are consumed or given away. See also Possession Limit (see p. 9).

Dates: Whenever dates are listed they are considered inclusive.

Designated Trout Lake: Any lake designated by law that contains a significant population of trout or salmon. All Type A and Type D lakes are designated trout lakes (see p. 42 and 48–65).

Designated Trout Stream: Any stream designated by law that contains a significant population of trout or salmon. All of the following: Type 1, Type 2, Gear Restricted Streams, and Brook Trout Restoration Areas, and most Type 3 and Type 4 waters are designated trout streams (see pp. 42–65).

Dip Net: A square net constructed from a piece of webbing of heavy twine, hung on heavy cord or frame so as to be without sides or walls, and suspended from the corners and attached in such a manner that when the net is lifted no part is more than 4 feet below the plane formed by the imaginary lines connecting the corners from which the net is suspended. As used in fishing, it shall be lowered and raised vertically as nearly as possible (also referred to as a drop net or umbrella net) (see p. 23).

Dropper Line: A line in addition to the main fishing line that contains a hook. Dropper lines are usually attached to the main line.

Drop-Shotting: Using a weight suspended below a single-pointed hook that is tied directly to the main fishing line (see p. 10).

Drowned River Mouth Lakes (Type F): A lake-like area of a river where it enters the Great Lakes. Considered inland waters and are listed in Note 2 on p. 18.

Eviscerated: To have internal organs removed from the body cavity or have gills severed to ensure the organism is dead.

Fishing License: A required item for any resident or nonresident angler age 17 or older targeting fish, amphibians, crustaceans or reptiles in Michigan.

Annual licenses are valid from March 1 of a given year through March 31 of the following year (see p. 2).

Fishing Season: The period of time a body of water is open to fishing. It is unlawful to fish in any body of water outside of the fishing season.

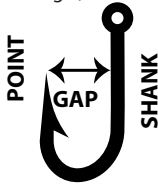
Fishing Tournament: An organized, competitive fishing event among anglers, or teams of anglers, with specific rules applying to that particular event. See also Fishing Tournament Information on p. 70.

Fishing Tournament Information System: An electronic system fishing tournament directors use to register their fishing tournaments (see p. 70).

Great Lakes Connecting Waters (Connecting Waters): Specific bodies of water in Michigan that connect the Great Lakes. The designated connecting waters are L. St. Clair, St. Marys R., St. Clair R. (begins at the Fort Gratiot Light) and the Detroit R. (begins at the imaginary east/west line extending due south of the Windmill Point Light, Wayne Co., and ending at the imaginary east/west line drawn through the most southernly point of Celeron Isl.). NOTE: Portage/ Torch Lakes (Houghton Co.) are not designated as Great Lakes Connecting Waters.

Hand Net and Landing Net: A mesh bag of webbing or wire, suspended from a circular, oval or rectangular frame attached to a handle. These are the most common fishing nets used in Michigan (see p. 23).

Hook & Hook Gap Measurement: A single, double or treble pointed hook. All hooks — single, double or treble pointed and attached to a manufactured artificial lure shall be counted as 1 hook. Refer to diagram to the right. The same method is used for single and multi-pointed hooks.



Inland Trout & Salmon Regulation Maps: Maps are available online to assist anglers in identifying which trout and salmon regulations apply on specific stream reaches and inland lakes categorized by Type. The maps are posted at Michigan.gov/FishingMaps.

Inland Waters: All waters in Michigan EXCEPT the Great Lakes and the Great Lakes Connecting Waters.

Minnows: Chubs, shiners, dace, stonerollers, sculpins (muddlers), mudminnows, and suckers of a size used for bait in hook-and-line fishing (see p. 10).

Mutilated Fish: A fish that is unidentifiable or cannot be measured.

Possession Limit: In addition to 1 day's daily possession limit of fish, a person may possess an additional 2 daily possession limits of fish taken during previous fishing days provided the additional limits of fish are processed (canned, cured by smoking or drying, or frozen). This provision does not apply to Lake Sturgeon or Muskellunge. Anglers who have not attained the age of 17 are entitled to the possession limit even though they do not have a

fishing license. A person fishing waters bordered by other states or provinces AND possessing multiple fishing licenses may possess the limit allowed for ONLY ONE license while in transit. When fishing in Michigan waters, Michigan possession and size limits must be followed.

Possession Season: The portion of the fishing season during which it is legal to harvest fish.

Protected Slot Limit: A size range for which possession of a species is not allowed. Fish smaller or greater than the protected slot may be kept.

Public Water Stocking Permit: The permit required when requesting stocking in a public waterbody. Visit michigan.gov/dnr/managing-resources/fisheries/stocking for more information.

Reduced Possession Limit Zones: Refers to zones with reduced possession limits for Lake Trout and Splake, see Lake Trout Management Units & Refuges map, p. 20. **Stannard Rock** is defined as the area east of a line of longitude at -87.28 degrees, south of a line of latitude at 47.27 degrees, west of a line of longitude at -87.11 degrees, and north of a line of latitude at 47.13 degrees. **Big Reef** is defined as the area east of a line of longitude at -86.55 degrees, and south of a line of latitude at 46.93 degrees, and west of a line of longitude at -86.37 degrees, and north of a line of latitude at 46.7 degrees.

Round Whitefish: Also known as Menominee.

Snag or Snagging: Taking or attempting to take a fish in a manner or methods where the fish does not take, or have the chance to take, the hook voluntarily in its mouth. Snagging shall include, but not be limited to, fishing by manipulating a hook or hooks and other tackle or lures, whether baited or not, in such a manner as to pierce or hook a fish in any part of the body, circumventing the voluntary action of the fish to take the bait or lure in the mouth.

Tournament Registration: Following the appropriate process to register bass and Walleye tournaments or Muskellunge competitive fishing events with the department (see p. 70).

Trapping: Catching or taking fish by use of a device, such as a cage or net, designed to capture a fish or animal.

T/R/S: Public Land Survey System notation for Township, Range, and Section.

Type: Refers to the regulation category that an inland stream or inland lake is classified as. Inland Trout & Salmon Lake Regulations are categorized as Types A – F. Inland Trout & Salmon Stream Regulations are categorized as Types 1 – 4, Brook Trout Restoration Areas (BTRA) and Gear Restricted Streams (GR). The regulations for each category can be found on pp. 42–65.

Weir: A fence or structure set in water to block or retain fish.

Artificial Lights: Artificial lights may be used for fishing; however, artificial lights may not be used to spear frogs (see p. 22).

Bait: Baitfish may only be used in the waters where collected. Any fish and frogs may be used as bait when legally taken and possessed, EXCEPT lampreys, live carp or Goldfish. Wigglers (mayfly nymphs) and other aquatic nymphs and larvae also may be used for bait, but may not be taken from any trout stream except for personal use on the same stream. Crayfish may be taken for bait and personal use (see below). See exceptions on the Michigan Wisconsin Boundary Waters (see pp. 24–25). To help reduce the spread of invasive species, anglers are reminded to properly dispose of all bait containers including worms and soil, crayfish and minnows in a trash receptacle.

Bowfishing: Bow and arrow and crossbow may be used on certain waters for certain species. See Bow- and Spearfishing Regulations table, pp. 16–17.

Crayfish: Native crayfish may be harvested in all waters as long as the water body is open to fishing. In designated trout waters, crayfish may only be taken during the fishing season for trout. Anglers may use traps, nets, hook-and-line or hands to harvest crayfish. All crayfish traps must bear the owners name and address. There is no minimum size limit or possession limit. Crayfish species not native to Michigan waters, including (but not limited to) Red Swamp Crayfish (*Procambarus clarkii*) and Rusty Crayfish (*Faxonius rusticus*), may not be possessed live or used alive for bait on any waters of this state whether those waters are public or private. However, Rusty Crayfish may be harvested live for personal consumption. On Michigan-Wisconsin boundary waters, crayfish may not be possessed or used for bait, whether alive or dead.

Dip Nets: Dip nets may be used for Bowfin, carp, Longnose Gar, Smelt and suckers in waters that are not designated trout streams. A permit is required if equipment is to be left overnight. See General Netting Regulations table, p. 23.



Drop-Shotting: The practice of having a weight suspended below a single-pointed hook that is tied directly to the main fishing line is lawful on inland lakes, drowned river mouths (see p. 18), Great Lakes and Great Lakes Connecting Waters only. This gear may not be used on rivers or streams.

Gaffs: Gaffs may be used to help land lawfully hooked fish on all waters EXCEPT on a designated trout stream. Never use a gaff on fish that are not legal to harvest or fish you plan to release.

Hand Nets: Hand nets of any handle length may be used to help land lawfully hooked fish. Hand nets may also be used to take Bowfin, carp, Longnose Gar, Smelt and suckers. See General Netting Regulations table, p. 23.

Hook-and-Line Fishing: Fish not hooked in the mouth must be returned to the water immediately. No more than 3 lines per person (including tip-ups) or more than 6 hooks or lures may be used. All hooks attached to an artificial bait or “night crawler harness” are counted as 1 hook (EXCEPTION: for crappie/perch rigs and umbrella rigs each hook is counted separately as part of total allowed). Hooks must be baited, **fished with a bead** or attached to an artificial bait. All tip-ups and other similar devices must be marked with the name and address of the owner in legible English, either directly on the object or securely fastened to it by a plate or tag. All lines must be under immediate control. Hook and size regulations exist on certain streams (see Exceptions to General Regulations by County, pp. 28–31).

Minnows for Personal Use: Minnows for personal use may only be taken with hook-and-line, seines, dip nets, hand nets and traps with a valid fishing license and may only be used in the waters where they are collected. In designated trout lakes and streams, minnows may only be taken during the open season for trout by hook-and-line or minnow traps. NOTE: Minnows may not be taken from Leelanau Co.: Hatlem’s Cr. Gear restrictions are as follows: seines must not be over 12 feet by 4 feet; hand nets not over 8 square feet and without sides or walls; and minnow traps not over 24" long and need to have a funnel opening no larger than 1 1/2". Minnow traps must bear the owner’s name and address. Cast nets may be used to take minnows, Alewife, Smelt and shad in the Great Lakes, L. St. Clair, and the Detroit R., St. Clair R., and St. Mary’s R.

Spearfishing: Hand, rubber or spring-propelled spears may be used for certain species. See Bow- and Spearfishing Regulations table, pp. 16–17. A spear is not a line.

It Is Unlawful To:

- **Chum with organic material** in all stream Types as indicated on p. 43.
- **Possess or transport** any live transgenic (genetically engineered) organism or any live specimen of the following non-native fish, crayfish, or freshwater mollusk: Bighead Carp, Black Carp, Silver Carp, Grass Carp (White Amur), members of the snakehead family (*Channidae*), Wels Catfish, Bitterling, Stone Moroko, Dander, Ide, Japanese Weatherfish, Rudd, Tench, Eurasian Ruffe, Tubenose Goby, Round Goby, Red Swamp Crayfish, Yabby Crayfish, Rusty Crayfish (except for personal consumption as noted on p. 10), Killer Shrimp, Zebra Mussel, Golden Mussel or Quagga Mussel. To do so may result in civil fines up to \$10,000.
- **Possess or use for bait** any live crayfish species not native to Michigan waters, including (but not limited to) Red Swamp Crayfish and Rusty Crayfish, whether alive or dead, on any waters of this state whether those waters are public or private (see p. 10).
- **Import, plant or transplant** live fish including viable eggs of any fish without a public water stocking permit (see p. 9).
- **Buy or sell** fish or parts of fish, reptiles, amphibians or crayfish taken under a sport fishing license.
- **Take fish** for the sole purpose of removing the eggs.
- **Harvest, attempt to harvest, or possess any threatened or endangered species** except as authorized by the DNR. For more information, look at Michigan's Rare Plants & Animals list at Michigan.gov/dnr/managing-resources/wildlife/wildlife-permits/threatened-endangered-species/threatened-and-endangered-species-list.
- **Harvest or attempt to harvest** freshwater mussels (clams or bivalves) whether living or dead, including the shell or parts thereof, from any waters of the state.
 - » **EXCEPTION:** A special cultural or collectors permit may be obtained from the DNR for the taking of freshwater mussels.
- **Use multi-pointed hooks exceeding** 3/8" between point and shank and/or single-pointed hooks exceeding 1/2" between point and shank on all streams (including tributaries to the Great Lakes) from Aug. 1 – May 31.
- **Use lures exceeding one ounce** on all streams from Aug. 1 – May 31 except when fishing in the Detroit R., St. Clair R., and St. Marys R.
- **Possess or sell** a multi-pointed hook with a weight permanently attached.
- **Take or possess on any waters over which this state has jurisdiction** any fish that is so mutilated that the identification or measurement of that fish is impossible.
- **Possess more than** the Michigan daily possession limit when fishing in Michigan waters, even if holding licenses from more than one state or province.
- **Commercially take, possess or sell** Rusty Crayfish in Michigan.
- **Commercially take** amphibians or reptiles in Michigan.
- **Disturb or remove** reptile eggs from the wild without a permit.
- **Fish for** any species or possess fishing devices along a stream or lake closed to fishing.
- **Fish with** your hands, firearms, explosives, setlines, poisons or methods other than lawful fishing methods.
- **Fish** anywhere in a fish ladder or within 100 feet of a lamprey control weir.
- **Use a net** to take a fish within 100 feet of a dam (landing nets are allowed to secure a legally hooked fish).
- **Use a seine** for any species other than minnows.
- **Use cast nets** in any inland water.
- **Shoot** reptiles or amphibians with a firearm (including spring, air or gas propelled), bow and arrow or crossbow.
- **Have a weight** rigidly attached to a multi-point hook, or suspended from a multi-point hook.
- **Fish on a river or stream** (see NOTE 2, p. 18) using a weight suspended below any hook, unless the hook is on a dropper line (a leader) that is at least 3" long.
- **Fish on a drowned river mouth (Type F)** using a weight suspended below any multi-pointed hook or single-pointed hooks exceeding a 1/2" between point and shank (see NOTE 2, p. 18).
- **Deposit litter**, fish offal or any foreign matter in any waters of the state or any lands, private or public.
- **Take or attempt to take** fish outside of the open season for that species (unless there is a specified CIR season for that species).
- **Commercially harvest** wigglers from any state waters from June 1 – Sep. 1.
- **Snag a fish**, attempt to snag a fish, or possess a fish that was snagged.
- **Possess a Prohibited or Restricted Species**, the possession of a fish species listed as prohibited or restricted per MCL 324.41301 or Invasive Species Order Amendment No. 1 of 2020 is prohibited unless it is eviscerated or adheres to criteria described within MCL 324.41301(2).

This table provides general statewide regulations for the species listed. **However, there are many waters in the state that have fishing regulations which differ from those in this table. For instance, it is unlawful to possess fishing gear or fish for suckers on designated trout waters during the closed fishing season.** Please refer to the Michigan-Wisconsin Boundary Waters (see pp. 24–25), Sylvania Wilderness Area (see p. 26), Exceptions to General Regulations by County (see pp. 28–31), and Inland Trout & Salmon Regulations (pp. 42–65) for exceptions. Table notes are found on pp. 13–14. **ATTENTION ANGLERS:** There are regulations requiring all bass and Walleye tournaments and Muskellunge contests be registered (see p. 70).

General Fishing Regulations

Species (NOTE 1)	Minimum Size (inches)	Daily Possession Limit	Possession Seasons
Largemouth Bass Smallmouth Bass (NOTE 2)	14"	5 in any combination	3rd. Sat. in June – Dec. 31: L. St. Clair, St. Clair R., Detroit R. (See NOTE 2) Sat. before Memorial Day – Dec. 31: All other waters including Gr. Lakes (except those listed in NOTE 2)
Walleye (NOTE 3)	15"	5	May 15 – March 15: Upper Peninsula Gr. Lakes and inland waters, and St. Marys R. Last Sat. in April – March 15: Lower Peninsula inland waters Open All Year: Lower Peninsula Gr. Lakes, L. St. Clair, St. Clair R. and Detroit R.
Northern Pike (NOTE 4)	24"	2	May 15 – March 15: Upper Peninsula Gr. Lakes and inland waters, and St. Marys R. Last Sat. in April – March 15: Lower Peninsula inland waters Open All Year: Lower Peninsula Gr. Lakes, L. St. Clair, St. Clair R. and Detroit R.
Flathead Catfish	15"	5	Open All Year
Channel Catfish	12"	10	Open All Year
Muskellunge (including Tiger Muskellunge) (NOTE 4)	42" (See NOTE 4 for exceptions)	Only 1 per angler per license year (Mandatory Registration)	1st Sat. in June – March 15: All Gr. Lakes and inland waters and St. Marys R. 1st Sat. in June – Dec. 31: L. St. Clair, St. Clair R. and Detroit R.
Yellow Perch (NOTE 5)	No size limit	25	Open All Year
Sunfishes (NOTE 6)	No size limit	25 in any combination of the listed species	Open All Year
White Bass	No size limit	25 on Gr. Lakes, L. St. Clair, St. Marys R., St. Clair R., and Detroit R. 10 on inland waters	Open All Year
Cisco, Lake Whitefish, Round Whitefish (NOTE 7)	No size limit	10 in any combination on Gr. Lakes, Connecting Waters and Type F lakes, 5 in any combination on other inland waters	Open All Year
Lake Sturgeon			See Lake Sturgeon Regulations table, p. 15
Smelt	No size limit	2 gallons	Open All Year (See p. 23, General Netting Regulations table)
Burbot	No size limit	5	Open All Year
All others (NOTE 8)	No size limit	No possession limit	Open All Year

NOTES for General Fishing Regulations Table

NOTE 1 - All Warmwater Fish

Warmwater fish include all species listed in this table. Regulations for trout and salmon on inland waters are provided on pp. 42–65 and Great Lakes trout and salmon on pp. 18–21.

NOTE 2 - Largemouth & Smallmouth Bass

Catch-and-Immediate-Release (CIR) seasons: CIR fishing for bass is allowed all year on all waters, unless otherwise closed to fishing. All bass caught must be immediately returned to the water (see *Definitions & Terms* pp. 8–9).

On **L. Michigan**, within one-half mile of the following islands of the Beaver Island Archipelago: Beaver, Garden, High and Hog, (Charlevoix Co.) the possession season is July 1 – Dec. 31 and open to bass CIR all year.

NOTE 3 - Walleye

L. Huron waters of MH-4 (p. 20) including Saginaw Bay and lower Saginaw R. including tributaries (**Bay and Saginaw Counties**) **from the mouth of the river, upstream to the West Center Street (Douglas G. Schenk) Bridge.** The daily possession limit for Walleye is 8 with a 13" minimum size limit and open all year. Any changes will be announced online at Michigan.gov/Fishing and in a prerecorded message at 888-367-7060.

L. Erie, Detroit R., L. St. Clair and St. Clair R.: The daily possession limit is 6 Walleye through April 30, 2027. The daily possession limit for Walleye will be updated by May 1 annually. The daily possession limit will be announced online at Michigan.gov/Fishing and in a prerecorded message at 888-367-7060.

L. Michigan waters of Little Bay de Noc (Delta Co.): The daily possession limit shall not include more than 1 Walleye 23" or greater north of a line drawn from Peninsula Point Lighthouse to the mouth of the Bark R.

L. Michigan waters of Green Bay (Menominee Co.): from the mouth of the Menominee R. northward to latitude/longitude (45.5505, -87.2637). located approximately 10 miles north of the Cedar R., from March 2 – Fri. before 1st Sat. in May the daily possession limit is 1 Walleye and from the 1st Sat. in May – March 1 the daily possession limit is 5 Walleye.

Cheboygan R. from the south end of the outermost breakwall at Mullett L. downstream to Cheboygan Dam, and Black R. from Alverno Dam downstream to its confluence with the Cheboygan R.: the possession season for Walleye shall be May 15 – March 15.

Ontonagon R. (Ontonagon Co.): No more than 1 Walleye 23" or greater may be possessed in daily possession limit.

Portage and Torch L. systems (Houghton Co.): No more than 1 Walleye 23" or greater may be possessed in daily possession limit.

Walleye Protected Slot Limit (PSL) Waters: Release all Walleye less than 15" and all between 18.0" to 23.0", inclusive. Daily possession limit is 5 with no more than 1 Walleye greater than 23". **Marquette: L. Independence and Teal L.**

NOTE 4 - Muskellunge & Northern Pike

Mandatory Registration of Harvested Muskellunge: Anglers are required to register Muskellunge harvest within 24 hours. Anglers must report their harvest online (Michigan.gov/RegisterFish), on the DNR Hunt Fish app, by calling 888-636-7778, or in person at any DNR Customer Service Center (p. 73) during normal state business hours with advanced notice of arrival.

Muskellunge harvest is limited to 1 Muskellunge per angler per year (April 1 – March 31).

Catch-and-Immediate-Release (CIR) seasons: CIR fishing for Muskellunge is allowed all year on all waters, unless otherwise closed to fishing. All Muskellunge caught must be immediately returned to the water (see *Definitions & Terms* pp. 8–9).

Special Muskellunge Regulations

50" Minimum Size Limit Waters

Antrim: L. Bellaire (including tribs upstream to Bellaire Dam), Clam L. (including tribs), Torch L. (including tribs); **Antrim & Grand Traverse:** Elk L. (above Elk Rapids Dam, including tribs); **Antrim, Grand Traverse & Kalkaska:** L. Skegemog (including tribs); **Barry & Eaton:** Thornapple R. (including Thornapple L.) from the M-50 bridge downstream to the McCann road crossing and including Mud Cr. from Barger Rd. downstream to Thornapple L.; **Iron:** Chicagoan L. (including tribs); **Lenawee:** L. Hudson.

46" Minimum Size Limit Waters

Antrim: Beals L. (including tribs), Benway L. (including all tribs), Ellsworth L. (including tribs), Hanley L. (including tribs), Scotts L. (including tribs), Wilson L. (including tribs), Intermediate L. (from Bellaire Dam upstream, including tribs); **Antrim & Charlevoix:** Saint Clair L. (including tribs), Sixmile L. (including tribs); **Barry:** Gun L.; **Cheboygan & Presque Isle:** Black L. (including tribs); **Cheboygan:** Black R. (including tribs upstream to Kleber Dam), Mullett L., Indian R., Burt L., Cheboygan R.; **Cheboygan & Emmet:** Crooked R. (downstream from Crooked L. confluence); **Chippewa:** St. Marys R. (from compensating gates downstream to DeTour/Drummond Island Ferry Docks); **Kent:** Grand R. (downstream from Sixth Street Dam); **Murray L.;** **Ottawa:** L. Macatawa, Grand R. (downstream from Sixth Street Dam); **Muskegon:** Mona L.

38" Minimum Size Limit Waters

Lucé: Tahquamenon R. and tribs (upstream from Upper Falls); **Van Buren:** Round L.; **Hillsdale:** L. Diane.

Special Northern Pike Regulations

Waters with 24.0" – 34.0" protected slot limit on Northern Pike and daily possession limit of 2 Northern Pike

Alger: Grand Sable L. **Allegan:** Pine Cr. Flooding **Barry:** Gull L. **Cass:** Diamond and Magician Lks. **Kalamazoo:** Gull and Long Lks. (T35, R10W, S17/18/19/30) **Kent:** Wabasis L. **Lucé:** Blind Sucker Flooding and Bodi L. **Montcalm:** Townline and Sand Lks. **Van Buren:** Magician L.

Waters where up to 5 Northern Pike of any size may be taken with only 1 pike 24" or greater allowed in the daily possession limit

Alcona: Badger and McCollum Lks. **Alger:** Echo, Nawakwa, Trout and 16 Mile Lks. and Au Train Basin (Forest L.). **Antrim:** Beals, Benway, Ellsworth, Hanley, Scotts, Six Mile, St. Clair, and Wilson Lks. **Baraga:** Vermilac (Worm) L. **Benzie:** Long L. **Charlevoix:** Deer, Fox, Geneserath, Six Mile, St. Clair and Susan Lks. **Cheboygan:** Black L. and tribs, Black R. from Alverno Dam upstream, Black R. (upstream of Tower Dam includes Tower Pond and tribs), Paradise (Carp), Silver and Wildwood Lks. **Chippewa:** Frenchman and Trout (Carp) Lks. **Clare:** Eight Point L., L. George, Little Long L., Long L. and L. Thirteen. **Crawford:** Big Creek Imp., River and Pickerel Lks. **Delta:** Carr, Chicago, Hamilton (McDonald), Lyman and Round (T43N, R20W, S1) Lks. and Escanaba R. (upstream from first dam at US-2) **Dickinson:** Hamilton L., L. Louise, L. Mary, Norway, Rock, and Sawyer Lks. **Emmet:** Crooked L., French Farm and O'Neal L. Floodings, Paradise (Carp) and Pickerel Lks. **Gladwin:** L. Lancelot, L. Lancer and Wiggins L. **Gogebic:** African (Big and Little), Chaney, Cisco, Clearwater, East Bay, Fishhawk and Indian Lks., L. Gogebic, Lindsley, Morley, Poor, Record, Sunday and Thousand Island Lks. **Grand Traverse:** Boardman L. and L. Dubonnet. **Houghton:** Prickett Imp. and Rice L. **Ionia:** Long L. **Iosco:** Chain Lks. **Iron:** Bass, Bone, Brule, Buck, Dawson, Indian and Iron Lks., L. Mary, Paint, Perch, Railroad, Runkle, Shank, Sunset and Winslow Lks., Paint R. Pond (downstream of Horseshoe Rapids and upstream of Frog Island), Hemlock Falls and Michigamme Reservoir, Michigamme Falls and Peavy Reservoir, L. St. Kathryn, Deer R., Net R., and Net R. Wide Waters. **Kent:** Scram L. **Keweenaw:** Schlatter L. **Leelanau:** Florence L. (S. Manitou Is.). **Lucé:** East, Kaks and Muskallonge Lks. **Mackinac:** East, Millecoquins and South Manistique Lks. **Manistee:** Bar and Chief Lks. **Marquette:** Bass (East), Cedar, Engman, Shag (Big) and Witch Lks., Dead R. Storage Basin, Middle Br. Escanaba R., Big West Br. Escanaba R. mainstream downstream to Boney Falls Basin (except Greenwood, Schweitzer and Cataract Reservoirs) **Mason:** Hackert (Crystal)

L. Mecosta: Canadian Lks. (in T14N, R8W, S20,29,30; north of Pierce Rd. and south of Buchanan Rd. in S19), Haymarsh and Horsehead Lks. **Menominee:** Bass L., L. Ann, Shakey Lakes Chain (Baker, Beecher, East, Long, Resort and Spring Lks.), Westman Imp. **Missaukee:** Missaukee L. **Montcalm:** Crystal, Indian and Rainbow Lks. **Montmorency:** Robarge, East and West Town Corner, Pug, and North and South Tomahawk Lks., Black R. and tribs. **Muskegon:** Big Blue L. **Newaygo:** Bills, Diamond, Emerald, Kimball, Nichols, Pickerel, Ryerson (Long) and Sylvan Lks. **Oceana:** Crystal and Round (Wykof) Lks. **Ogemaw:** East Twin L., L. Ogemaw and Sage L. **Osceola:** McCoy L., L. Miramichi, Diamond, Rose and Wells Lks. **Oscoda:** McCollum and Pickerel Lks. **Ontonagon:** L. Gogebic. **Otsego:** Black R. and tribs. **Presque Isle:** Black, Francis and Orchard Lks., Ocqueoc R. and tribs, Ocqueoc Watershed Lakes (Ann, Bullhead, Ella, Emma, Ferdelman, Gorman, Horseshoe, Lost, Louise, Lower and Upper Barnhart, May, McIntosh, Moore, Mud and Nettie and Ocqueoc Lks.), Black R. and tribs and Tomahawk Flooding. **Roscommon:** L. St. Helen, Cut R. (from the river mouth at Houghton L. upstream to CO 100 just downstream of Higgins L.), L. James, Houghton L., Backus Cr. from the stream mouth upstream, including all tribs, Little Mud L. Flooding, Backus Cr. Flooding, and Backus L. Flooding. **Schoolcraft:** Boot, Colwell, Crooked, Gulliver, Kennedy, MacDonald, Stanley, Thunder and Worchester (Wolf) Lks. **Seney National Wildlife Refuge Pools:** contact Refuge office (906-586-9851). **Wexford:** Pleasant and Stone Ledge Lks.

Waters where up to 5 Northern Pike 24" or greater allowed in the daily possession limit

Lake St. Clair, St. Clair R., and Detroit R.

NOTE 5 - Yellow Perch

L. Erie: The daily possession limit for Yellow Perch is 50.

L. Gogebic (Gogebic and Ontonagon Cos.): The daily possession limit for Yellow Perch is 25 with no more than 5 Yellow Perch 12" or greater.

NOTE 6 - Sunfishes

Includes: Black and White Crappies, Bluegill, Green and hybrid sunfish, Longear, Pumpkinseed, Redear, Rock Bass and Warmouth.

NOTE 7 - Round Whitefish

In Lake Superior the daily possession limit shall include up to an additional 10 Round Whitefish.

NOTE 8 - Other Species

Those species not listed above and not considered trout or salmon or threatened and endangered species which are protected from harvest.

Lake Sturgeon harvest is limited to only 1 Lake Sturgeon per angler per year (April 1 – March 31). Harvest of Lake Sturgeon is limited to the waters of the state listed in the table below. Spearfishing for Lake Sturgeon is prohibited, except in Black Lake (**Cheboygan & Presque Isle Cos.**), during a special winter season; pre-registration is required. For more information, visit Michigan.gov/Sturgeon.

Mandatory Registration of Harvested Lake Sturgeon

Anglers are required to register Lake Sturgeon harvest within 24 hours. Anglers must report their harvest online (Michigan.gov/RegisterFish), on the DNR Hunt Fish app, by calling 888-636-7778, or in person at any DNR Customer Service Center (see p. 73) during normal state business hours with advanced notice of arrival. **EXCEPTION:** Lake Sturgeon harvested from Black Lake (**Cheboygan & Presque Isle Cos.**) must be immediately registered on-site with DNR personnel.

Lake Sturgeon

Hook & Line Fishing Only (except as indicated above)

Waters	Seasons	Regulations and Size Restrictions
Detroit River (Wayne, Macomb & St. Clair Cos.)	Fishing Season: July 16 – March 15	All Lake Sturgeon must be released immediately.
Lake St. Clair and St. Clair R. (Wayne, Macomb & St. Clair Cos.)	Fishing Season: July 16 – March 15 Possession Season: July 16 – Sep. 30	Between 42" – 50". Lake Sturgeon less than 42" and greater than 50" must be released immediately.
Otsego Lake (Otsego Co.)	Fishing and Possession Season: July 16 – March 15	50" minimum size limit. Lake Sturgeon less than 50" must be released immediately.
Menominee River (Menominee, Dickinson & Iron Cos.) Upstream of Sturgeon Falls Dam (pp. 24–25)	Fishing and Possession Season: 1st Sat. in Sep. – Sep. 30	60" minimum size limit. Lake Sturgeon less than 60" must be released immediately.
Menominee River (Menominee, Dickinson & Iron Cos.) From Grand Rapids Dam upstream to Sturgeon Falls Dam	Fishing Season: 1st Sat. in June – 1st Sun. in March. Possession Season: 1st Sat. in Sep. – Sep. 30	60" minimum size limit. Lake Sturgeon less than 60" must be released immediately.
Black Lake (Cheboygan & Presque Isle Cos.)	Fishing and Possession Season: 1st Sat. in Feb. through the following Mon. or until the quota is reached (whichever comes first)	No size limit. All harvested Lake Sturgeon must be reported immediately to DNR on site. Contact DNR Gaylord office (989) 732-3541 for details.
St. Marys River (Chippewa Co.) From the Soo Locks/Compensating Works downstream to the DeTour Village and Drummond Island ferry terminals to the south, and from Hay Point to Cherry Island then north to the international boundary for the northeast.	Fishing Season: July 16 – March 15	All Lake Sturgeon must be released immediately.
Portage and Torch Lakes (Houghton Co.) This includes Portage River, Portage Canal and north and south entry.	Fishing Season: July 16 – March 15	All Lake Sturgeon must be released immediately.
Ontonagon River (Ontonagon Co.) From Lake Superior up to the Victoria Dam Road	Fishing Season: July 16 – March 15	All Lake Sturgeon must be released immediately.
All Other Waters	NO FISHING SEASON	Unlawful to fish for Lake Sturgeon

The seasons, gear, waters and species where a spear, bow and arrow, or crossbow may be used as indicated in the table below and lists that follow (except as otherwise prohibited). **Spearing gear shall be limited to:** hand-propelled spear, rubber-propelled spear, and spring-propelled spear. In addition, bow and arrow, and crossbow may be used. Artificial lights may be used. It shall be unlawful to use a rubber-propelled spear or a spring-propelled spear without being submerged and the spear must be attached to a line not exceeding twenty feet in length. It is unlawful to spear any fish in a waterbody closed to fishing, except as noted in the spearing exceptions list (p. 17). Unless noted otherwise, all general regulations apply for the species listed (pp. 12–14, 20–21). Anglers should contact local enforcement offices for information concerning local weapons ordinances banning the use of bow and arrow or crossbow in some locations. Fishing in any manner other than hook-and-line is prohibited in National Park sites.

Bow- & Spearfishing Regulations (for species as indicated below)

Season	Gear	Waters (NOTE 1)	Species (NOTE 2)
Open All Year	Spear or bow and arrow or crossbow (as listed above)	ALL WATERS except: Designated Trout Lakes and Streams and Michigan-Wisconsin boundary waters. Also see Spearing Exceptions List below.	Bowfin, Bullheads, Burbot, Carp, Catfish, Cisco, Drum, Gizzard Shad, Goldfish, Grass Carp, Longnose Gar, Smelt, Suckers, Whitefish

In addition to year-round opportunities listed above, the following spearfishing provisions allow for the possession of additional species listed below:

Season	Gear	Waters (NOTE 1)	Species (NOTE 2)
Dec. 1 – March 15 (through the ice)	Hand-propelled spear (only)	ALL WATERS except: Designated Trout Lakes and Streams and Michigan-Wisconsin boundary waters. Also see Spearing Exceptions List below.	Northern Pike and Muskellunge (pp. 13–14 NOTE 4)
Species and location specific (see NOTE 3 for Northern Pike season exception)	Underwater spear (see NOTE 4)	Lake Michigan: waters north of the MI/IN border northward to the 45th Parallel excluding all waters of Grand Traverse Bay. Waters from the MI/WI border northward to the southern edge of the Ford R. mouth(45.673512, -87.143475) extending out 2 miles from shore. From Point Detour (Southern tip of the Garden Peninsula) eastward to the west edge of the mouth of the Brevort R., extending out 5 miles from shore. Lake Huron: waters south of the southernmost pier of the Thunder Bay R., extending south to the mouth of the St. Clair R. (Fort Gratiot Light) Lake Erie: waters north of the MI/OH border northward to the line extending due east and west of the most southerly point of Celeron Island in the Detroit River Lake Superior: waters from the MI/WI border eastward to the St. Marys R. (Birch Point Range front light to the most westerly point of Round Island, thence following the shore of Round Island to the most northerly point thereof, thence from the most northerly point of Round Island to Point Aux Pins Light, ON). See exceptions p. 17.	Lake Trout, Northern Pike, Walleye

NOTE 1 — All Type A and D lakes are Designated Trout Waters. All Type 1 and 2 streams, Gear Restricted Streams, Brook Trout Restoration Areas, and nearly all Type 3 and 4 streams are Designated Trout Waters (see pp. 42–65).

NOTE 2 — The term suckers refers to: suckers (longnose, white, northern hog, spotted), redhorse (all except River Redhorse, which are a protected species), buffalo (bigmouth, black), Lake Chubsucker and Quillback Carpsucker.

NOTE 3 — When using an underwater spear the possession season for Northern Pike shall be July 1 – March 15.

NOTE 4 — For underwater spearfishing Lake Trout, Northern Pike, and Walleye the following regulations apply:

- All recreational anglers who intend to engage in underwater spearfishing shall request and be issued a free annual underwater spearfishing license (See p. 2 for more information).
- To use an underwater spear in compliance with the table within this order, the angler/diver shall be fully submerged beneath the waters surface when attempting to harvest fish.

- The species and location specific size limits for Lake Trout, Northern Pike, and Walleye shall apply.
- Underwater spearfishing shall be prohibited daily from 30 minutes after sunset to 30 minutes before sunrise.
- This activity shall be prohibited within 150 feet of designated swimming areas, boat docks, boat access or egress sites and power intake tubes.
- This activity shall be prohibited where placement of a diver-down flag would restrict boater navigation or access to a boating access site.

- All spearguns shall have the bands unloaded from the spear and the safety on when divers are moving between fishing areas and when entering and exiting the water.
- Use of artificial breathing devices such as scuba, rebreather or similar devices shall be prohibited while underwater spearfishing.
- **Use of bait, attractants or decoys is prohibited while underwater spearfishing.**

Spearing Exceptions List

Waters Closed to Possession and Use of Spearing Gear

It shall be unlawful to fish by any means other than hook-and-line or to possess bow and spearing gear (p. 16) in the following waters from Nov. 1 – Nov. 30: **Muskegon:** at the port of Muskegon from the westernmost pier head extending into Lake Michigan (excluding break walls) to the easternmost pier head extending into Muskegon Lake and at the port of Whitehall/Montague from the westernmost pier head extending into Lake Michigan to the easternmost pier head extending into White Lake. **Ottawa:** the port of Grand Haven from the westernmost pier head extending into Lake Michigan to the US-31 bridge (northbound Beacon Blvd).

Waters Closed to Northern Pike and Muskellunge Spearing

It shall be unlawful to fish by any means other than hook-and-line for Northern Pike or Muskellunge in the following waters: **Alger:** Kingston L.; **Alpena & Montmorency:** Fletcher Floodwaters; **Barry:** Lower Crooked L., Thornapple L. (from McKeown Rd. to Barger Rd.); **Clare:** Budd L.; **Clinton:** L. Ovid; **Delta:** Dana L.; **Dickinson:** East, Island, South, and West Lks (all within Groveland Mines); **Iron:** Brule and Chicagon Lks., L. Emily, Paint L., Paint (Brule Isle Imp.) Pond, Stanley and Swan Lks.; **Kent:** Campau and Murray Lks.; **Keweenaw:** L. Gratiot; **Lenawee:** L. Hudson; **Schoolcraft:** Grassy and McKeever Lks.; **St. Joseph:** Long L. (Fabius Twp. T6S, R12W, S7); **Van Buren:** Bankson and Round Lks. (Keeler Twp. T4S, R16W, S31).

Waters Closed To Muskellunge Spearing

It shall be unlawful to fish for Muskellunge by any means other than hook and line in the following waters: L. Erie, L. St. Clair, Detroit R., and St. Clair R.

Lake Superior Waters Closed to Underwater Spearfishing of Lake Trout, Northern Pike and Walleye

It shall be unlawful to fish with an underwater spear in the following waters (p. 20): **Stannard Rock** (east of a line of longitude at 47.27 degrees, west of a line of longitude at -87.11 degrees, and north of a line of latitude at 47.13 degrees); **Big Reef** (east of a line

of longitude at -86.55 degrees, and south of a line of latitude at 46.93 degrees, and west of a line of longitude at -86.37 degrees, and north of a line of latitude at 46.7 degrees); **Isle Royale:** within a 4.5-mile radius of Isle Royale.

Waters with Spearing and Gaff Hook Restrictions

It shall be unlawful to take or attempt to take any species of fish with spearing gear or gaff hook from April 1 – June 15 from the following waters of **Cheboygan:** Black R., Cheboygan R., and Indian R.

Lake St. Clair Yellow Perch Spearing

Macomb, St. Clair & Wayne: A hand-propelled spear or bow and arrow or crossbow may be used to harvest Yellow Perch from Dec. 1 – March 15.

Designated Trout Streams Open To Spring Spearing

The following designated trout streams listed by county are open to the use of spearing gear from April 1 – May 31, for taking Bowfin, Bullheads, Burbot, Common Carp, Catfish, Cisco, Drum, Longnose Gar, Gizzard Shad, Goldfish, Grass Carp, Smelt, **suckers (as listed on p. 16) and whitefish: **Alcona:** Bryant Cr. from Vaughn L. downstream to Little L.; Buff Cr.; Sucker Cr. from confluence of Vincent Cr. (T27N, R8E, S9) downstream to Hubbard L. (T28N, R7E, S36); **Calhoun:** Nottawa Cr. from Calhoun Co. line (T4S, R8W, S31) upstream to T3S, R5W, S35; Rice Cr. South Branch Rice Cr. from confluence of Rice Cr. and Kalamazoo R. (T2S, R6W, S25) upstream to Concord Rd. (Jackson Co.); **Chippewa:** Trout Cr. downstream of Big Trout L. (T42N, R3E, S31); Prentiss Cr. (T42N, R2E.); **Delta:** Squaw Cr. downstream of Co. Rd 513; **Mackinac:** Doe Cr. (T43N, R10W); Foley Cr. downstream of I-75; Hoban Cr. downstream of State St.; Hudson Cr. (T41N, R11W, S8); Martineau Cr. downstream of I-75; McClouds Cr.; Milakokia R. from Milakokia L. downstream to Heinz L.; Norton Cr. from M-135 downstream to South Manistique L.; Nunns Cr. downstream of Highway M-134; Pearson's Cr. (T42N, R1W and R1E); Rabbits Back Cr. downstream of Mackinac Trail; Scrams Cr. (T42N, R11W, S11); Taylor Cr. (T43N, R12W, S2, 11, 12 and 13); **Mason:** Sable R. from Freesoil Rd. downstream to Custer Rd. (T20N, R16W, S22); **Van Buren:** Dowagiack R. and tributaries upstream of 50th Street (T4S, R15W, S35); Lake of the Woods Outlet to confluence with Dowagiack R. (T45N, R15W, S34).

Great Lakes Trout & Salmon Regulations

The regulations in this table apply to fishing on the Great Lakes for the following species: Atlantic Salmon, Brook Trout (**NOTE 1**), Brown Trout, Chinook Salmon, Coho Salmon, Lake Trout (**NOTE 3**), Pink Salmon, Rainbow Trout (Steelhead) and Splake (**NOTE 3**). See regulations that pertain to fishing for trout and salmon on inland waters, pp. 42–65.

Seasons by Water Type	Minimum Size	Daily Possession Limit (NOTES 1, 2, 3)
Open All Year: (NOTE 3) L. Superior, L. Michigan, L. Erie, L. Huron, L. St. Clair, St. Marys R., St. Clair R. and Detroit R.	10" (NOTES 1, 3) (also see Lake Trout and Splake Regulations table, p. 21)	Great Lakes, L. St. Clair, St. Marys R., St. Clair R., and Detroit R.: 5 total in any combination; no more than 3 of any one species, except up to 5 Coho, Chinook or Pink Salmon allowed. On the St. Marys R.: 5 additional Pink Salmon allowed from last Sat. in April – Sept. 30.

NOTE 1 — Brook Trout: For L. Superior, the minimum size limit for Brook Trout is 20" and daily possession limit is 1 fish. Within 4.5 miles of Isle Royale (Isle Royale National Park waters), catch-and-immediate-release; no possession.

NOTE 2 — Drowned River Mouth Lakes: On the following inland waters trout and salmon regulations are as follows: 5 total trout and salmon in any combination; no more than 3 of any one species, except up to 5 Coho or Chinook Salmon; minimum size limit is 10"; fishing season and possession season are open all year. For all other species of trout and salmon, the possession season is open all year. **Allegan:** Kalamazoo and Silver Lks. **Benzie:** Betsie L. **Charlevoix:** L. Charlevoix (including Round L.) **Manistee:** Arcadia, Manistee, and Portage Lks. **Mason:** Pere Marquette L. **Muskegon:** Duck, Mona, Muskegon, and White Lks. **Oceana:** Pentwater, Silver, and Stony Lks. **Ottawa:** Macatawa and Pigeon Lks.

NOTE 3 — Lake Trout and Splake Regulations: Lake Trout and Splake regulations for the Great Lakes are listed by Lake Trout Management Unit (see Lake Trout and Splake Regulations tables, p. 21). Lake Trout and Splake have a combined daily possession limit, in any combination. To help identify Management Unit boundaries, a few major ports are listed for each. The map on p. 20 provides a graphic to further define the boundaries. For a complete description of Lake Trout Management Unit boundaries, contact any DNR Customer Service Center (p. 73) or check online at Michigan.gov/DNR.



Help us build the first ever public fish cleaning station on Lake St. Clair

There are many public fish cleaning stations in Michigan, but not on Lake St. Clair. Angling intensity on Lake St. Clair is 14 times that of Lakes Huron, Michigan and Superior combined. The catch rate is two times as high.

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Michigan's creel survey program

The Michigan creel survey program — named after the baskets used to collect fish, called “creels” — collects fish data. Creel clerks collect information from anglers about the length of fishing trips and the fish they targeted and caught, as well as take samples from fish. Biologists use this data to study fish populations, evaluate stocking, and measure the impact of fishing regulations. Creel clerks can also answer questions, help identify fish, or make note of any concerns.

Thank you for your participation!



● LOOK FOR ORANGE: TRAP NETS

Commercial fishing is an active industry in Michigan waters, feeding Michiganders with fresh, local, and sustainable wild-caught fish.

- ◆ Orange or black flags or buoys indicate trap nets below surface. Nets can cover 1+ acres on lake bottom and can be dangerous if snagged.
- ◆ Single flag marks shallower end of net near shore. Double flag marks deeper end farther from shore.

STAY SAFE

- ◆ Pull in fishing gear, **TURN AWAY** from visible marker, and navigate out of the area:
- ◆ If additional flags are visible, **DO NOT** pass between markers. Give a wide berth.
- ◆ Additional flags could be out of sight. Waves, glare, fog, or low light also limit visibility.
- ◆ Stay mindful in surrounding waters for more nets or floating ropes. Give a wide berth.

IF YOU GET TANGLED

- 1) **TURN OFF** engine or put boat in neutral.
- 2) **CUT** yourself free using wire cutters. Label your gear if left behind.
- 3) **MARK** location on GPS. Attach buoy or jug to mark net for officials. Leave net in water.
- 4) **REPORT** GPS coordinates to agencies:
 - ◆ Michigan Department of Natural Resources (MDNR) hotline: (800) 292-7800
 - ◆ Great Lakes Indian Fish and Wildlife Commission (GLIFWC): (715) 685-2113
 - ◆ Chippewa Ottawa Resource Authority (CORA): (906) 632-0043



MICHIGAN STATE UNIVERSITY



Michigan Sea Grant is a collaborative effort of the University of Michigan and Michigan State University and part of the NOAA-National Sea Grant network of 34 university-based programs.



Weekly Fishing Report

Discover the latest fishing hot spots and tips on catching specific species throughout Michigan—all courtesy of the DNR's Weekly Fishing Report! Scan the QR code or visit Michigan.gov/FishingReport to sign up or view past reports.

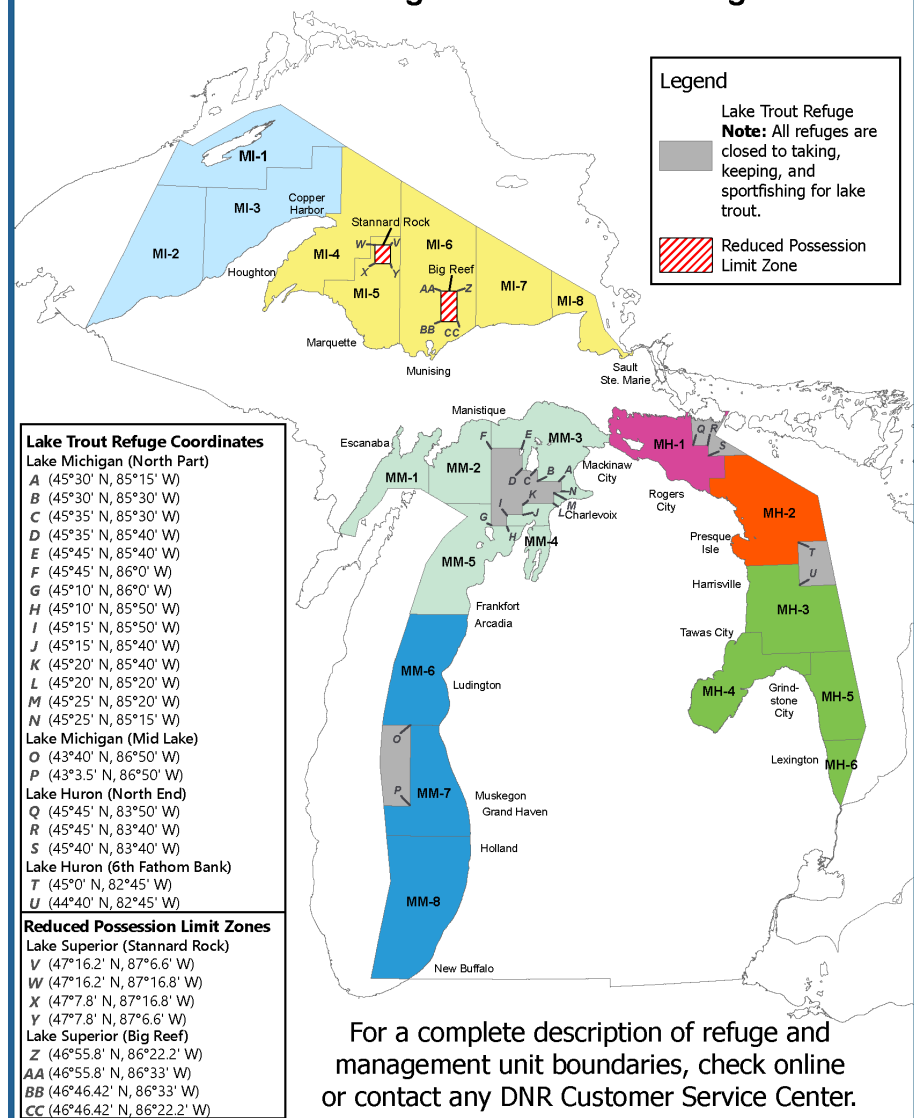


Lake Trout & Splake Regulations

See below and p. 21 for Lake Trout and Splake size limit, possession season, and daily possession limit information. Lake Trout and Splake are treated as the same fish for the purpose of Great Lakes fisheries management because they are so similar in appearance.

Map (below) and tables (p. 21) are color-coded by unit regulations. Any changes will be posted on the DNR website (Michigan.gov/Fishing) and in a pre-recorded message at 888-367-7060.

Lake Trout Management Units & Refuges



Lake Superior

Lake Trout Management Unit, Major Ports/Areas	Possession Season	Size Restrictions (inches)	Lake Trout and Splake Combined Daily Possession Limit
MI 1-3: Windigo, Rock Harbor, Black River Harbor, Ontonagon, Upper Entry, Cooper Harbor	Open All Year	The minimum size limit for Lake Trout and Splake shall be 15"; the daily possession limit shall not include more than 1 Lake Trout 34" or greater.	3
MI 4-8: Big Bay, Marquette, Au Train, Munising, Grand Marais, Keweenaw Bay, Whitefish Bay NOTE: for Stannard Rock (MI-5) and Big Reef (MI-6) see below.	Open All Year	The minimum size limit for Lake Trout and Splake shall be 15"; the daily possession limit shall not include more than 1 Lake Trout 34" or greater.	5
Stannard Rock in MI-5 and Big Reef in MI-6, see pp. 9, 20	Open All Year	The minimum size limit for Lake Trout and Splake shall be 15"	1

Lake Huron

Lake Trout Management Unit, Major Ports/Areas	Possession Season	Size Restrictions (inches)	Lake Trout and Splake Combined Daily Possession Limit
MH 1: DeTour, Cedarville, St. Ignace, Mackinaw City, Cheboygan, Rogers City	Jan. 1 – Sep. 30 (Lake Trout and Splake)	The minimum size limit for Lake Trout and Splake shall be 15".	3
MH-2: Presque Isle, Rockport, Alpena, Black R.	Jan. 1 – Sep. 30 (Lake Trout and Splake)	The minimum size limit for Lake Trout and Splake shall be 15".	3
MH 3-6: Harrisville, Tawas, Grindstone, Harbor Beach, Lexington	Open All Year (Lake Trout and Splake)	The minimum size limit for Lake Trout and Splake shall be 15".	3

Lake Michigan

Lake Trout Management Unit, Major Ports/Areas	Possession Season	Size Restrictions (inches)	Lake Trout and Splake Combined Daily Possession Limit
MM 1-5: Menominee, Escanaba, Manistique, Harbor Springs, Charlevoix, Elk Rapids, Traverse City, Northport, Leland, Frankfort, Platte Bay	Jan. 1 – Sep. 30 (Lake Trout and Splake)	The minimum size limit for Lake Trout and Splake shall be 15".	2
MM 6-8: Arcadia, Manistee, Ludington, Grand Haven, Holland, New Buffalo	Open All Year (Lake Trout and Splake)	The minimum size limit for Lake Trout and Splake shall be 15".	3

Regulations for Frogs, Toads, Salamanders, Turtles, Lizards & Snakes

Amphibians and reptiles MAY NOT be shot with firearms (including spring, air, or gas propelled), bow and arrow, blowgun or crossbow.

The following shall not be taken or possessed except as authorized by the Director of the Department of Natural Resources: **Blanding's, spotted, wood, and eastern box turtles; black rat snake, Butler's garter snake, eastern fox snake, copper-bellied water snake, Kirtland's snake, queen snake, smooth green snake, and eastern massasauga rattlesnake; boreal chorus frog, Blanchard's cricket frog, pickerel frog, and Fowler's toad; mudpuppy; small-mouthed salamander, marbled salamander, six-lined racerunner, western lesser siren, northern two-lined salamander, northern dusky salamander, and mink frog;** all reptile eggs; and amphibians and reptiles protected under Part 365 (Endangered Species) of 1994 P.A. 451. For further information check online at Michigan.gov/Fishing or contact any Customer Service Center, see p. 73.

Personal Use: A fishing license is required to take amphibians and reptiles for personal use. Reptiles and amphibians may not be bought, sold or offered for sale.

Hand, trap, nets, seines (up to 12 x 4 feet overall dimensions), and hook-and-line may be used. Set lines may not be used to take turtles.

Frogs may be speared but NOT with the aid of an artificial light.

Traps must have a plate or tag attached bearing the name and address of the user in legible English.

For taking turtles, no more than 3 traps may be used, mesh traps must be no less than 1" mesh, and traps must be set to allow turtles to surface and breathe.

It is illegal to possess or transport in the field, dressed or processed reptiles or amphibians that cannot be measured or identified.

Snapping turtle carapace length: to obtain the carapace (top of shell) length, use a flexible tape to measure from the nuchal scute (the scute directly behind the turtle's head) to the base of the notch where the two most posterior scutes meet (see image below).

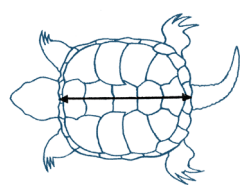


Image courtesy of PA Fish & Boat Commission.

Species	Season	Minimum Size (inches)	Daily Possession Limit	Total Possession Limit
Frogs, toads, salamanders	Last Sat. in May – Nov. 15	none	10 in any combination	10 in any combination
Snapping turtles (NOTE 1)	July 15 – Sept. 15	13" minimum carapace length	1	2 total
Softshell turtles	July 15 – Sept. 15	none	1	2 total
All other turtles (painted, musk, map, red-eared slider); snakes and lizards	Open All Year	none	3 in combination (However, no more than 2 turtles and no more than 1 of any one turtle species)	6 total in combination (However, no more than 4 turtles and no more than 2 of any one turtle species)

NOTE 1 — Carapace length: use a flexible tape to measure from the shell behind the turtle's head to the posterior end of the shell (see image above).

The following restrictions apply for the species, seasons and waters listed below:

- Nets and seines may not be fished within 100' of any dam.
- Hand nets may be of any circumference and handle length, except for taking minnows (p. 10).
- Dip nets may not exceed 9' x 9' square and permit is required if equipment is to be left overnight. Permits are available from local DNR Customer Service Center (p. 73).
- There is a two-gallon daily possession limit on Smelt.
- Seines may not exceed 12' x 4' and may only be used for minnows except under a scientific collector's permit issued by the DNR.
- **NOTE:** Check **Definitions and Terms** (pp. 8-9) for more information.

General Netting Regulations

Season	Gear	*Species	Waters
Mar 1 – May 31	Hand Net	Bowfin, Carp, Goldfish, Gizzard Shad, Longnose Gar, Smelt, Suckers	All Great Lakes, L. St. Clair, St. Clair R., Detroit R., and St. Marys R. including all tributaries to those waters from the mouth to ½ mile upstream (except that Thompson Cr. ([Schoolcraft Co.], is closed). See List A for additional inland streams open to hand netting.
Mar 20 – May 31	Dip Net	Bowfin, Carp, Goldfish, Gizzard Shad, Longnose Gar, Smelt, Suckers	All Lower Peninsula and Upper Peninsula streams, except Designated Trout Streams. See List B for additional streams closed to dip netting.
Open all year	Seine, Hand Net, Dip Net	Minnows	All waters, except Designated Trout Lakes & Streams and those waters closed to minnow harvest (see p. 10).
Open all year	Cast Net	Alewife, Minnows, Smelt, Gizzard Shad	Great Lakes, L. St. Clair, St. Clair R., Detroit R., and St. Marys R.

*The term "suckers" refers to: suckers (longnose, white, northern hog, spotted), redbone (all except River Redbone, which are a protected species), buffalo (bigmouth, black), Lake Chubsucker, and Quillback Carpsucker. The term "minnows" refers to small baitfish used as bait: chubs, shiners, dace, stonerollers, sculpins (muddlers), mudminnows, and suckers. Review the netting exceptions list below and p. 24 for regulations that differ from those listed in the table above.

Netting Exceptions

LIST A – Additional Inland Waters Open to Hand Netting

The following inland waters are open to use of hand nets from March 1–May 31 for Bowfin, carp, Goldfish, Gizzard Shad, Longnose Gar, Smelt and suckers:

Alger: Towes Cr.; W. Br. Whitefish R. from Sea Lamprey Barrier (T44N, R21W, S29) downstream 500' to posted signs; **Charlevoix:** L. Charlevoix and trib to 1/2 mile upstream; **Chippewa:** Trout Cr. down from Big Trout L. (T42N, R3E, S31); Prentiss Cr. (T42N, R2E); **Delta:** Days R. from sea lamprey barrier downstream for 500'; Rapid R. from Rapid River Falls (T42N, R21W, S19) down to Co. Rd S15; Escanaba R. from mouth to 1st dam upstream of US-2; Ford R. down from Jaeger Rd.; **Houghton:** Portage L. and tribs to 1/2 mile upstream; N. and S. Portage Canal and tribs to 1/2 mile upstream; Torch L. and tribs to 1/2 mile upstream; **Luce:** Little Two Hearted R. from mouth upstream to bridge on Co. Rd. 412 (T50N, R9W, S25); **Mackinac:** Doe Cr. (T43N, R10W, S9); Foley Cr. down from I-75; Hoban Cr. down from State St.; Hudson Cr. (T41N, R11W, S8); Martineau Cr. down from I-75; McClouds Cr.; Milakokia R., Milakokia L. down to Heinz L.; Norton Cr. from M-135 down to S. Manistique L.; Nunns Cr. from M-134 to mouth; Pearson's Cr. (T42N, R1W, R1E); Rabbits Back Cr. down from Mackinac

Trail; Scrams Cr. (T42N, R11W, S11); Taylor Cr. (T43N, R12W, S2, 11, 12, 13); **Manistee:** Little Bear Cr. down from Bear L. to trunkline US-31; **Menominee:** Big Cedar R. down from mouth of Elwood Cr. (T35N, R25W, S11).

LIST B – Inland Streams Closed to Dip Netting

It shall be unlawful to take or attempt to take any species of fish with dip nets on the following streams: **Arenac:** Au Gres R. from Saginaw Bay upstream to M-65 (T22N, R5E, S26); Rifle R. from Steve's Rd. (T19N, R5E, S9) upstream; **Benzie:** Cold Cr. from Crystal L. (T26N, R15W, S26) upstream; **Grand Traverse:** Unnamed Cr. from Green L. (T26N, R12W, S20) upstream to Bridges L.; **Iosco:** Au Gres R. from Saginaw Bay upstream to M-65 (T22N, R5E, S26); **Leelanau:** Houdek Cr. from North Lake Leelanau (T31N, R12W, S35) upstream; **Monroe:** Huron R. from L. Erie upstream to Belleville Dam; Stony Cr. from L. Erie upstream to Finzel Rd. (T55, R8E, S23); **Wayne:** Huron R. from L. Erie upstream to Belleville Dam.

Michigan and Wisconsin share several boundary waters and while the states strive to have consistent regulations across the border there are some discrepancies. Anglers are strongly encouraged to familiarize themselves on fishing regulations for both states. Anglers with a valid Michigan or Wisconsin fishing license can fish either state's boundary waters, however, anglers are required to adhere to the state-specific regulations based on their location while fishing these shared boundary waters. For example, anglers fishing in Michigan waters must follow Michigan's fishing regulations and anglers fishing within Wisconsin's portion of the boundary waters must follow Wisconsin's fishing regulations.

The interstate boundary waters in which fishing is to be governed by the special regulations are: The **L. Michigan waters between the breakwalls at the mouth of the Menominee R. beginning at an imaginary line drawn between the most lakeward point of each breakwall. Menominee R., its sloughs and impoundments** (Menominee, Dickinson, Iron Cos., Michigan; Florence, Marinette Cos., Wisconsin); **Brule R.** (Iron Co., Michigan; Florence and Forest Cos., Wisconsin); **Brule Island Impoundment**, upstream to a line running east-west through the first island upstream from the junction of the Brule and Paint Rivers (Iron Co., Michigan; Florence Co., Wisconsin); **Smoky L.** (Iron Co., Michigan; Vilas Co., Wisconsin); **Norwood L., Lac Vieux Desert, Crystal L., Mill L., Big Bateau L., Mamie L.** (Cisco Chain), **West Bay L.** (Cisco Chain), **Big L.** (Cisco Chain), **Crampton L., Plum L., Tenderfoot L., Roach L., Little Presque Isle L., Cyrus L., Basin L., Stateline L.** (Gogebic Co., Michigan; Vilas Co., Wisconsin); **East Fork Montreal R. up to the mouth of Layman Cr.** (Gogebic Co., Michigan; Iron Co., Wisconsin); **Montreal R.** (Gogebic Co., Michigan; Iron Co., Wisconsin).

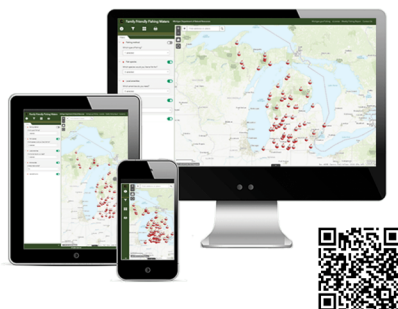
NOTE: Cowboy Lake (Dickinson Co.), west of Iron Mountain, is NOT part of the MI-WI Boundary Waters.

Legal fishing methods

- All residents of Michigan and Wisconsin holding a resident sport fishing license from their respective state, or residents of states other than Michigan and Wisconsin holding a sport fishing license issued by either Michigan or Wisconsin may fish in the boundary waters.
- Up to 3 lines per person with a total of 3 hooks or baits may be used.
- Lines must be attended at all times.
- Crayfish may not be possessed or used for bait on Michigan-Wisconsin boundary waters.
- Dip nets not exceeding 9 feet square or in diameter, without walls may be used in the Menominee R. from April 1 – May 14 for taking of suckers, redbhorse, carp, Smelt, and Burbot (except from Hattie Street Bridge in Marinette-Menominee to Menominee Dam upstream and within 200 feet of all other dams).
- Fish shanties used in ice fishing must be legibly marked with the name and address of owner, and persons placing a shanty on these waters shall remove the shanty by midnight of March 15. In Wisconsin boundary waters, fish shanty doors cannot be locked from inside during occupancy.

Find your family's new fishing spot!

The Family Friendly Fishing Waters map has easy to access, family-friendly locations with a high likelihood for catching fish. Scan the QR code or visit Michigan.gov/Things-To-Do/Fishing/Where/FFFW.



Michigan-Wisconsin Boundary Water Regulations

(Hook & Line Only — Use of spear, bow & arrow and crossbow prohibited)

Species	Waters	Seasons	Minimum Size (inches)	Daily Possession Limit
Trout, Salmon see (NOTE 1)	Smoky L., Montreal R., and Menominee R. mouths to 1st dam.	Open All Year	10"	5
Trout, Salmon see (NOTE 1)	Menominee R. and Montreal R. above 1st dam. Brule R. mouth to US-2	Last Sat. in April – Sep. 30	7"	5
Trout, Salmon see (NOTE 1)	Brule R. above US-2 bridge	Last Sat. in April – Sep. 30	Brook Trout 8" Brown Trout 12"	5
Smallmouth & Largemouth Bass	All boundary waters	Open All Year	Catch-and-Immediate-Release	Catch-and-Immediate-Release
Smallmouth & Largemouth Bass	All boundary waters	3rd Sat. in June – Dec. 31	14"	5 in any combination
Walleye, Sauger	All boundary waters except rivers and impoundments	1st Sat. in May – March 1	15"	5 in any combination
Walleye, Sauger	All rivers and impoundments	March 2 – Fri. before 1st Sat. in May	15"	1
Walleye, Sauger	All rivers and impoundments	1st Sat. in May – March 1	15"	5 in any combination (See NOTE 2)
Northern Pike	All boundary waters	1st Sat. in May – March 1	none	5
Bluegill, Crappie, Sunfish, Yellow Perch	All boundary waters	Open All Year	none	25 in any combination
Muskellunge (including Tiger Muskellunge)	All boundary waters	Open All Year	Catch-and-Immediate-Release	Catch-and-Immediate-Release
Muskellunge (including Tiger Muskellunge)	All boundary waters	1st Sat. in June – Dec. 31	50" (Mandatory Registration)	(See NOTE 3)
Lake Sturgeon	Menominee R. (upstream of Grand Rapids Dam)	1st Sat. in Sep. – Sep. 30	60" (Mandatory Registration)	(See NOTES 3 & 4)
Lake Sturgeon	Menominee R. from Grand Rapids Dam upstream to Sturgeon Falls Dam	1st Sat. in June - 1st Sat. in March	Catch-and-Immediate-Release	Catch-and-Immediate-Release
Channel Catfish	All boundary waters	Open All Year	none	10
Cisco, Lake Whitefish, Round Whitefish	All boundary waters	Open All Year	none	10 in any combination
All others	All boundary waters	Open All Year	none	none

NOTE 1 — No fishing is allowed during the closed season in the Brule R. upstream from U.S. Hwy 2 Bridge (T41N, R32W, S9) Iron Co., MI and the Montreal R. above Superior Falls flowage.

NOTE 2 — On Lac Vieux Desert, the daily limit for Walleye is 3 with a minimum size limit of 18".

NOTE 3 — Muskellunge and Lake Sturgeon harvest are both limited to 1 per angler per year (April 1 – March 31). Anglers are required to register Lake Sturgeon and Muskellunge harvest within 24 hours online, in person, or by phone. For more information see p. 9.

NOTE 4 — Any Lake Sturgeon caught that may not be legally possessed must be immediately released unharmed back into the water.

Michigan-Indiana Border Lakes

Residents of Indiana or Michigan may fish the whole lake, but must abide by the regulations in the waters they are fishing. Nonresident license holders (for either state) may only fish in the waters under which the jurisdiction applies for that nonresident license. Nonresidents would need Indiana and Michigan nonresident licenses to fish both sides.

South Clear Lake - Indiana, St. Joseph Co./Michigan, Berrien Co., **Indiana Lake** - Indiana, Elkhart Co./Michigan, Cass Co., **Fish Lake** - Indiana, La Grange Co./Michigan, St. Joseph Co., **Lake George** - Indiana, Steuben Co./Michigan, Branch Co., **Long Lake** - Indiana, Steuben Co./Michigan, Hillsdale Co.

Sylvania Wilderness Area Regulations

The following lakes in Gogebic Co. are subject to special regulations: Banks, East Bear, West Bear, Clark, Corey, Cub, Deer Island, Dorothy, Elsie, Fisher, Florence, Germain, Glimmerglass, Golden Silence, Hay, Helen, High, Honey, Jay, Johnston Springs, Katherine, Kerr, Liluis, Lois, Loon, Louise, Marsh, Moss, Mountain, Snap Jack, Trapper and Whitefish. NOTE: Crooked Lake is covered under general statewide fishing regulations (p. 12).

Seasons: Statewide seasons apply for all fish species, except that no fishing shall be allowed before the last Sat. in April or after Oct. 31 of each year.

Size Limits

- Lake Trout: minimum 30"
- Walleye: minimum 20"
- Northern Pike: minimum 30"
- All other species: no size limit

Possession Limits

- Largemouth and Smallmouth Bass must be returned immediately to the water without injury and may not be possessed on the special regulation lakes of the Sylvania Wilderness Area.
- Northern Pike, Walleye and Lake Trout: not more than 1 fish of any of these species.
- All other species: 10 singly or in any combination of species.

Method of Take

- Hook-and-line fishing only, not to exceed 3 lines to which may be attached a total of 6 hooks on all lines. All hooks attached to a manufactured artificial lure shall be counted as 1 hook.
- Only artificial lures with barbless hooks may be used. "Artificial lure" means any lure that is man-made, in imitation of or as a substitute for natural bait, used to attract fish for the purpose of taking them, and shall include artificial flies. Barbless hooks are defined as a hook from which all barbs have been deleted when manufactured, filed off, or pinched down.
- Live bait, dead or preserved bait or organic or processed food may not be used or possessed at any time on special regulation Sylvania Wilderness Area lakes.



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4468800000000



A fish disease called Viral Hemorrhagic Septicemia (VHS) has been found in our state. You can help slow the spread of this and other fish diseases by following the regulations on this page. The regulations in effect focus on the use of fish species which are known to be susceptible to VHS. Visit Michigan.gov/VHS for more information.

Baitfish Exclusion Zones

The following locations are vital to hatchery operations and require greater protection. Therefore, baitfish shall not be used or possessed on the following waters:

Benzie: Brundage Cr. and tribs., Kinney Cr. and Stanley Cr., from its confluence with the Platte R. (T26N, R13W, S7), to their headwaters, including Brundage Spring Pond.

Chippewa: Pendills L. (T47N, R4W, S25, 26) including tributary Pendills Cr. downstream to its confluence with L. Superior (T47N, R4W, S28). Sullivan Cr. from its headwaters (T46N, R4W, S32) downstream to its confluence with the N. Br. of the Pine R. (T45N, R4W, S23). Viddian Cr. from its headwaters (T47N, R4W, S32) downstream to its confluence with Pendills Cr. (T47N, R4W, S28).

Marquette: Cherry Cr. from the location of the Cherry Creek Rd. (T47N, R24W, S18) to the headwaters at County Rd 480 (T47N, R25W, S22).

Wexford: Slagle Cr. from M-37 upstream.

General Statewide Provisions

1. A person shall not stock baitfish, live fish or roe in public waters of the state prior to receiving a Fish Stocking Permit from the DNR and the permit must be in possession when transporting and stocking the fish.
2. It is unlawful to import any uncertified live, dead, preserved, frozen and cut baitfish species found on the list of VHS Fish Species (top right) that are not labeled with their scientific and common name, location of capture, and testing status including the testing certification number. View Fisheries Order 245 at Michigan.gov/Fishing.
3. Fish caught in a waterbody should only be released into the waterbody where originally caught and not transferred into another location where the fish could not have freely moved to.
4. All baitfish or fish collected for personal use as bait or cut bait shall only be used for fishing purposes in the original waters of collection and must be used on a hook.
5. A person who trailers a boat over land shall drain all water from the live well(s) and the bilge of their boat upon leaving any body of water.
6. It shall be unlawful to purchase and use baitfish, crayfish, or other live organisms from any location not licensed under Part 487 of 1994 PA 451 including, but not limited to, pet shops and live fish markets.

VHS Fish Species (susceptible to VHS)

Anchovies	Lake Whitefish
Atlantic Herring	Largemouth Bass
Atlantic Menhaden	Muskellunge
Atlantic Salmon	Northern Pike
Black Bullhead	N. Redbelly Dace
Black Crappie	Pacific Herring
Bluegill	Pumpkinseed
Bluntnose Minnow	Rainbow Smelt
Brook Trout	Rainbow Trout
Brown Bullhead	Redear Sunfish
Channel Catfish	Rock Bass
Cisco (Lake Herring)	Sand Shiner
Common Shiner	Smallmouth Bass
Creek Chub	Spotfin Shiner
Emerald Shiner	Spottail Shiner
Eulachon	Walleye
Flathead Minnow	Warmouth
Flathead Catfish	White Bass
Gizzard Shad	White Crappie
Golden Shiner	White Sucker
Green Sunfish	Yellow Bullhead
Hybrid Sunfish	Yellow Perch
Lake Trout	

Help Michigan's waters stay world-class, put unused bait in the trash!

VHS Clinical Signs

Photos from Dr. Mohamed Faisal, MSU

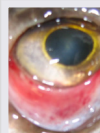
Hemorrhagic areas on skin

Gizzard Shad,
Lake St. Clair



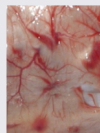
Hemorrhagic areas near eye

Yellow Perch,
Lake St. Clair



Typical hemorrhagic areas in swim bladder

Yellow Perch,
Lake St. Clair



Hemorrhagic areas in muscle tissue

Yellow Perch,
Lake St. Clair



Exceptions to General Regulations by County

Many water bodies have special regulations that differ from the general Hook & Line Fishing (p. 12), General Netting (p. 23), and Bow- and Spearfishing regulations (pp. 16–17). The following is a list of waters, organized by county, with special regulations that are **NOT included in the following sections of the Michigan Fishing Regulations**: General Regulations tables cited above; Special Northern Pike and Muskellunge Regulations (pp. 13–14); Michigan-Wisconsin Boundary Regulations (pp. 24–25); and Sylvania Wilderness Area Regulations (p. 26).

Alger

Rock R. closed to fishing from dam to lower foot bridge downstream from M-28 April 1 – June 30. **Duck and Echo Lks. (Grand Island),** catch-and-release on Smallmouth Bass. **Pictured Rocks National Lakeshore** (contact park for regulation specifics 906-387-3700).

Allegan

Swan Cr. from mouth upstream to the dam on 118th Ave. restricted to only one single-pointed, unweighted hook no larger than 1/2" from point to shank.

Antrim

Intermediate R. closed to all fishing from Bellaire Dam to M-88 Bridge April 1 – May 14. **Torch R.** from the Crystal Beach Rd Bridge downstream to **L. Skegemog** including **Rapid R.** up to Aarwood Rd Bridge - from May 1 – July 1, it shall be unlawful to use other than one single-pointed unweighted hook measuring 1/2-inch or less from point to shank.

Arenac

Saganing Cr. (upstream from State Rd.) and **Pine R.** (upstream from State Rd.) closed to fishing March 16 – Fri. before last Sat. in April.

Baraga

Lakes of Craig Lake State Park (Clair, Craig, Crooked, Keewaydin, Nelligan, Teddy, and Thomas Lks.) artificial lures only; Northern Pike, Muskellunge, Largemouth Bass, and Smallmouth Bass must be released, minimum size on Walleye is 15", no size limit on other species; daily possession limit on Walleye is 2; otherwise, all general rules apply. Motorboats of all types prohibited on all except **Thomas and Keewaydin Lks.; Sturgeon R.** from Prickett Dam downstream to mouth of **Clear Cr.** (T50N, R35W, S12) closed to all fishing April 1 – June 30.

Barry

Williams L. open season is last Sat. in April – Dec. 15, catch-and-immediate-release only.

Bay

Kawkawlin R. and **all tributaries upstream** of Euclid Ave., and **Saganing Cr.** (upstream from State Rd.) and **Pine R.** (upstream from State Rd.) closed to fishing March 16 – Fri. before the last Sat. in April. On **Kawkawlin R.** downstream from Euclid Ave. and **Saginaw R.** from upstream of the West Center Street

(Douglas G. Schenk) Bridge and **all tributaries**, the following regulations apply from March 16 – Fri. before the last Sat. in April: Anglers are limited to using unweighted single-pointed hooks, natural bait, and sinkers or weights or artificial lures with unweighted single-pointed hooks.

Benzie

Platte R. restricted to only one single-pointed, unweighted hook no larger than 1/2" from point to shank; closed to fishing within 300 ft. of upper (hatchery) weir and lower weir whenever either weir is in place; closed to fishing from US-31 bridge at Veteran's Park downstream to **Platte L.** Jan. 1 – March 31. **Betsie R.** Homestead Dam closed to fishing Nov. 16 – July 31 within 100 feet of lamprey barrier and fish passage facility (T25N, R15W, S2). **Betsie R.** Homestead Dam closed to fishing from August 1 – November 15 within 300 feet of the lamprey barrier and fish passage facility (T25N, R15W, S2). On all waters of the **Betsie R.** special artificial lure regulations apply (see p. 8).

Berrien

Townsend Cr. (T6S, R17W, S19), and the mouth area of **L. Chapin**, to a point 100 yards below the **Townsend Cr.** mouth into **L. Chapin**, it is unlawful to use other than one single-pointed, unweighted hook measuring 1/2" or less from point to shank.

Calhoun

Harts L. catch-and-release only for all species.

Cass

Corey, Little Crooked and Stone Lks. bass minimum size limit is 10". **Indiana L.** no possession of Cisco (Lake Herring).

Charlevoix

Medusa Cr. and area of **L. Michigan** for a radius of 100' of mouth closed to fishing when weir is in place. **Boyne R.** from mouth upstream to dam (T32N, R5W, S5) restricted to one single-pointed, unweighted hook no larger than 1/2" from point to shank. On **L. Michigan**, within one-half mile of the following islands of the **Beaver Island Archipelago: Beaver, Garden, High and Hog** the possession season for Largemouth and Smallmouth Bass is July 1 – Dec. 31 and open to bass catch-and-immediate-release all year.

Cheboygan

Cheboygan R. from the south end of the outermost breakwall at Mullett L. downstream to Cheboygan Dam, and Black R. from Alverno Dam downstream to its confluence with the Cheboygan R. the possession season for Walleye shall be May 15 – March 15. **Cheboygan R., Indian R., or Black R.** unlawful to fish during April 1 – June 15 with spear, bow and arrow, crossbow, dip net or gaff. **Black R.** between Kleber Dam and Red Bridge (T35N, R1E, S5) unlawful to fish in any manner during April 1 – June 15. **Lower Black R.** from Alverno Dam down to Mograin Bridge, no fishing April 1 – May 14. **Black L. and tributaries** no commercial minnow take; Sturgeon fishing prohibited except under special season (p. 15).

Chippewa

Potagannissing R. from Potagannissing Dam downstream to Maxton Rd. (T42N, R6E, S15) closed to fishing March 16 – May 14.

Crawford

Jones and Wakeley Lks. open season last Sat. in April – Sept. 30, catch-and-release fishing with artificial lures only. It shall be unlawful to use or possess live bait, dead bait or organic or processed food at any time on the shore or water.

Delta

Rapid R. Borrow Pit (Stockyard Pond, T40N, R21W, S5) closed to fishing all year.

Dickinson

See Michigan-Wisconsin Boundary Waters Regulations (pp. 24–25). **Fumee L.** county ordinance currently prohibits access for the purpose of fishing.

Emmet

Bear R. from northern edge of foot bridge north of Lake Street upstream to Lake Street Dam (T34N, R5W, S6) restricted to one single-pointed, unweighted hook no larger than 1/2" from point to shank.

Genesee

Flint R. downstream from Holloway Dam and all tributaries, the following regulations apply from March 16 – Fri. before the last Sat. in April: Anglers are limited to using unweighted single-pointed hooks, natural bait, and sinkers or weights or artificial lures with unweighted single-pointed hooks.

Gogebic

L. Gogebic the daily possession limit for Yellow Perch is 25 with no more than 5 Yellow Perch 12" or greater. See **Michigan-Wisconsin Boundary Waters Regulations** (pp. 24–25) and **Sylvania Wilderness Area Regulations** (p. 26).

Grand Traverse

Boardman R. closed to fishing whenever weir is in place from the downstream side of the Front Street Bridge to the upstream side of the pedestrian bridge in the vicinity of the **Boardman R.** weir in Traverse City. **Arbutus** and **Spider Lks.** bass minimum size limit is 10".

Ionia

Woodard L. bass minimum size limit is 10".

Iosco

Au Gres R. from 50' upstream of Allen Rd. bridge to 500' downstream closed to all fishing March 16 – Fri. before last Sat. in April. **E. Br. Au Gres R.** between DNR lamprey barrier and Legget Rd. closed to fishing Dec. 1 – Fri. before last Sat. in April. **Au Sable R.** from Foote Dam downstream to the downstream edge of the apron of the dam closed to fishing all year.

Iron

See Michigan-Wisconsin Boundary Waters Regulations (pp. 24–25). **L. Ottawa** no possession of bass. **Fire and Indian Lks.** bass possession limit is 1 fish and minimum size limit is 18".

Kalkaska

Cub L. (T27N, R5W, S19) bass minimum size limit is 10". **Torch R.** from the Crystal Beach Rd Bridge downstream to **L. Skegemog** including **Rapid R.** up to Aarwood Rd Bridge - From May 1 – July 1 it shall be unlawful to use other than one single-pointed unweighted hook measuring 1/2-inch or less from point to shank.

Kent

Pratt L. bass minimum size limit is 10".

Keweenaw

Isle Royale National Park: Michigan fishing laws apply and state license required on **L. Superior** waters of park. On **L. Superior**, within 4.5 miles of Isle Royale, no possession of Brook Trout. (Contact park for specific regulations 906-482-0984 or www.nps.gov/isro/planyourvisit/fishing.htm.)



Lake

Little Manistee R. 300' above and below the DNR weir is closed to fishing all year; from 300' above DNR weir to Spencers Bridge closed to fishing Jan. 1 – March 31; also from 300' below DNR weir to mouth closed to fishing Sep. 1 – Nov. 14 and Jan. 1 – March 31. On all waters of the **Pere Marquette R.** and **Little Manistee R.** an artificial lure is defined as a body bait, plug, spinner or spoon (as described on p. 8). **Big Bass L.** (T20N, R14W, S34) bass minimum size limit is 10".

Leelanau

North Manitou L. bass minimum size limit is 18", the possession limit is 1; fishing restricted to artificial lures only; live bait, dead or prepared bait or organic or processed food may not be possessed on the water or the shore. **Florence L.** (S. Manitou Is.) fishing restricted to artificial lures only; live bait, dead or prepared bait or organic or processed food may not be possessed on the water or the shore. **Hatlem's Cr.**, it is unlawful to take or attempt to take minnows for personal use.

Livingston

Spring Mill Pond (Island Lake Recreation Area) March 15 – March 31 no fishing; April 1 – Fri. before the last Sat. in April, catch-and-immediate-release of trout with artificial lures only; last Sat. in April – March 14 statewide regulations apply.

Luce

Unlawful to launch or retrieve motorized vessel (greater than 5 horsepower) from state land on the **E. Br. Fox R.** from M-28 to the mouth of Cold Cr.

Macomb

Clinton R. cut-off channel (T2N, R13E): from spillway weir to the Harper Rd. Bridge: the following regulations apply from March 16 – Fri. before the last Sat. in April: Anglers are limited to using unweighted single-pointed hooks, natural bait, and sinkers or weights or artificial lures with unweighted single-pointed hooks.

Manistee

Little Manistee R. 300' above and below the DNR weir is closed to fishing all year; from 300' above DNR weir to Spencers Bridge closed to fishing Jan. 1 – March 31; also from 300' below DNR weir to mouth closed to fishing Sep. 1 – Nov. 14 and Jan. 1 – March 31. On all waters of the **Betsie R.**, all waters of **Bear Cr.** (Manistee Co.), all waters of the **Little Manistee R.**, and the **Manistee R.** from Tippy Dam downstream to Railroad Bridge below M-55 (T21N, R16W, S6), special artificial lure regulations apply (p. 8).

Marquette

Deer L. Basin, Carp R./Carp Cr. downstream from M-28 (T47N, R27W, S4), and all other tributaries

to **Deer L. Basin** fishing restricted to artificial lures, catch-and-release only; live bait, dead or prepared bait or organic or processed food may not be possessed on the water or the shore. **Fish L.** bass minimum size 18" and possession limit is 1 bass only. **Salmon-Trout R.**, from Lower Falls to mouth closed to fishing Aug. 15 – Fri. before last Sat. in April.

Mason

On the **Sable R.** from mouth upstream to Hamlin Lake Dam, all waters of the **Little Manistee R.**, all waters of the **N. Br. Pentwater R.**, and on all waters of the **Pere Marquette R.** special artificial lure regulations apply (p. 8). **Gun L.** bass minimum size limit is 10".

Menominee

See **Michigan-Wisconsin Boundary Waters Regulations** (pp. 24–25).

Midland

Tittabawassee R. between Sanford Dam site and mouth of the **Salt R.** and between Dow Dam and Gordonville Bridge, closed to fishing from March 16 – Fri. before last Sat. in April. **Tittabawassee R.** downstream from Sanford Dam site, **Chippewa, Pine, Salt** and all their tributaries the following regulations apply from March 16 – Fri. before the last Sat. in April: Anglers are limited to using unweighted single-pointed hooks, natural bait, and sinkers or weights or artificial lures with unweighted single-pointed hooks.

Monroe

Crystal Waters State Game Area for all waters - the fishing season is open all year and no possession allowed, catch-and-immediate-release fishing only.

Montmorency

East Fish, West Fish, and Middle Fish Lks., Hunt Cr. (above Section Z bulkhead T29N, R2E, S25), and **Fuller Cr.** (in the Hunt Cr. Trout Research Station Area), no fishing. **North** and **South Blue** and **Walled Lks.**, open season is the last Sat. in April – Sep. 30, catch-and-immediate-release only, artificial lures only.

Muskegon

On all waters of the **White R.** (from mouth upstream to Hesperia Dam) and all waters of the **N. Br. White R.** and **Muskegon R.** (upstream to Croton Dam) special artificial lure regulations apply (p. 8). From Nov. 1 – Nov. 30: It shall be unlawful to use other than one single-pointed unweighted hook measuring ½-inch or less from point to shank at the **port of Muskegon** from the westernmost pier head extending into **L. Michigan** (excluding break walls) to the easternmost pier head extending into **Muskegon L.** and at the **port of Whitehall/Montague** from the westernmost pier head extending into **L. Michigan** to the easternmost pier head extending into **White L.**

Newaygo

Baptist L., no possession of Walleye, Channel Catfish, Flathead Catfish or Bullheads; **Brush and Sand Lks.** no possession of Channel Catfish, Flathead Catfish or Bullheads. **Crystal L.**, no possession of Walleye. On **all waters** of the **Pere Marquette R.** and **Muskegon R.** (upstream to Croton Dam) special artificial lure regulations apply (p. 8).

Oakland

Upper Bushman L. catch-and-immediate-release only for all species.

Oceana

On **all waters** of the **Pere Marquette R.**, **White R.** (from mouth upstream to Hesperia Dam) and **all waters** of the **N. Br. White R.** and **all waters** of the **N. Br. Pentwater R.** and **S. Br. Pentwater R.** (upstream to Hart Dam) special artificial lure regulations apply (p. 8).

Ontonagon

L. Gogebic the daily possession limit for Yellow Perch is 25 with no more than 5 Yellow Perch 12" or greater. **W. Br. Ontonagon R.** from its confluence with the Victoria Hydro station tailrace (T50N, R39W, SE 1/4 of the SW 1/4 of S29) upstream to Victoria Dam, including the trailrace canal closed to fishing April 1 – Jun. 10. **L. of the Clouds** (Carp L.) fishing restricted to artificial lures only. It shall be unlawful to use or possess live bait, dead bait or organic or processed food at any time on the shore or water. No spearing; no possession of Smallmouth Bass.

Ottawa

From Nov. 1 – Nov. 30: It shall be unlawful to use other than one single-pointed unweighted hook measuring 1/2-inch or less from point to shank at the **port of Grand Haven** from the westernmost pier head extending into **L. Michigan** to the US-31 bridge (North bound Beacon Blvd.).

Otsego

Otsego L. Pike Marsh closed to fishing March 16 – June 15. **Otsego L.** see Lake Sturgeon regulations (p. 15).

Presque Isle

Clinton Cr. closed to fishing April 1 – May 14. **Grand L. Pike Marsh** it is unlawful for any person other than state employee to use or operate a motorized vehicle on the access road leading from US-23 to the **Grand L. Pike Marsh** during March – May, closed to fishing whenever marsh is operating. **Rainy R.** from confluence with **Black L.** upstream to N. Allis Rd. Bridge (T35N, R2E, S15) closed to fishing April 1 – May 14. **Shuberts Cr.** (Monaghan Cr.) from **Long L.** upstream to Clinton Cr. Rd. (T33N, R7E, S14), closed to fishing April 1 – May 14. **Swan R.** from 300' above weir to mouth closed to fishing whenever weir is in place.

Roscommon

Denton Cr. from the Lake James Dam downstream to **Houghton L.** closed to fishing March 23 – April 23. **Cut R.** from confluence with **Backus Cr.** upstream to outlet at **Marl L.** closed to fishing March 23 – April 23.

St. Joseph

Pleasant (Big Pleasant) and Corey Lks. minimum size limit for bass is 10".

Saginaw

Bad R., Cass R., Flint R., Saginaw R. from upstream of the West Center St. (Douglas G. Schenk) Bridge, **Shiawassee** and **Tittabawassee Rivers** and **all their tribs** the following regulations apply from March 16 – Fri. before the last Sat. in April: Anglers are limited to using unweighted single-pointed hooks, natural bait, and sinkers or weights or artificial lures with unweighted single-pointed hooks.

Schoolcraft

Thompson Cr. closed to use of hand nets. **Seney National Wildlife Refuge** waters have limited fishing, contact Refuge office (906-586-9851) or visit www.fws.gov/refuge/Seney. On the **Big Island Lakes Complex** (**Big Island, Bluegill, Byers, Center, Coattail, Cucumber, Farm** [Blush], **Jarr, Klondike, McInnes, Mid, Neville, Onega, Pear, Townline, Upper and Vance Lks.**) no wheeled or motorized vehicles (including electric or outboard motors) are allowed; artificial lures only; no spearing, no netting, and use of live bait prohibited; Muskellunge (including Tiger Muskellunge) fishing season is May 15 – Nov. 30, possession season is 1st Sat. in June – Nov. 30, minimum size limit 42", possession limit is 1 fish per angler per season, anglers must register all harvested Muskellunge (p. 9); Northern Pike open season May 15 – Nov. 30, minimum size limit 24", and possession limit is 2 Northern Pike; bass fishing is open from Sat. before Memorial Day – Nov. 30, minimum size limit 18", and possession limit is 1; perch, Bluegill and Pumpkinseed open season is from last Sat. in April – Nov. 30, possession limit is 5 fish in combination; all other fish no open season. Unlawful to launch or retrieve motorized vessel (greater than 5 horsepower) from state land on the **E. Branch Fox R.** from M-28 to the mouth of **Cold Cr.**

Van Buren

Crooked and Little Crooked Lks. bass minimum size limit is 10". **S. Br. Black R.** and **all tributaries** upstream of Breedsville (Mill Str.) restricted to only one single-pointed, unweighted hook no larger than 1/2" from point to shank.

Washtenaw

Huron R. from Mast Rd. Bridge in Dexter (T1S, R5E, S32) downstream to Delhi Rd. Bridge (T2S, R5E, S2) catch-and-immediate-release only on bass. **Horseshoe L.** bass possession limit is 1, minimum size is 14"; Northern Pike possession limit is 1, sunfish (NOTE 6, p. 14) possession limit is 10.

Michigan's Eat Safe Fish Guide

There are many health benefits to eating fish. However, to get the most benefits, the Michigan Department of Health and Human Services (MDHHS) recommends eating fish that are low in chemical contaminants. Chemicals can be found in fish from anywhere in the world. You can use the *Eat Safe Fish Guide (ESF Guide)* to find fish from Michigan that have been tested for chemicals and are safe for everyone to eat.

- MDHHS tests only the parts of the fish that you eat for chemicals. That's the information used to make the guidelines in the *ESF Guide*.
- The guidelines in the *ESF Guide* are safe for everyone to use — including pregnant women, children, and those with illnesses, like cancer or diabetes.
- You can't see or taste the chemicals that can cause health problems. The only way to know if they could be in your fish is to use the MDHHS *ESF Guide*. Get yours today!

To get a free copy of the MDHHS *Eat Safe Fish Guide* and other helpful information about choosing and eating safe fish, visit **Michigan.gov/EatSafeFish** or call MDHHS at 1-800-648-6942.



Be aware of PFAS

The Michigan Department of Health & Human Services releases *Eat Safe Fish Guides* annually in the spring and emergency advisories as needed. Fish across the state are tested for PFAS (per- and polyfluoroalkyl substances). Additionally, they are tested for other chemicals such as mercury, as all fish have some amount of mercury. As new guidelines are set as a result of elevated levels of PFAS, Michigan is releasing those advisories outside of the annual *Eat Safe Fish Guides* update. To be sure you have the most up-to-date information about PFAS fish results, visit **Michigan.gov/PFASResponse**.

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Angler Rights On Public Streams

On fenced or posted property or farm property, an angler wading or floating a navigable public stream (for more information call the DNR's Law Enforcement Division at 517-284-6000) may, without written or oral consent, enter upon property within the clearly defined banks of the stream, or without damaging farm products, walk a route as closely proximate to the clearly defined bank as possible when necessary to avoid a natural or artificial hazard or obstruction, including, but not limited to a dam, deep hole or fence or other exercise of ownership by the riparian owner.

However, per the Michigan Penal Code Section 552c, a person is prohibited from intentionally and without authority or permission from entering in or upon premises or structures belonging to another person that is a "key facility" if that key facility is completely enclosed by a physical barrier of any kind. A key facility includes: a chemical manufacturing facility; a refinery; an electric utility facility; a water intake structure or water treatment facility; a natural gas facility; gasoline, propane, liquid natural gas, or other fuel terminal or storage facility; a transportation facility; a pulp or paper manufacturing facility; a pharmaceutical manufacturing facility; a hazardous waste storage, treatment or disposal facility; and a telecommunication facility.

Railroad Rights-Of-Way

Railroad rights-of-way are private property. Trespassing on railroad property, including the trestles and bridges, is a misdemeanor. Written permission must be obtained from the railroad company to be exempt from railway trespass.

Angler Harassment Information

Anglers in Michigan have the right to enjoy their sport free from unreasonable and deliberate interference. Michigan law prohibits individuals from obstructing or interfering with the lawful taking of aquatic species. The DNR supports fishing as a legitimate form of recreation and as a useful tool in the management of aquatic resources. Michigan Conservation Officers are committed to protecting anglers from the intentional disruption of the fishing experience. Individuals whose fishing is being obstructed should promptly report the violation by calling or texting toll free to 800-292-7800 (Report All Poaching hotline).

Personal Flotation Devices (PFD)

When selecting a PFD, be sure to read the label to verify that it is appropriate for the person's size, weight and intended activity. Try your PFD on to make sure it fits properly and check to make sure it is U.S. Coast Guard approved.

Craft under 16 feet long:

For Great Lakes and connecting waterways, the U.S. Coast Guard requires all vessels less than 16 feet to carry one wearable U.S. Coast Guard approved life jacket for each person on board. For inland waters not connected to the Great Lakes, each person on board must have either a wearable or throwable PFD.

Craft 16 feet or longer:

If your boat is 16 feet or longer, you must have at least one U.S. Coast Guard approved wearable PFD for each person on board:

- Offshore Life Jacket (Type I)
- Near-shore Bouyant Vest (Type II)
- Flotation Aid (Type III)

PLUS you must have one throwable PFD (Type IV) on board.

Michigan law requires:

- Everyone operating, riding on or being towed by a personal watercraft must wear a non-inflatable Type I, II or III PFD.
- Persons less than 6 years old must wear a Type I or Type II PFD when riding on the open deck area of a boat.

Learn more at Michigan.gov/DNRLaws.



Public access to fishing is supported by the Natural Resources Trust Fund

Visit Michigan.gov/DNR and click on "Apply for Grants" for more information.

The Master Angler Patch is awarded to all entries meeting the established minimum length criteria and that adhere to program requirements described below. All fish must be taken by legal Michigan sportfishing methods, during the open season, and in Michigan waters **OPEN TO THE PUBLIC**. A photo of the fish being measured by a standard ruler or measuring tape **MUST** be included in the entry application. Only one entry will be accepted per fish species that are the same length and submitted by the same angler. DNR Fisheries Division reserves the right to reject any application if the entry does not meet the established criteria. Only 1 patch per species will be awarded to each angler per year.

- The Master Angler patch is awarded to anglers who meet the species-specific minimum length and other program requirements. Anglers catching a State Record fish also receive a patch.
- **Measuring the length of your fish:** Measure your fish from the tip of the nose (or lower jaw) to tip of the tail in a straight line. Do NOT measure in a curve or over the body. Measure to the closest 1/8". Use a standard ruler or measuring tape and take a picture while measuring the fish as required for the program.
- Applications are only accepted via the online form found at Michigan.gov/MasterAngler. The deadline for submitting an entry for fish caught in **2026 is January 10, 2027**. Color photos of the fish, including at least one of the entire fish being measured with a device that clearly shows and verifies the length must be submitted along with the application. **Applications and photos may ONLY be submitted via the online form. Need help submitting? Call 517-284-5830.**
- **State Record Fish** are recognized by weight only. To qualify, your fish must exceed the current listed State Record weight and identification must be verified by a DNR fisheries biologist. See the list of Customer Service Centers on p. 73 and plan on calling ahead for fisheries biologist availability.

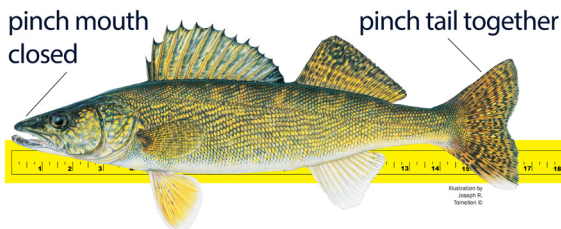
When releasing a fish...

Please follow these suggestions to reduce the risk of injury to the fish when practicing catch-and-release:

- Never use a gaff.
- Land your catch carefully and quickly. Avoid handling the fish at all and remove the hook gently with pliers.
- Use a landing net made of soft or knotless mesh and always try to net your fish head first.
- Try to keep the fish in the water and gently cradle it while carefully removing the hook.
- Leave your fish in the water until you are ready to take a photo.
- Do not squeeze the fish and keep your fingers out of the fish's gills since a torn gill could cause the fish to bleed to death.
- Touch your fish as little as possible. Always wet your hands before touching your fish.
- Cut the line near the hook if a fish is deeply hooked. A steel hook will rust away leaving the fish unharmed.
- Release your fish, pointing it into a slow current or gently moving it back and forth until its gills are working properly and the fish regains its balance. Once fully recovered, allow the fish to swim from your hands (large fish may take longer to recover).

Length Measurement Directions

Measure fish from tip of nose (or lower jaw) to tip of tail in a straight line (DO NOT measure in a curve around the body from nose to tail). Measure to the closest 1/8". Tail and jaw should be pinched to get proper measurement.



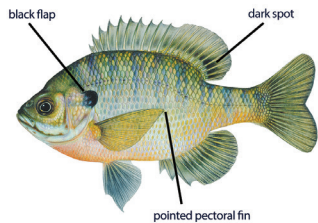
Minimum Entry Lengths & Current State Records

Must meet minimum length and include a picture of fish being measured.

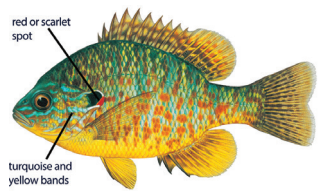
Submit entries at Michigan.gov/MasterAngler

Species	Minimum Entry Length (inches)	Current State Record (lbs.)
Bass, Largemouth	21"	11.94
Bass, Rock	12"	3.62
Bass, Smallmouth	21"	9.98
Bass, White	16"	6.44
Bluegill	10"	2.75
Buffalo, Bigmouth	30"	33
Buffalo, Black	30"	54.3
Bullhead, Black	14"	3.44
Bullhead, Brown	14"	3.77
Bullhead, Yellow	14"	3.6
Bowfin	27"	14
Burbot	26"	18.25
Carp, Common	33"	61.5
Carp sucker, Quillback	19"	9.98
Catfish, Channel	30"	40
Catfish, Flathead	35"	64.46
Cisco (Lake Herring)	20"	6.36
Crappie, Black	14"	4.12
Crappie, White	14"	3.39
Freshwater Drum	27"	28.61
Lake Sturgeon	60"	193
Longnose Gar	32"	18
Muskellunge, Great Lakes	46"	58
Muskellunge, Northern	46"	49.75
Muskellunge, Tiger	46"	51.19
Northern Pike	36"	39
Perch, White	11"	2
Perch, Yellow	14"	3.75
Salmon, Atlantic	28"	32.62
Salmon, Chinook	39"	47.86
Salmon, Coho	28"	30.56
Salmon, Pink	21"	8.56
Smelt	10"	(12" length)
Splake	25"	17.5
Sucker, Longnose	17"	6.88
Sucker, Northern Hog	13"	2.54
Sucker, Redhorse	22"	12.89
Sucker, White	21"	7.19
Sunfish, Green	9"	1.53
Sunfish, Hybrid	10"	1.8
Sunfish, Pumpkinseed	9"	2.15
Sunfish, Redear	10"	2.36
Sunfish, Warmouth	9"	1.38
Trout, Brook	14"	9.5
Trout, Brown	24"	41.45
Trout, Lake	34"	61.5
Trout, Rainbow (Steelhead)	32"	26.5
Walleye	29"	17.19
Whitefish, Lake	23"	14.28
Whitefish, Menominee (Whitefish, Round)	15"	4.06

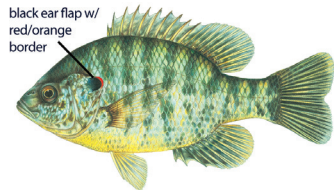
Bluegill



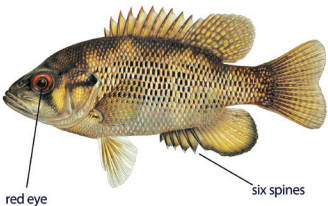
Pumpkinseed (Sunfish)



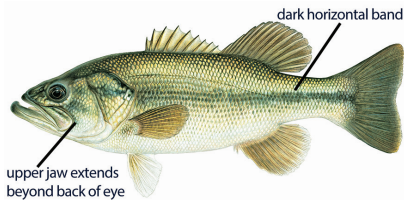
Redear Sunfish



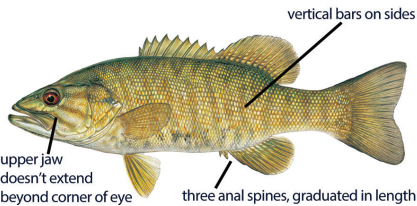
Rock Bass



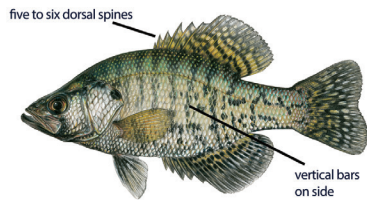
Largemouth Bass



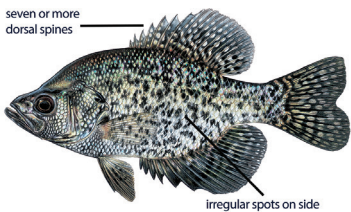
Smallmouth Bass



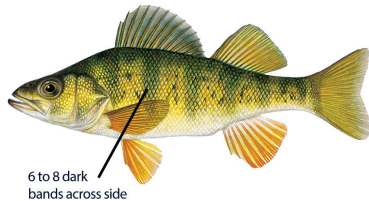
White Crappie



Black Crappie



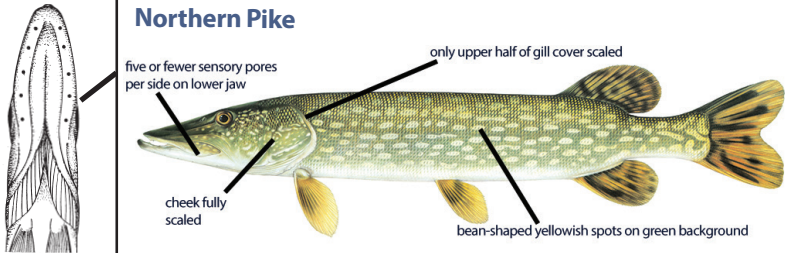
Yellow Perch



Walleye



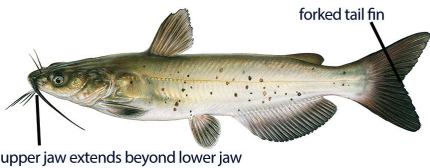
Northern Pike



Muskellunge



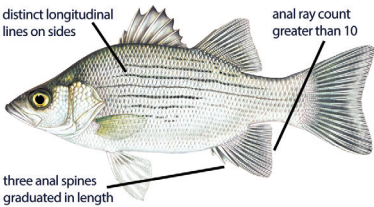
Channel Catfish



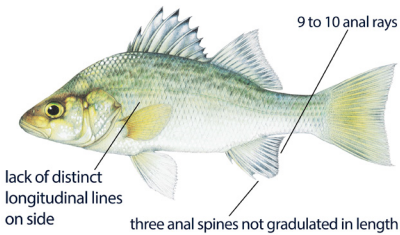
Flathead Catfish



White Bass



White Perch



Rainbow Trout



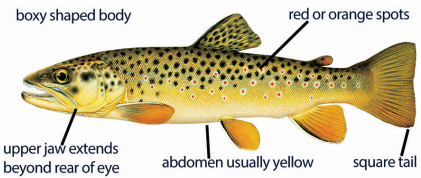
Rainbow Trout (Steelhead)



Brook Trout



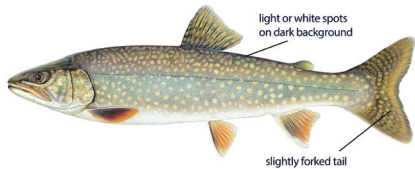
Brown Trout



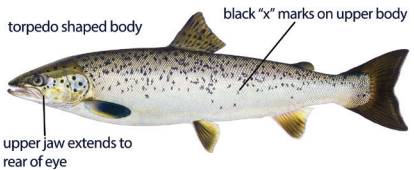
Lake Trout



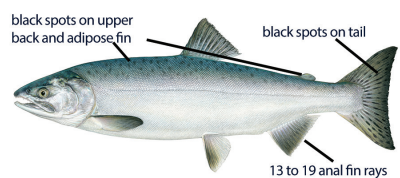
Splake



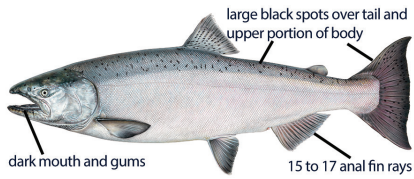
Atlantic Salmon



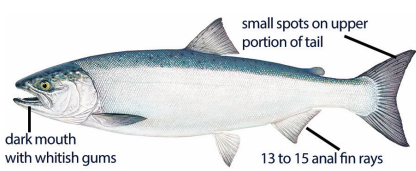
Pink Salmon



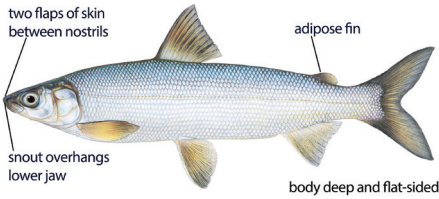
Chinook "King" Salmon



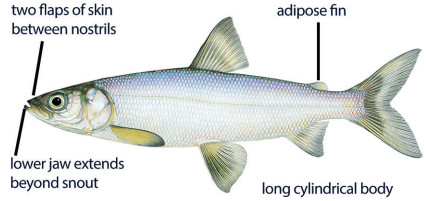
Coho Salmon



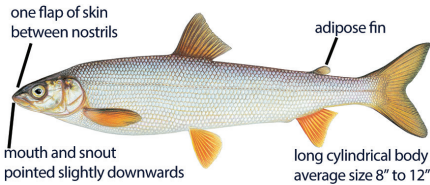
Lake Whitefish



Cisco



Round Whitefish



Want to learn more about Michigan's fish species?

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CASTING INTO CONSERVATION

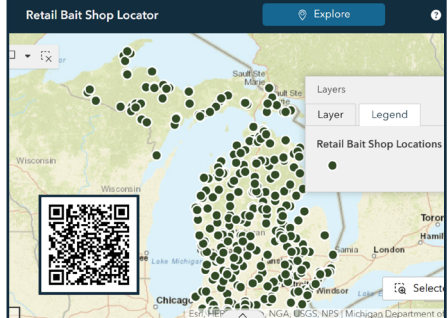
Every cast you make helps keep Michigan's waters thriving. In 2024 alone, anglers like yourself contributed more than **\$30 million** through license fees. These dollars fund fish population studies, stocking and habitat restoration. Thank you for investing in the future of fishing.

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Use the Retail Bait Shop Locator map to find licensed retail bait shops throughout the state—near you or near your favorite fishing hole! Make sure to call ahead to confirm hours and availability.

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Inland Trout & Salmon Regulations



Flies Only



Artificial Lures Only

The information in this section (pp. 42–65) provides fishing regulations that pertain only to the taking of trout and salmon from inland waters. Check the county listings (pp. 48–65) for specific waters and the regulations placed on each according to the Type listed for that entry. Regulations for lakes and streams are listed in either the lake regulations table (below), stream regulations table (p. 43), or the gear restricted streams section (pp. 44–46). Maps have been developed to assist anglers in identifying inland trout waters and the regulations associated with each Type as indicated by color scheme and text. **During closed season dates on inland trout and salmon waters, fishing is prohibited for all species.** Anglers should check the It is Unlawful To section for restrictions on hooks and lures (p. 11) and the Exceptions to General Regulations by County (pp. 28–31) for other restrictions. See Artificial Flies, Bead Fishing and Artificial Lure definitions(p. 8).

A person shall not at any time take or possess an Arctic Grayling taken from any of the waters over which the state has jurisdiction.

Inland Trout & Salmon Lake Regulations

The following regulations pertain only to inland lake Types A – F as listed on pp. 48–65.

Maps are available online at Michigan.gov/FishingMaps.

Lake Type	Fishing and Possession Season	Tackle	Daily Possession Limit	Minimum Size Limit Brook Trout	Minimum Size Limit Brown Trout, Rainbow Trout, & Splake	Minimum Size Limit Lake Trout	Minimum Size Limit Coho, Chinook, & Pink Salmon	Minimum Size Limit Atlantic Salmon
A (60 lakes)	Last Sat. in April – Oct. 31	All except minnows	5/3*	10"	12"	15"	10"	15"
B (53 lakes)	Open All Year	All	5/3*	10"	12"	15"	10"	15"
C (26 lakes)	Open All Year	All	5/3*	8"	8"	8"	10"	15"
D (19 lakes)	Last Sat. in April – Oct. 31	 **	1	15"	15"	15"	10"	15"
E (11 lakes)	Open All Year	All	3	15"	15"	15"	10"	15"
F (16 lakes)	Open All Year	All	5/3^	10"	10"	10"	10"	10"

* 5 fish, with no more than 3 trout 15" or greater.

** On Type D lakes, it is unlawful to use or possess live bait, dead or preserved bait or organic or processed food on any of the waters or on shore.

^ 5 fish in any combination, but no more than 3 fish of any one species, except up to 5 salmon (Chinook or coho) may be retained.

Designated Trout Lakes

All Type A and all Type D lakes are designated trout lakes (p. 8).

Regulations for Lakes Not Classified as Lake Type

Except for lakes in the Michigan-Wisconsin Boundary Waters and Sylvania Wilderness Area, any other inland lake not classified by Type is open all year to the taking of trout with an 8-inch minimum size limit and 5 fish daily possession limit, no more than 3 of which may be 15" or greater. Artificial lures and all types of natural bait may be used. See pp. 24–26 for Michigan-Wisconsin Boundary Waters and Sylvania Wilderness Area regulations, respectively.



Inland Trout & Salmon Stream Regulations

The following regulations pertain only to inland stream Types 1–4, and Brook Trout Restoration Areas (BTRA), as listed on pp. 48–65. Maps are available online at: Michigan.gov/FishingMaps.

All types of natural and artificial baits may be used on stream Types 1–4. NOTE: Chumming is prohibited on all stream types listed below and Gear Restricted Streams.

Stream Type (Colors below are indicated accordingly on the maps online.)	Fishing Season	Possession Season	Brook Trout Min. Size Limit	Brown Trout Min. Size Limit	Atlantic, Chinook, Coho & Pink Salmon, Lake Trout, Rainbow Trout (Steelhead) & Splake Min. Size Limit	All Trout and Salmon Daily Possession Limit
1 (Approx. 1,400 streams)	Last Sat. in April – Sep. 30	Last Sat. in April – Sep. 30	7"	8"	10"	5 fish, but no more than 3 trout 15" or greater. See pp. 48–65 for exceptions
2 (13 streams)	Last Sat. in April – Sep. 30	Last Sat. in April – Sep. 30	10"	12"	10"	5 fish, but no more than 3 trout 15" or greater. See pp. 48–65 for exceptions
3 (58 streams)	Open All Year	Open All Year	15"	15"	10"	5 fish, but no more than 3 trout 15" or greater. See pp. 48–65 for exceptions
4 (128 streams)	Open All Year	Last Sat. in April – Sep. 30 for Brook Trout, Brown Trout, and Atlantic Salmon Open all year for all other trout and salmon	7"	10"	10"	5 fish, but no more than 3 trout 15" or greater. See pp. 48–65 for exceptions
Brook Trout Restoration Areas (BTRA)	The following locations have more restrictive Brook Trout Regulations. Fishing regulations on these waters shall supersede those in other sections which in any way conflict with the following: the possession season for Brook Trout is from the last Saturday in April – Sep. 30, the minimum size limit on Brook Trout, Lake Trout, and Splake shall be 20" with a daily possession limit of 1 Brook Trout, Lake Trout or Splake total combined. Big Garlic River and tributaries (Marquette Co.), from County Road 550 (T50N, R26W, S33) downstream to Lake Superior (T50N, R26W, S21). Big Huron River (Baraga and Marquette Cos.), from Big Eric's Bridge (T52N, R30W, S35) downstream to Lake Superior (T52N, R29W, S18). Iron River (Marquette Co.), from Lake Independence Dam (T51N, R27W, S13) downstream to Lake Superior (T51N, R26W, S18). Little Huron River (Marquette Co.), from unnamed bridge crossing located at the southern border of section 20 (T52N, R29W, S20) downstream to Lake Superior (T52N, R29W, S17). Pilgrim River and tributaries (Houghton Co.), from the headwaters downstream to Portage Lake (T54N, R33W, S5). Portage/Torch Lake system (including the Portage River, Portage Canal, North Entry and South Entry, Houghton Co.). Ravine River (Baraga Co.), from Scicotte Road (T51N, R31W, S2) downstream to Huron Bay (T51N, R31W, S4). Silver River (Baraga Co.), from Silver River Falls (T51N, R32W, S26) downstream to Huron Bay (T51N, R31W, S18). Slate River (Baraga Co.), from Slate River Falls (1/2 mile upstream from Skanee Road T51N, R31W, S9) downstream to Huron Bay (T51N, R31W, S8). Salmon-Trout River (Marquette Co.) from Lower Falls (T51N, R28W, S13) down to Lake Superior. NOTE: Fishing season: last Saturday in April – August 14; Possession season: last Saturday in April – August 14.					

Regulations for Streams Not Classified as Stream Type or Listed as a Gear Restricted Stream

Except for streams in the Michigan-Wisconsin Boundary Waters, any other inland stream not classified by Type is open to trout fishing all year with an 8" minimum size limit (except 7" for Brook Trout) and a 5 fish daily possession limit, no more than 3 of which may be 15" or greater, except up to 5 salmon (Chinook or Coho) 15" or greater may be retained in the daily possession limit on these waters. Artificial lures and all types of natural bait may be used. Review pp. 24–25 for Michigan-Wisconsin Boundary Waters regulations.

Designated Trout Streams

All Type 1, all Type 2, all Gear Restricted Streams (GR), and all Brook Trout Restoration Areas (BTRA) are designated trout streams. Most Type 3 and most Type 4 streams are designated trout streams (check FO-210 and FO-200 (Michigan.gov/dnr/managing-resources/laws/orders/fisheries-orders) or Michigan.gov/FishingMaps for more information).

Gear Restricted Streams



Flies Only



Artificial Lures Only

The following streams have regulations that differ from those in Types 1–4 as listed on p. 43. On all streams managed under gear restrictions, it shall be unlawful to use or possess live bait, dead or preserved bait or organic or processed food on any of the waters or on shore (this restriction does not apply when a stream is under Type regulations). NOTE: It shall be unlawful to use or possess scented material on flies-only Gear Restricted Streams. **Gear Restricted Streams are indicated in red color on the maps online at Michigan.gov/FishingMaps.** See p. 8 for the Artificial Flies definition.

Au Sable River

Mainstream (Crawford Co.) from Burton's Landing (T26N, R3W, S11) to South Wakeley Bridge Rd. (Wakeley Bridge): Fishing Season: open all year; **Possession Season:** closed all year; except for children under 12 the possession season is open all year; **Tackle:** artificial flies only; **Daily Possession Limit:** zero trout; except children under 12 may keep 1 trout; **Size Limits:** for children under 12 there is an 8-inch minimum size limit and a 12-inch maximum size limit for trout. **Mileage:** 9.0 miles.

Mainstream (Crawford Co.) from South Wakeley Bridge Rd. (Wakeley Bridge) to McMasters Bridge Rd. (McMasters Bridge): Fishing Season: open all year; **Possession Season:** last Sat. in April – Sep. 30 for Brook Trout and Brown Trout; open all year for Rainbow Trout; **Tackle:** artificial lures only; **Daily Possession Limit:** 2 trout with no more than 1 trout 18" or greater; **Minimum Size Limits:** Brook Trout and Rainbow Trout — 10"; Brown Trout — 18". **Mileage:** 8.0 miles.

Mainstream (Oscoda Co.) from Mio power line (T26N, R3E, S7; 44° 39' 40.550" N/ 84° 7' 24.280" W) to Evans Rd. (McKinley Bridge): Fishing Season: open all year; **Possession Season:** last Sat. in April – Sep. 30 for Brook Trout and Brown Trout; open all year for Rainbow Trout; **Tackle:** artificial lures only; **Daily Possession Limit:** 2 trout with no more than 1 trout 18" or greater; **Minimum Size Limits:** Brook Trout — 7"; Brown Trout — 18"; Rainbow Trout — 10". **Mileage:** 15.0 miles.

North Branch (Crawford Co.) from Sheep Ranch (T28N, R2W, S12; 44° 49' 40.470" N/ 84° 29' 25.933" W) to confluence with Mainstream: Fishing Season: Open all year; **Possession Season:** last Sat. in April – Sep. 30 for Brook Trout and Brown Trout; open all year for Rainbow Trout; **Tackle:** artificial flies only; **Daily Possession Limit:** 2 trout with no more than 1 trout 18" or greater; **Minimum Size Limits:** Brook Trout and Rainbow Trout — 10"; Brown Trout — 18". **Mileage:** 20.7 miles

South Branch (Crawford Co.) from Chase Bridge Rd. (Chase Bridge) to Lower High Banks (T25N, R2W, S13; 44° 33' 49.735" N/ 84° 29' 59.107" W): Fishing season: open all year; **Possession Season:** closed all year; except for children under 12 the possession season is open all year; **Tackle:** artificial flies only; **Daily Possession Limit:** zero trout; except children under 12 may keep 1 trout; **Size Limits:** for children under 12 there is an 8-inch minimum size limit and a 12-inch maximum size limit for trout. **Mileage:** 4.3 miles.

South Branch (Crawford Co.) from Lower High Banks (T25N, R2W, S13; 44° 33' 49.735" N/ 84° 29' 59.107" W) to confluence with Mainstream: Fishing Season: open all year; **Possession Season:** last Sat. in April – Sep. 30 for Brook Trout and Brown Trout; open all year for Rainbow Trout; **Tackle:** artificial flies only; **Daily Possession Limit:** 2 trout with no more than 1 trout 18" or greater; **Minimum Size Limits:** Brook Trout and Rainbow Trout — 10"; Brown Trout — 18". **Mileage:** 11.5 miles.

Black River

 (Otsego and Montmorency Cos.) from Tin Shanty Bridge Rd. to the Town Corner Lake Stairs (T32N, R1E, S31 SE/SE; 45° 6' 50.872" N/ 84° 21' 0.488" W): **Fishing Season:** open all year; **Possession Season:** last Sat. in April – Sep. 30 for Brook Trout; open all year for Brown Trout and Rainbow Trout; **Tackle:** artificial lures only; **Daily Possession Limit:** 5 trout; with no more than 2 Brook Trout; **Minimum Size Limits:** Brook Trout and Rainbow Trout — 10"; Brown Trout — 8". **Mileage:** 4.4 miles.

Cooks Run

(Iron Co.) from US Forest Hwy 16 to confluence with South Branch Paint River:

- From the last Sat. in April – Sep. 30, this reach of stream shall be managed under Type 2 regulations, except the minimum size limit for Brook Trout is 7".

 From Oct. 1 – the Fri. before the last Sat. in April, this reach of stream shall be managed under gear restricted regulations as follows: **Fishing Season:** Oct. 1 – the Fri. before the last Sat. in April; **Possession Season:** closed; except for children under 12 the possession season is open; **Tackle:** artificial flies only; **Daily Possession Limit:** zero trout; except children under 12 may keep 1 trout; **Size Limits:** for children under 12 there is an 8-inch minimum size limit and a 12-inch maximum size limit for all trout. **Mileage:** 4.5 miles.

Duck Creek

 (Gogebic Co.) from Railroad Bridge (T44N, R39W, S16) to confluence with Middle Branch Ontonagon River: **Fishing Season:** open all year; **Possession Season:** last Sat. in April – Sep. 30 for Brook Trout and Brown Trout; open all year for Rainbow Trout; **Tackle:** artificial lures only; **Daily Possession Limit:** 2 trout; **Minimum Size Limits:** minimum size limit: all trout – 10". **Mileage:** 6.5 miles.

Escanaba River

 (Delta Co.) from Boney Falls Dam to Mouth of Silver Creek: **Fishing Season:** open all year; **Possession Season:** last Sat. in April – Sep. 30 for Brook Trout and Brown Trout; open all year for Rainbow Trout; **Tackle:** artificial lures only; **Daily Possession Limit:** 2 trout; **Minimum Size Limits:** Brook Trout — 10"; Brown Trout and Rainbow Trout — 12". **Mileage:** 14.2 miles.

Fox River

(Schoolcraft Co.) from Fox River State Forest Campground (T46N, R14W, S11; 46° 24' 1.668" N/ 86° 1' 50.271" W) to M-28:

- From the last Sat. in April – Sep. 30, this reach of stream shall be managed under Type 1 regulations.

 From Oct. 1 – the Fri. before the last Sat. in April, this reach of stream shall be managed under gear restricted regulations as follows: **Fishing Season:** Oct. 1 – the Fri. before the last Sat. in April; **Possession Season:** closed; except for children under 12 the possession season is open; **Tackle:** artificial flies only; **Daily Possession Limit:** zero trout; except children under 12 may keep 1 trout; **Size Limits:** for children under 12 there is an 8-inch minimum size limit and a 12-inch maximum size limit for all trout. **Mileage:** 7.6 miles.

Huron River

(Oakland Co.) from 50 yards below Proud Lake Dam (T2N, R8E, S18) to 100 yards below Wixom Road (T2N, R7E, S13):

- From the last Sat. in April – Sep. 30, this reach of stream shall be managed under Type 1 regulations.

 From April 1 – the Fri. before the last Sat. in April, this reach of stream shall be managed under gear restricted regulations as follows: **Fishing Season:** April 1 – the Fri. before the last Sat. in April; **Possession Season:** closed; except for children under 12 the possession season is open; **Tackle:** artificial flies only; **Daily Possession Limit:** zero trout; except children under 12 may keep 1 trout; **Size Limits:** for children under 12 there is an 8-inch minimum size limit and a 12-inch maximum size limit for all trout. **Mileage:** 2.0 miles.

Little Manistee River

 (Lake Co.) from North Peacock Trail (Spencer's Bridge) to Johnson Rd. (Johnson's Bridge): **Fishing Season:** April 1 – Dec. 31; **Possession Season:** last Sat. in April – Sep. 30 for Brook Trout and Brown Trout; open April 1 – Dec. 31 for all other trout and salmon; **Tackle:** artificial flies only; **Daily Possession Limit:** 2 fish, any combination of trout and salmon; **Minimum Size Limits:** Brown Trout — 15"; all other trout and salmon — 10". **Mileage:** 7.5 miles.

Manistee River

 (Crawford Co.) from CO. Rd. 612 to M-72: **Fishing Season:** open all year; **Possession Season:** last Sat. in April – Sep. 30 for Brook Trout and Brown Trout; open all year for Rainbow Trout; **Tackle:** artificial lures only (see p. 8); **Daily Possession Limit:** 2 trout; with no more than 1 trout 18" or greater; **Minimum Size Limits:** Brook Trout and Rainbow Trout — 10"; Brown Trout — 18". **Mileage:** 9.2 miles.

 (Crawford and Kalkaska Cos.) from M-72 to Sunset Trail Rd. (CCC Bridge): **Fishing Season:** open all year; **Possession Season:** last Sat. in April – Sep. 30 for Brook Trout and Brown Trout; open all year for Rainbow Trout; **Tackle:** artificial flies only; **Daily Possession Limit:** 2 trout; with no more than 1 trout 18" or greater; **Minimum Size Limits:** Brook Trout and Rainbow Trout — 10"; Brown Trout — 18". **Mileage:** 16.7 miles.

Paint Creek

 (Oakland Co.) from Gunn Rd. to Tienken Rd.:

Fishing Season: last Sat. in April – Sep. 30 for all trout; **Possession Season:** last Sat. in April – Sep. 30 for all trout; **Tackle:** artificial lures only; **Daily Possession Limit:** 2 trout; **Minimum Size Limit:** all trout — 14". **Mileage:** 5.0 miles.

Paint River

South Branch (Iron Co.) from the Mouth of Cooks Run to the Mouth of the North Branch of the Paint River:

• **From the last Sat. in April – Sep. 30,** this reach of stream shall be managed under Type 2 regulations, except the minimum size limit for Brook Trout is 7".

• **From Oct. 1 – the Fri. before the last Sat. in April,** this reach of stream shall be managed under gear restricted regulations as follows: **Fishing Season:** Oct. 1 – the Fri. before the last Sat. in April; **Possession Season:** closed; except for children under 12 the possession season is open; **Tackle:** artificial flies only; **Daily Possession Limit:** zero trout; except children under 12 may keep 1 trout; **Size Limits:** for children under 12 there is an 8-inch minimum size limit and a 12-inch maximum size limit for all trout. **Mileage:** 10.0 miles.

Pere Marquette River



(Lake Co.) from M-37 to the Downstream Edge of the Boat Ramp/Slide at Gleason's Landing (T17N, R14W, S13; 43° 52' 14.521" N/ 85° 55' 21.752" W): **Fishing Season:** open all year; **Possession Season:** closed all year; except for children under 12 the possession season is open all year; **Tackle:** artificial flies only; **Daily Possession Limit:** zero trout and salmon; except children under 12 may keep 1 trout or salmon; **Size Limits:** for children under 12 there is an 8-inch minimum size limit and a 12-inch maximum size limit for all trout and salmon. **Mileage:** 8.5 miles.

(Lake Co.) from the Downstream Edge of the Boat Ramp/Slide at Gleason's Landing (T17N, R14W, S13; 43° 52' 14.521" N/ 85° 55' 21.752" W) to the Upstream Edge of the Boat Ramp at Rainbow Rapids (T18N, R14W, S27; 43° 55' 5.321" N/ 85° 58' 30.719" W):

• **From Sep. 1 – the Fri. before the last Sat. in April,** this reach of stream shall be managed under Type 4 regulations, with the following exceptions: **Fishing Season:** Sep. 1 – the Fri. before the last Sat. in April; **Possession Season:** Sep. 1 – the Fri. before the last Sat. in April; **Daily Possession Limit:** 1 Rainbow Trout; 0 Brook Trout; 0 Brown Trout; **Size Limits:** Rainbow Trout — 10".

• **From the last Sat. in April – Aug. 31,** this reach of stream shall be managed under gear restricted regulations as follows: **Fishing Season:** last Sat. in April – Aug. 31; **Possession Season:** last Sat. in April – Aug. 31; **Tackle:** artificial lures only (see p. 8); **Daily Possession Limit:** 2 trout or salmon; with no more than 1 Brown Trout 18" or greater, and no more than 1 Rainbow Trout; **Size Limits:** minimum size limit: all salmon and Rainbow Trout — 10"; Brook Trout and Brown Trout — 8"; except that the harvest of fish greater than 14" and less than 18" shall be prohibited for Brook Trout and Brown Trout. **Mileage:** 10.5 miles.

Pigeon River



(Cheboygan and Otsego Cos.) from Elk Hill Campground Horse Trail (T32N, R1W, S10; 45° 10' 50.753" N/ 84° 25' 27.866" W) to Pine Grove Campground Stairs (T33N, R1W, S17; 45° 14' 38.497" N/ 84° 26' 47.983" W): **Fishing Season:** open all year; **Possession Season:** last Sat. in April – Sep. 30 for Brook Trout and Brown Trout; open all year for Rainbow Trout; **Tackle:** artificial lures only; **Daily Possession Limit:** 2 trout; with no more than 1 Brown Trout; **Minimum Size Limits:** Brook Trout and Rainbow Trout — 10"; Brown Trout — 12". **Mileage:** 5.3 miles.



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County Listing of Lakes and Streams

Below is a listing of the inland lakes and streams that are managed for trout and salmon, along with their respective regulation Type. Please see pp. 42–43 for detailed regulations for each Type. For inland lakes, the lake name will appear under the appropriate county and will be followed by a letter (A–F). The letter designates the Type of regulations that apply to that lake. For streams, the stream name will be followed by a number (2–4, GR for Gear Restricted Streams, or BTRA for Brook Trout Restoration Area, p. 43) and any upstream/downstream boundaries that apply to that section of stream. Type 1 streams are not listed in the text except for a few instances as indicated. For a complete listing of all trout streams, check online at Michigan.gov/dnr/managing-resources/laws/orders/fisheries-orders or contact any DNR Fisheries Office. An SC indicates a fishing closure for the area and time period mentioned. Inland Trout/Salmon maps are available online at Michigan.gov/FishingMaps.

Alcona

Lakes	Type
South Hoist Lake	B
Streams	Type
Au Sable River Mainstream from Evans Rd. (McKinley Bridge) downstream to 4001 Bridge.	2
Au Sable River Mainstream from Alcona Dam to S. Branch River.	4
Black River from confluence with N. Branch Black River downstream to Lake Huron.	4
Pine River from F-41 downstream to Lake Huron.	3

Alger

Lakes	Type
Ackerman Lake	B
Addis Lakes	A
Bette’s Pond	A
Cheryl’s Pond (T44N, R19W, S25)	B
Cox Pond	A
Grand Marais Lake	A
Hike Lake	A
Irwin Lake	A
Kay’s Pond	B
Mirror Lake	B
North (Upper) Shoe Lake	B
Rock River Pond	A
Rock Lake	A
Sitka Lake	A
Sullivan Lake	A
Trueman Lake	A
West John’s Lake	A

Streams	Type
Anna River from Railroad Bridge (T46N, R19W, S14) downstream to L. Superior.	4
Au Train River from Powerhouse below M-94 downstream to L. Superior.	4
Hurricane River from Truck Trail (CO Rd 724, T49N, R15W, S25) downstream to L. Superior.	3
Laughing Whitefish River from Forks (T47N, R22W, S22) downstream to L. Superior.	4
Miner’s River from Miner’s Falls downstream to L. Superior.	4
Rock River from Railroad Bridge (T47N, R21W, S22) downstream to L. Superior. SC - Closed to Fishing — April 1 – Jun. 30 between dam and its downstream-most foot bridge located downstream from M-28 in T47N, R21W, S15.	4
Sable Creek	4
Sucker River upstream limit is old Grand Marais/Seney Road Bridge.	4

Allegan

Lakes	Type
Kalamazoo Lake/Silver Lake from US-31 down to L. Michigan.	F
Streams	Type
Black River Mainstream from confluence of North and South branches down to L. Michigan.	3
Gun River Mainstream from 122nd Ave. (T2N, R11W, S12) downstream to US 131 Bridge (T1N, R11W, S18).	4

INLAND TROUT & SALMON REGULATIONS

Streams	Type
Kalamazoo River from Calkins Dam (T2N, R14W, S15) downstream to US-31.	3
Middle Branch Black River from confluence of Spring Brook Creek (T1N, R15W, S22) downstream to confluence of Main Branch Black River.	4
North Branch Black River from 111th Ave. (T1N, R16W, S3) downstream to confluence with Mainstream.	3
Pine Creek Tributary from 101st Ave. to confluence with Pine Creek (T1N, R12W, S33).	4
Rabbit River Mainstream from US-131 Bridge (T4N, R11W, S31) downstream to confluence with Kalamazoo River (T3N, R15W, S16).	4
Silver Creek from M-89 Bridge (T1N, R11W, S26) downstream to confluence with Kalamazoo River.	2
Swan Creek from 109th Ave. (T1N, R14W, S7) downstream to confluence with Kalamazoo River (T2N, R14W, S9). Hook Restriction: On Swan Creek from mouth upstream to the dam at 118th Ave. it shall be unlawful to use other than one single-pointed unweighted hook measuring 1/2" or less from point to shank.	4

Alpena

Streams	Type
Devils River from US-23 Bridge downstream to L. Huron.	4
Long Lake Creek downstream limit is L. Huron.	4
Thunder Bay River from Ninth Street Dam downstream to L. Huron.	3

Antrim

Lakes	Type
Bellaire Pond	C
Elk Lake	E
Green Lake	B
Torch Lake	E

Streams	Type
Clam River from Clam Lake downstream to the end of the dock at the confluence with Torch Lake.	4
Elk River from Power Dam below Elk Lake downstream to L. Michigan.	3
Elk River Bypass from Bypass Dam downstream to L. Michigan.	4
Grass River from Lake Bellaire downstream to Clam Lake.	4
Intermediate River from Intermediate Dam downstream to Lake Bellaire. SC - Closed to Fishing — April 1 – May 14 Bellaire Dam to Highway M-88 Bridge.	4
Jordan River from Graves Crossing (T31N, R6W, S32) downstream to Lake Charlevoix.	4
Manistee River from headwaters downstream to CO. Rd. 612.	2
Torch River from Torch Lake downstream to Lake Skegemog. Hook Restriction: From May 1 – July 1 on Torch River from the Crystal Beach Rd Bridge downstream to Lake Skegemog including Rapid River up to Aarwood Rd Bridge it shall be unlawful to use other than one single-pointed unweighted hook measuring 1/2-inch or less from point to shank.	4



Arenac

Streams	Type
East Branch Au Gres River (Whitney Drain) from M-55 downstream to Saginaw Bay.	3
Rifle River from Sage Lake Road (T23N, R3E, S22) downstream to Saginaw Bay.	3

Baraga

Lakes	Type
Roland Lake	B
Streams	Type
Big Huron River from Big Eric's Bridge (T52N, R30W, S35) downstream to L. Superior (T52N, R29W, S18).	4 BTRA
Falls River from US-41 to L. Superior.	3
Otter River from confluence of N. and W. Br. Otter River downstream to Sturgeon River.	3
Ravine River from Scicotte Road (T51N, R31W, S2) downstream to Huron Bay (T51N, R31W, S4).	4 BTRA
Silver River from Silver River Falls (T51N, R32W, S26) downstream to Huron Bay (T51N, R31W, S18).	4 BTRA
Slate River from Slate River Falls (1/2 mile upstream from Skanee Road T51N, R31W, S9) downstream to Huron Bay (T51N, R31W, S8).	4 BTRA
Sturgeon River from US-41 downstream to Prickett Dam.	2
Sturgeon River from Prickett Dam downstream to L. Superior. SC - Closed to Fishing — April 1 – Jun. 30 from the Prickett Dam downstream to mouth of Clear Creek (T50N, R35W, S12).	3

Barry

Lakes	Type
Deep Lake	B
Gull Lake	E

Streams	Type
Augusta Creek from Little Gilkey Lake and Fair Lakes outlets downstream to Knappen Mills Dam.	4
Bassett Creek from Baker Lake downstream to confluence with Thornapple River.	4
Coldwater River from M-43 Bridge (T4N, R8W, S16) downstream to Freeport Road Bridge.	2
Coldwater River from Freeport Rd. downstream to confluence with Thornapple River.	4
Turner Creek from (T3N, R10W, S23) downstream to confluence with Baker Creek (T3N, R10W, S9).	4

Bay

Streams	Type
Saginaw River	3

Benzie

Lakes	Type
Betsie Lake from M-22 down to L. Michigan.	F
Crystal Lake	E
Streams	Type
Betsie River from Kurick Rd. downstream to M-22. Year-round — the daily possession limit shall not include more than one (1) Rainbow Trout. SC - Closed to Fishing — Betsie River Homestead Dam: Nov. 16 – July 31 within 100 ft. of the lamprey barrier and fish passage facility at T25N, R15W, S2. SC - Closed to Fishing — Betsie River Homestead Dam: Aug. 1 – Nov. 15 within 300 ft. of lamprey barrier and fish passage facility. Special Artificial Lure Regulations: apply Aug. 1 – Nov. 15, see p. 8.	4
Otter Creek from Otter Lake outlet (T27N, R15W, S13) downstream to L. Michigan.	4

Streams	Type
Platte River from US-31 bridge at Veteran's Park downstream to L. Michigan. NOTE: The daily possession limit shall not include more than one (1) Rainbow Trout. Hook Restriction: On the Platte River, Benzie Co., it shall be unlawful to use other than one single-pointed unweighted hook measuring 1/2" or less from point to shank. SC - Closed to Fishing — within 300 ft. of the upper (hatchery) weir infrastructure whenever weir is in place. SC - Closed to Fishing — whenever weir is in place within 300 ft of the lower weir. SC - Closed to Fishing — Jan. 1 – March 31 from US-31 bridge at Veteran's Park downstream to Platte Lake.	4

Berrien

Lakes	Type
Singer Lake	C

Streams	Type
Blue Creek	4
Dowagiac River (including Dowagiac Drain) from source downstream to confluence with St. Joseph River.	4
Galien River Mainstream downstream limit is L. Michigan.	4
South Branch Galien River Mainstream only, downstream limit is the confluence with Galien River.	4
St. Joseph River from Indiana state line downstream to L. Michigan.	3

Branch

Lakes	Type
Cary Lake	C

Streams	Type
Prairie River Mainstream from Bowers Road (T8S, R7W, S4) downstream to McKale Road (T7S, R9W, S8).	4

Calhoun

Streams	Type
South Branch Rice Creek from Concord Rd. downstream to confluence with Kalamazoo River.	4
Nottawa Creek	4

Cass

Lakes	Type
Birch Lake	B
Harwood Lake	C
Hemlock Lake	B

Streams	Type
Curtis Creek and Tributaries	2
Dowagiac Creek from McKenzie Street (T5S, R14W, S31) downstream to M-62.	2
Mill Creek and Tributaries from Preston Road (T7S, R12W, S7) downstream to impoundment at T7S, R12W, S32.	4
Dowagiac River (including Dowagiac Drain) from source downstream to confluence with St. Joseph River.	4

Charlevoix

Lakes	Type
Lake Charlevoix (including Round Lake)	F
Thumb (Louise) Lake	B
Walloon Lake	B

Streams	Type
Bear River from Walloon Lake downstream to northern edge of foot bridge north of Lake Street Hook Restriction: On the Bear River, from the northern edge of foot bridge north of Lake Street upstream to Lake Street Dam (T34N, R5W, S6) it shall be unlawful to use other than one single-pointed unweighted hook measuring 1/2" or less from point to shank.	4

Streams	Type
Boyne River from P. H. (Boyne USA) Dam downstream to Lake Charlevoix. Hook Restriction: On the Boyne River, from the mouth upstream to dam (T32N, R5W, S5) it shall be unlawful to use other than one single-pointed unweighted hook measuring 1/2" or less from point to shank.	4
Jordan River from Graves Crossing (T31N, R6W, S32) downstream to Lake Charlevoix.	4
Medusa Creek SC - Closed to Fishing — whenever weir is in place. Tributary to L. Michigan (T34N, R8W, S28) and including an area of L. Michigan in a radius of 100 ft from the mouth of Medusa Creek.	N/A

Cheboygan

Lakes	Type
Hemlock Lake	D
Silver Lake	B
Tower Pond (from dam to M-68)	E
Weber Lake	B

Streams	Type
Cheboygan River from Cheboygan Dam downstream to L. Huron.	3
Maple River from Woodland Rd. in Emmet Co. downstream to mouth.	4
Mill Creek	4
Pigeon River from Elk Hill Campground Horse Trail to Pine Grove Campground Stairs.	GR p. 46
Pigeon River from Pine Grove Campground Stairs (T33N, R1W, S17) to East Mullet Rd.	4
Sturgeon River from Afton Rd. (Also called Webb Rd. or Wolverine Rd.) downstream to mouth at Burt Lake.	4

Chippewa

Lakes	Type
Dukes Lake	B
Highbanks Lake	B

Lakes	Type
Naomikong Lake	A
Naomikong Pond	A

Streams	Type
Albany Creek from bridge below lamprey weir to L. Huron.	4
Carp River, Mainstream	4
Halfaday Creek from Lakeshore Drive downstream to L. Superior.	4
Pendill's Creek from Second Dam (T47N, R4W, S28) downstream to L. Superior.	4
Pine River from H-40 Bridge downstream to L. Huron.	4

Crawford

Lakes	Type
Bright Lake	B
Kneff Lake	A
Shupac Lake	A

Streams	Type
Au Sable River Mainstream from Business Loop 75 (James St.) downstream to Burton's Landing (T26N, R3W, S11).	2
Au Sable River Mainstream from Burton's Landing downstream to South Wakeley Bridge Rd. (Wakeley Bridge).	GR p. 44
Au Sable River Mainstream from South Wakeley Bridge Rd. (Wakeley Bridge) to McMasters Bridge Rd. (McMasters Bridge).	GR p. 44
Au Sable River Mainstream from McMasters Bridge Rd. (McMasters Bridge) downstream to Rainbow Bend power line (T26N, R2E, S3).	4
Manistee River from headwaters downstream to CO. Rd. 612.	2
Manistee River from CO. Rd. 612 to M-72.	GR p. 45
Manistee River from M-72 downstream to Sunset Trail Rd. (CCC Bridge T26N, R6W, S26).	GR p. 45

Streams	Type
North Branch Au Sable River from Sheep Ranch downstream to confluence with Mainstream.	GR p. 44
South Branch Au Sable River from Chase Bridge Rd. (Chase Bridge) to Lower High Banks.	GR p. 44
South Branch Au Sable River from Lower High Banks downstream to confluence with Mainstream.	GR p. 44

Delta

Lakes	Type
Bear Lake	A
Carr Lake	A
Carr Ponds	A
Kilpecker Pond	A
Norway Lake	A
Wintergreen Lake	A
Zigmaul Pond	A

Streams	Type
Bark River from 9 Road (Section Line Between T38N, R24W, S20 & 29) downstream to L. Michigan.	4
Big Fishdam River from County Road 2222 Bridge (T41N, R18W, S9) downstream to L. Michigan.	4
Days River from Highway M-35 Bridge downstream to L. Michigan.	4
Escanaba River from Boney Falls Dam downstream to mouth of Silver Creek (T40N, R23W, S11).	GR p. 45
Ford River from Northland Truck Trail (T43N, R27W, S35) downstream to L. Michigan.	4
Rapid River from County Road S-15 (T42N, R21W, S19) downstream to L. Michigan.	4
Sturgeon River from County Road 442 Bridge (T42N, R20W, S13) downstream to L. Michigan.	4
Tacoosh River from 29th Lane (County Road G-24) downstream to L. Michigan.	4

Streams	Type
Whitefish River from 38th Road (U.S.F.S. 2236) downstream to US-2 bridge in T41N, R21W, S28. Year-round — the daily possession limit shall not include more than one (1) Rainbow Trout.	4

Dickinson

Streams	Type
Ford River from Northland Truck Trail (T43N, R27W, S35) downstream to L. Michigan.	4

Eaton

Streams	Type
Sebewa Creek and Tributaries	4

Emmet

Lakes	Type
Walloon Lake	B

Streams	Type
Bear River from Walloon Lake downstream to northern edge of foot bridge north of Lake Street. Hook Restriction: On the Bear River, from the northern edge of foot bridge north of Lake Street upstream to Lake Street Dam (T34N, R5W, S6) it shall be unlawful to use other than one single-pointed unweighted hook measuring 1/2" or less from point to shank.	4
Carp Lake River from Bridge in (T39N, R4W, S32) downstream to L. Michigan	3
Maple River from Woodland Rd., Emmet Co. downstream to mouth	4

Gladwin

Streams	Type
North Branch Cedar River from (T20N, R2W, S2) downstream to confluence with Cedar River (T19N, R2W, S20).	4

Gogebic

Lakes	Type
Beatons Lake	B
Castle Lake	A
Cornelia Lake	A
Imp Lake	B
Moon Lake	B
Redboat Lake	C

Streams	Type
Big Carp River from a point 100 yards downstream of Bathtub Falls (T50N, R45W, S1) to L. Superior.	3
Black River from Rainbow Falls (T49N, R46W, S10) downstream to L. Superior.	3
Black River from US-2 downstream to Rainbow Falls.	2
Duck Creek from Railroad Bridge (T44N, R39W, S16) to confluence with Middle Branch Ontonagon River.	GR p. 45
Little Carp River from Traders Falls (T50N, R45W, S2) downstream to L. Superior.	3
Maple Creek from Bridge in (T49N, R46W, S18) downstream to L. Superior.	3
Middle Branch Ontonagon River downstream limit is Agate Falls.	2
Omans Creek from County Road 505 downstream to L. Superior.	3
Presque Isle River from Manabesho Falls to L. Superior.	3

Grand Traverse

Lakes	Type
Duck Lake	B
Elk Lake	E
Green Lake	B
Sand Lake #1	C

Streams	Type
Boardman River from Beitner Rd. downstream to L. Michigan. SC - Closed to Fishing — Whenever weir is in place from the downstream side of the Front Street Bridge to the upstream side of the pedestrian bridge in the vicinity of the Boardman River weir in Traverse City.	4

Hillsdale

Lakes	Type
Bear Lake	C
Bird Lake	C

Houghton

Systems	Type
Portage/Torch Lake system (including the Portage River, Portage Canal, North Entry and South Entry.	BTRA

Lakes	Type
Clear Lake	D
Penegor Lake	A
Perrault Lake	D

Streams	Type
Big Traverse River upstream limit is Gay-Lake Linden Road.	3
East Branch Ontonagon River upstream limit is Hwy. M-28.	3
Elm River from Road Bridge between (T53N, R36W, S3 & 10) downstream to L. Superior.	4
Graveraet River from mouth of Deer Creek (T54N, R36W, S2) downstream to L. Superior.	4
Little Elm River from Agate Beach Road (T53N, R36W, S6) downstream to L. Superior.	4
Otter River from confluence of N. and W. Br. Otter River downstream to Sturgeon River.	3
Pilgrim River from Hwy US-41 downstream to Portage L. (T54N, R33W, S5).	3 BTRA

Streams	Type
Pilgrim River and tributaries from the headwaters downstream to Hwy US-41.	1 BTRA
Salmon Trout River from Redridge Dam downstream to L. Superior.	3
South Branch Elm River from bridge (T54N, R36W, S29 & S32) downstream to L. Superior.	4
Sturgeon River from US-41 downstream to Prickett Dam.	2
Sturgeon River from Prickett Dam downstream to L. Superior. SC - Closed to Fishing — April 1 – June 30 from the Prickett Dam downstream to mouth of Clear Creek (T50N, R35W, S12).	3
Trap Rock River upstream limit is Cemetery Road (T56N, R32W, S29).	4

Huron

Streams	Type
Bird Creek	3
Pigeon River	3
Pinnebog River	3

Ionia

Streams	Type
Fish Creek from Sidney Rd. (T10N, R6W, S20) downstream to confluence with Maple River.	4
Prairie Creek Year-round — the daily possession limit shall not include more than one (1) Rainbow Trout.	4
Sebewa Creek and Tributaries	4

Iosco

Streams	Type
Au Sable River Mainstream from Foote Dam downstream to L. Huron. SC - Closed to Fishing - Year-round, from Foote Dam to the downstream edge of the apron of the dam.	3
Au Sable River Mainstream Alcona Dam to S. Br. River.	4

Streams	Type
East Branch Au Gres River (Whitney Drain) from M-55 downstream to Saginaw Bay SC - Closed to Fishing — Dec. 1 – Friday before last Saturday in April between DNR lamprey weir and Legget Road (T21N, R6E, S10).	3
Pine River from F-41 downstream to Lake Huron.	3
Tawas River	3
Van Etten Creek from Van Etten Lake downstream to mouth.	3

Iron

Lakes	Type
Chicagon Lake	B
Deadman's Lake	A
Ellen Lake	B
Forest Lake	D
Fortune Pond	A
Golden Lake	B
Killdeer Lake	A
Lake on Three	B
Madelyn Lake	A
Lake Ottawa	B
Skyline Lake	A
Spree Lake	A
Timber Lake	D

Streams	Type
Cooks Run from US Forest Hwy 16 to confluence with S. Br. Paint River (T44N, R36W, S28).	GR p. 45
Paint River, South Branch from the Mouth of Cooks Run (T44N, R36W, S28) to the Mouth of the N. Br. of the Paint River (T44N, R35W, S8).	GR p. 46

Isabella

Streams	Type
Chippewa River from Outlet of Lake Isabella, (T15N, R6W, S35) Isabella Co. downstream to confluence with the Tittabawassee River, (T14N, R2E, S21), Midland Co.	3

Jackson

Lakes	Type
Farwell (Farewell) Lake	C
Swains Lake	C
Streams	Type
South Branch Rice Creek from Concord Rd. downstream to confluence with Kalamazoo River.	4

Kalamazoo

Lakes	Type
Gull Lake	E
Little Paw Paw Lake	C
Ruppert Lake	C
Streams	Type
Augusta Creek from Little Gilkey Lake and Fair Lakes outlets downstream to Knappen Mills Dam.	4
Portage Creek downstream limit is Kilgore Rd. (T3S, R11W, S3).	4
Silver Creek from M-89 Bridge (T1N, R11W, S26) downstream to confluence with Kalamazoo River.	2

Kalkaska

Lakes	Type
Bear Lake	B
Big Blue Lake	B
Big Guernsey Lake	C
Big Twin Lake	C
North Blue Lake	B
Starvation Lake	C
Streams	Type
Manistee River from M-72 downstream to Sunset Trail Rd. (CCC Bridge T26N, R6W, S26).	GR p. 45
Manistee River from Sunset Trail Rd. (CCC Bridge T26N, R6W, S26) downstream to M-115.	4

Streams	Type
Rapid River from Antrim (Rugg) Pond downstream to Torch River. Hook Restriction: from May 1 – July 1, on Torch River from the Crystal Beach Rd Bridge downstream to Lake Skegemog including Rapid River up to Aarwood Rd Bridge it shall be unlawful to use other than one single-pointed unweighted hook measuring ½-inch or less from point to shank.	4
Torch River from Torch Lake downstream to Lake Skegemog. Hook Restriction: from May 1 – July 1, on Torch River from the Crystal Beach Rd Bridge downstream to Lake Skegemog including Rapid River up to Aarwood Rd Bridge it shall be unlawful to use other than one single-pointed unweighted hook measuring ½-inch or less from point to shank.	4

Kent

Streams	Type
Ball Creek downstream limit is confluence with Rogue River.	4
Buck Creek downstream limit is confluence with Grand River.	4
Coldwater River from Freeport Rd. downstream to confluence with Thornapple River.	4
Nash Creek downstream limit is confluence with Rogue River.	4
Rogue River downstream limit is confluence with Grand River. Year-round — From Rockford Dam downstream to confluence with Grand River: the daily possession limit for Type 4 still applies with up to five (5) Rainbow Trout allowed in the daily possession limit, no more than three (3) trout 15" or greater and shall not include more than one (1) Rainbow Trout 20 inches or greater.	4

Keweenaw

Lakes	Type
Lost Lake	D

Lakes	Type
No Name Pond (T57N, R31W, S8)	A

Streams	Type
Big Traverse River upstream limit is Gay-Lake Linden Road.	3
Eagle River upstream limit is dam at Eagle River Village.	4
Fanny Hooe River upstream limit is Lake Fanny Hooe.	4
Gratiot River from Bridge (T57N, R32W, S19,20) downstream to L. Superior.	4
Silver Creek upstream limit is Falls (T58N, R32W, S26).	4
Silver River upstream limit is Hwy M-26.	4
Tobacco River upstream limit is mouth of Black Brook Creek.	4

Lake

Streams	Type
Little Manistee River from North Peacock Trail (Spencer's Bridge T19N, R13W, S5) to Johnson's Road (Johnson's Bridge T20N, R14W, S24). SC - Closed to Fishing — Jan. 1 – Mar. 31 from a point 300 feet upstream of the DNR weir to Spencer's Bridge.	GR p. 45
Little Manistee River from Johnson Rd. (Johnson's Bridge) downstream to the boundary with Manistee Lake, which is defined as the power line crossing downstream of Stronach Road Bridge (also referred to as Water Street on some maps). SC - Closed to Fishing — Jan. 1 – Mar. 31 from a point 300 ft. upstream of the DNR weir to Spencer's Bridge. Year-round — from Johnson Rd downstream to 300 feet above the Little Manistee River Weir: the daily possession limit shall not include more than one (1) Rainbow Trout. Special Artificial Lure Regulations: apply Aug. 1 – Nov. 15, see p. 8.	4
Pere Marquette River from M-37 to the downstream edge of the boat ramp/slide at Gleason's Landing.	GR p. 46

Streams	Type
Pere Marquette River from the downstream edge of the boat ramp/slide at Gleason's Landing to the upstream edge of the boat ramp at Rainbow Rapids. Special Artificial Lure Regulations: apply Aug. 1 – Nov. 15, see p. 8.	GR p. 46
Pere Marquette River from the upstream edge of the boat ramp at Rainbow Rapids (T18N, R14W, S27) downstream to Reek Rd. (Indian Bridge). Year-round — the daily possession limit shall not include more than one (1) Rainbow Trout. Special Artificial Lure Regulations: apply Aug. 1 – Nov. 15, see p. 8.	4
Pine River from Elm Flats Public Access Site to confluence with Tippy Dam backwaters.	2

Lapeer

Streams	Type
Belle River	4

Leelanau

Lakes	Type
Big Glen Lake	E
North Lake Leelanau	E

Streams	Type
Crystal River from Fisher Dam downstream to L. Michigan.	3
Leland (Carp) River	3
Shalda Creek from Little Traverse Lake outlet (T29N, R13W, S10) downstream to L. Michigan.	4



Lenawee

Lakes	Type
Allens Lake	C
Deep Lake	C

Livingston

Lakes	Type
Spring Mill Pond, (Island Lake Recreation Area): No fishing March 15 – March 31. Catch-and-release fishing for trout - artificial lures only - April 1 – the Fri. before the last Sat. in April; from the last Sat. in April – March 14, 5 fish limit, 8-inch minimum size limit, no more than 3 fish 15" or larger, artificial and natural baits may be used.	N/A

Luce

Lakes	Type
Bennett Springs Lake	A
Brockies Pond (T46N, R11W, S1)	A
Bullhead Lake	A
Camp 8 Lake	C
Dairy Lake	A
Deer Lake	D
Holland Lake	A
Jack Lake	A
Little Whorl Lake	A
Moon Lake	A
Pratt Lake	A
Pretty Lake	B
Sid Lake	D
Silver Creek Pond	A
Syphon Lake	A
Tank Lake	B
Trout Lake	A
Ward Lake	A
Wolverine Lake	A
Streams	Type
Blind Sucker River upstream limit is Blind Sucker Flooding Dam.	4

Streams	Type
Two-Hearted River from Co. Rd. 407 (High Bridge) downstream to L. Superior.	4

Mackinac

Lakes	Type
Millecoquins Pond	A
Streams	Type
Black River upstream limit is Peters Truck Trail Footbridge.	4
Brevoort River upstream limit is Brevoort Lake.	4
Carp River Mainstream	4
Crow River upstream limit is outfall of Amadon Pond.	4
Milakokia River Inland-Limestone Co. Railroad Bridge (T41N, R13W, S1) downstream to L. Michigan.	4
Millecoquins River from H-40 bridge downstream to L. Michigan.	4
Pine River from H-40 Bridge downstream to L. Huron.	4

Macomb

Streams	Type
Belle River	4
Clinton River from Yates Dam above Dequindre Rd. downstream to Lake St. Clair.	4
North Branch Clinton River from 32 Mile Rd. downstream to confluence with Clinton River.	4

Manistee

Lakes	Type
Arcadia Lake from M-22 to L. Michigan.	F
Manistee Lake from Railroad Bridge below M-55 (T21N, R16W, S6) to L. Michigan.	F
Portage Lake	F

Streams	Type
Bear Creek from County Road 600 (T23N, 14W, S6) downstream to confluence with Manistee River. Year-round — the daily possession limit shall not include more than one (1) Rainbow Trout. Special Artificial Lure Regulations: apply Aug. 1 – Nov. 15, see p. 8.	3
Betsie River from Kurick Rd. downstream to M-22. Year-round — the daily possession limit shall not include more than one (1) Rainbow Trout. Special Artificial Lure Regulations: apply Aug. 1 – Nov. 15, see p. 8.	4
Bowens Creek from St. Pierre Road downstream to M-22.	4
Little Manistee River from Johnson Rd. (Johnson's Bridge) downstream to the boundary with Manistee Lake, which is defined as the power line crossing downstream of Stronach Road Bridge (also referred to as Water Street on some maps). SC - Closed to Fishing — Sep. 1 – Nov. 14 and Jan. 1 – March 31 from a point 300 feet downstream from the DNR weir in T21N, R16W, S25 down to the boundary with Manistee Lake, which is defined as the power line crossing downstream of Stronach Road Bridge (also referred to as Water Street on some maps). SC - Closed to Fishing — Year-round within 300 feet of the DNR weir, T21N, R16W, S25. SC - Closed to Fishing — Jan. 1 – March 31 from a point 300 feet upstream of the DNR weir to Spencer's Bridge. Year-round — from Johnson Rd downstream to 300 feet above the Little Manistee River Weir the daily possession limit shall not include more than one (1) Rainbow Trout. NOTE: The daily possession limit shall not include more than one (1) Rainbow Trout from 300' downstream of Little Manistee River Weir down to the boundary with Manistee Lake, which is defined as the power line crossing downstream of Stronach Road Bridge (also referred to as Water Street on some maps). Special Artificial Lure Regulations: apply Aug. 1 – Nov. 15, see p. 8.	4

Streams	Type
Manistee River from Hodenpyl Reservoir downstream to Red Bridge.	4
Manistee River from Tippy Dam downstream to Railroad Bridge below M-55 (T21N, R16W, S6). Year-round — the daily possession limit shall not include more than one (1) Rainbow Trout. Special Artificial Lure Regulations: apply Aug. 1 – Nov. 15, see p. 8.	3
Pine River from Elm Flats Public Access Site to confluence with Tippy Dam backwaters.	2

Marquette

Lakes	Type
Bass Lake	B
Big Trout Lake	E
Brocky Lake	B
Cranberry Lake	A
Forestville Basin	B
Island Lake (T45N, R30W, S14)	A
Just Lake	A
Lake Arfelin	E
Little Brocky Lake	B
Little Shag Lake	B
Moccasin Lake	A
Perch Lake	B
Rockingchair Lake, North	D
Rockingchair Lake, South	D
Silver Lake Basin	B
Slough Lake	A
South Kidney Lake (T45N, R26W, S28)	A
Sporley Lake	E
Strawberry Lake	A
Swanzy Lake	A
Twin Lake (T45N, R30W, S23)	B

Streams	Type
Big Garlic River Mainstream from Forks (T49N, R27W, S12) downstream to County Road 550 (T50N, R26W, S33)	4

Streams	Type
Big Garlic River tributaries from County Road 550 (T50N, R26W, S33) downstream to L. Superior (T50N, R26W, S21).	1 BTRA
Big Huron River from Big Eric's Bridge (T52N, R30W, S35) downstream to L. Superior (T52N, R29W, S18).	4 BTRA
Carp River from Deer Lake Dam (T48N, R27W, S27) downstream to Morgan Creek.	2
Carp River from Morgan Creek downstream to L. Superior. Year-round — the daily possession limit shall not include more than one (1) Rainbow Trout.	3
Chocoday River from confluence of Big Creek (T47N, R24W, S9) downstream to L. Superior.	3
Ford River from Northland Truck Trail (T43N, R27W, S35) downstream to L. Michigan.	4
Harlow Creek from Railroad Bridge (T49N, R26W, S24) downstream to L. Superior.	4
Iron River from Lake Independence Dam (T51N, R27W, S13) downstream to L. Superior (T51N, R26W, S18).	4 BTRA
Little Huron River from unnamed bridge crossing located at the southern border of section 20 (T52N, R29W, S20) downstream to L. Superior (T52N, R29W, S17).	1 BTRA
Salmon-Trout River from Lower Falls (T51N, R28W, S13) down to L. Superior. No fishing — Aug. 15 – the Friday before the last Saturday in April.	1 BTRA

Mason

Lakes	Type
Pere Marquette Lake from Old 31 Highway to L. Michigan.	F

Streams	Type
Big Sable River from Bridge Crossing (T19N, R15W, S3) downstream to Hamlin Lake.	4

Streams	Type
Big Sable River from Hamlin Lake Dam downstream to L. Michigan. Special Artificial Lure Regulations: apply Aug. 1 – Nov. 15, see p. 8.	3
Big South Branch Pere Marquette River from confluence of Beaver/Winnepesaug creeks downstream to confluence with Pere Marquette River. Year-round — the daily possession limit shall not include more than one (1) Rainbow Trout. Special Artificial Lure Regulations: apply Aug. 1 – Nov. 15, see p. 8.	4
Lincoln River from confluence of N. and S. Br. of Lincoln River, (T19N, R17W, S32) downstream to L. Michigan.	3
Little Manistee River from Johnson Rd. (Johnson's Bridge) downstream to the boundary with Manistee Lake, which is defined as the power line crossing downstream of Stronach Road Bridge (also referred to as Water Street on some maps). SC - Closed to Fishing — Jan. 1 – March 31 from a point 300 feet upstream of the DNR weir to Spencer's Bridge. Year-round — from Johnson Rd. downstream to 300 feet above the Little Manistee River Weir the daily possession limit shall not include more than one (1) Rainbow Trout. Special Artificial Lure Regulations: apply Aug. 1 – Nov. 15, see p. 8.	4
Pentwater River and all tributaries Special Artificial Lure Regulations: apply Aug. 1 – Nov. 15, see p. 8.	N/A
Pere Marquette River from the upstream edge of the boat ramp at Rainbow Rapids (T18N, R14W, S27) downstream to Reek Rd. (Indian Bridge). Year-round — the daily possession limit shall not include more than one (1) Rainbow Trout. Special Artificial Lure Regulations: apply Aug. 1 – Nov. 15, see p. 8.	4
Pere Marquette River from Reek Rd. (Indian Bridge) downstream to Old US-31. Year-round — the daily possession limit shall not include more than one (1) Rainbow Trout. Special Artificial Lure Regulations: apply Aug. 1 – Nov. 15, see p. 8.	3

Mecosta

Streams	Type
Little Muskegon River	4
Muskegon River from US-10 downstream to River Bend Bluffs Public Access Site (T15N, R9W, S31).	4
Tamarack Creek	4

Menominee

Streams	Type
Big Cedar River from Veterans Memorial Park Dam (T38N, R26W, S9) downstream to L. Michigan.	4
Ford River from Northland Truck Trail (T43N, R27W, S35) downstream to L. Michigan.	4
Walton Creek (River) from Westmann Dam (T35N, R25W, S18) down to L. Michigan.	4

Midland

Streams	Type
Chippewa River from outlet of Lake Isabella, (T15N, R6W, S35) Isabella Co. downstream to confluence with the Tittabawassee River, (T14N, R2E, S21), Midland Co.	3
Tittabawassee River from Sanford Dam site downstream to confluence with the Saginaw River. SC - Closed to Fishing — March 16 – Fri. before last Sat. in April between Sanford Dam and the mouth of the Salt River (T15N, R1W, S24). SC - Closed to Fishing — March 16 – Fri. before last Sat. in April between the Dow Dam and Gordonville Bridge (T13N, R2E, S1).	3

Missaukee

Streams	Type
Manistee River from Sunset Trail Rd. (CCC Bridge T26N, RW, S26) downstream to M-115.	4

Monroe

Streams	Type
Huron River from Belleville Lake Dam in Wayne Co. downstream to L. Erie	4

Montcalm

Lakes	Type
Marl Lake	C
Nevins Lake	C

Streams	Type
Fish Creek from Sidney Rd. (T10N, R6W, S20) downstream to confluence with Maple River.	4
Little Muskegon River	4
Prairie Creek Year-round — the daily possession limit shall not include more than one (1) Rainbow Trout.	4
Tamarack Creek	4

Montmorency

Lakes	Type
Avalon Lake	B
Clear Lake	B
McCormick Lake	B

Streams	Type
Black River from Tin Shanty Bridge Rd. downstream to the Town Corner Lake Stairs (T32N, R1E, S31).	GR p. 44
Hunt Creek (T29N, R3E) East Fish, West Fish and Middle Fish lakes, and 2.4 miles of Hunt Creek from the Section Z bulkhead south to the Montmorency-Oscoda Co. line, and all of Fuller Creek, all in Sections 25–27 and 34–36 is closed to fishing.	N/A
Thunder Bay R. from Atlanta dam to Sucker Cr. confluence upstream of Hillman Pond.	4

Muskegon

Lakes	Type
Duck Lake from Nestrom Rd. to L. Michigan.	F
Mona Lake from US-31 to L. Michigan.	F
Muskegon Lake from M-120 to L. Michigan.	F

Lakes	Type
White Lake from Business Route US-31 (in Whitehall) to L. Michigan.	F

Streams	Type
Cedar Creek from River Rd. (T11N, R15W, S33) downstream to confluence with Muskegon River.	3

Crockery Creek Mainstream from Moore Rd. (T10N, R13W, S4) in Muskegon Co. downstream to confluence with Grand River (Ottawa Co.).	4
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Muskegon River from Croton Dam downstream to M-120. Year-round — the daily possession limit for Type 3 still applies with up to five (5) Rainbow Trout allowed in the daily possession limit, no more than three (3) trout 15" or greater and shall not include more than one (1) Rainbow Trout 20 inches or greater. Special Artificial Lure Regulations: apply Aug. 1 – Nov. 15, see p. 8.	3
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North Branch Crockery Creek mainstream from Kenowa Ave. (T10N, R13W, S36) downstream to confluence with Crockery Creek mainstream at Ravenna.	4
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White River from Hesperia Dam downstream to White Lake (Business Route US-31 in Whitehall) Special Artificial Lure Regulations: apply Aug. 1 – Nov. 15, see p. 8.	4
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Newaygo

Lakes	Type
Condon Lake	C

Streams	Type
Big South Branch Pere Marquette River from confluence of Beaver/Winnepesaug creeks downstream to confluence with Pere Marquette River.	4

Year-round — the daily possession limit shall not include more than one (1) Rainbow Trout. Special Artificial Lure Regulations: apply Aug. 1 – Nov. 15, see p. 8.	
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Little Muskegon River	4
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Streams	Type
Muskegon River from Croton Dam downstream to M-120. Year-round — the daily possession limit for Type 3 still applies with up to five (5) Rainbow Trout allowed in the daily possession limit, no more than three (3) trout 15" or greater and shall not include more than one (1) Rainbow Trout 20 inches or greater. Special Artificial Lure Regulations: apply Aug. 1 – Nov. 15, see p. 8.	3
Rogue River downstream limit is confluence with Grand River.	4
Tamarack Creek	4

Oakland

Lakes	Type
Maceday Lake	C

Streams	Type
Huron River from 50 yards below Proud Lake Dam (T2N, R8E, S18) to 100 yards below Wixom Rd. (T2N, R7E, S13).	GR p. 45

Paint Creek from Gunn Rd. to Tienken Rd.	GR p. 46
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Oceana

Lakes	Type
Pentwater Lake from Long Bridge Rd (B15) to L. Michigan.	F
Silver Lake downstream limit is L. Michigan.	F
Stony Lake from inlet of Stony Creek to L. Michigan.	F

Streams	Type
Big South Branch Pere Marquette River from confluence of Beaver/Winnepesaug creeks downstream to confluence with Pere Marquette River.	4

Year-round — the daily possession limit shall not include more than one (1) Rainbow Trout. Special Artificial Lure Regulations: apply Aug. 1 – Nov. 15, see p. 8.	
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Streams	Type
North Branch Pentwater River from Oceana Dr. downstream to confluence with mainstream of Pentwater River. Special Artificial Lure Regulations: apply Aug. 1 – Nov. 15, see p. 8.	4
North Branch White River from Arthur Rd. downstream to confluence with White River. Year-round — the daily possession limit shall not include more than one (1) Rainbow Trout. Special Artificial Lure Regulations: apply Aug. 1 – Nov. 15, see p. 8.	4
Pentwater River from Hart Dam downstream to confluence with Pentwater Lake (Long Bridge Rd. or B15). Special Artificial Lure Regulations: apply Aug. 1 – Nov. 15, see p. 8.	4
White River from Hesperia Dam downstream to White Lake (Business Route US-31 in Whitehall) Special Artificial Lure Regulations: apply Aug. 1 – Nov. 15, see p. 8.	4

Ogemaw

Lakes	Type
Lake George	B

Streams	Type
Rifle River from Sage Lake Road (T23N, R3E, S22) downstream to Saginaw Bay.	3

Ontonagon

Lakes	Type
Courtney Lake	B
Mirror Lake	C
Trout Creek Pond	C

Streams	Type
Big Iron River from Koshak Rd. Bridge (T49N, R43W, S2) downstream to L. Superior.	3
East Branch Ontonagon River upstream limit is Hwy. M-28.	3
East Sleeping River from railroad trestle (T53N, R38W, S25) downstream to L. Superior.	3

Streams	Type
Firesteel River (including East & West Branch) upstream limit is Hwy. M-26.	3
Little Iron River upstream limit is Nonesuch Falls (T50N, R43N, S1).	3
Middle Branch Ontonagon River downstream limit is Agate Falls.	2
Middle Branch Ontonagon River Agate Falls is upstream limit.	3
Misery River upstream limit is bridge in T53N, R37W, S15.	3
Ontonagon River	3
Union River from South Boundary Rd. (T51N, R42W, S22) downstream to L. Superior.	4
West Branch Big Iron River from Burnt Dam Bridge (T50N, R44W, S36) downstream to confluence with Big Iron River.	3
West Branch Ontonagon River upstream limit is confluence with Victoria Hydro Station tail race (T50N, R39W, S29). SC - Closed to Fishing — April 1 – June 10 from its confluence with the Victoria Hydro Station tail race in the SE1/4 of the SW1/4 of T50N, R39W, S29 upstream to Victoria Dam.	3

Osceola

Lakes	Type
Center Lake	C

Streams	Type
Muskegon River from US-10 downstream to River Bend Bluffs Public Access Site (T15N, R9W, S31).	4



Oscoda

Lakes	Type
Crater Lake	A
Loon Lake	B

Lakes	Type
Au Sable River Mainstream from McMasters Bridge Rd. (McMasters Bridge) downstream to Rainbow Bend power line (T26N, R2E, S3).	4
Au Sable River Mainstream from Mio Dam down to the Mio power line at (T26N, R3E, S7).	4
Au Sable River Mainstream from Mio power line (T26N, R3E, S7) downstream to Evans Rd. (McKinley Bridge).	GR p. 44
Au Sable River Mainstream from Evans Rd. (McKinley Bridge) downstream to 4001 Bridge.	2

Otsego

Lakes	Type
Big Chub Lake	B
Bridge Lake	B
Ford Lake	D
Heart Lake	B
Lost Lake	D
North Twin Lake	D
Pickeral Lake	B
Section Four Lake	D
South Twin Lake	D
West Lost Lake	D

Streams	Type
Black River from Tin Shanty Bridge Rd. downstream to the Town Corner Lake Stairs (T32N, R1E, S31).	GR p. 44
Manistee River from headwaters downstream to Co. Rd. 612.	2
Pigeon River from Old Vanderbilt Rd. downstream to Elk Hill Campground Horse Trail (T32N, R1W, S10).	2
Pigeon River from Elk Hill Campground Horse Trail to Pine Grove Campground stairs.	GR p. 46

Ottawa

Lakes	Type
Lake Macatawa from River Ave. to L. Michigan.	F
Pigeon Lake from Lakeshore Drive to L. Michigan.	F

Streams	Type
Crockery Creek Mainstream from Moore Rd. (T10N, R13W, S4) in Muskegon Co. downstream to confluence with Grand River (Ottawa Co.).	4
North Branch Crockery Creek Mainstream from Kenowa Ave. (T10N, R13W, S36) downstream to confluence with Crockery Creek mainstream at Ravenna.	4
Sand Creek	4

Presque Isle

Lakes	Type
Bear Den Lake (T33N, R2E, S32)	B

Streams	Type
Ocqueoc River from Barnhart L. down to L. Huron.	4
Swan River from US-23 Bridge downstream to L. Huron. SC - Closed to Fishing — Whenever weir is in place - from 300 feet above weir to mouth (T35N, R6E, S20 & S29).	3
Trout River from dam (T35N, R5E, S17) downstream to L. Huron.	3

Roscommon

Lakes	Type
Higgins Lake	E

Saginaw

Streams	Type
Saginaw River	3
Tittabawassee River from Sanford Dam site downstream to confluence with the Saginaw River.	3

Schoolcraft

Lakes	Type
Banana Lake	B
Bear (Nineteen) Lake	B
Kings Pond	A
Lost Lake	A
Ned's Lake	D
Spring Pond	A
Twilight Lake	D

Streams	Type
Fox River from Fox River State Forest Campground (T46N, R14W, S11) to M-28.	GR p. 45
Manistique River from Papermill Dam downstream to L. Michigan.	4
Milakokia River Inland-Limestone Co. Railroad Bridge (T41N, R13W, S1) downstream to L. Michigan.	4

St. Clair

Streams	Type
Belle River	4
Black River from private dam in Port Huron State Game Area downstream to confluence with St. Clair R.	3
Mill Creek downstream limit is confluence with Black R.	4

St. Joseph

Streams	Type
Curtis Creek and tributaries	2
Mill Creek and tributaries from Preston Road (T7S, R12W, S7) downstream to impoundment at T7S, R12W, S32.	4
Prairie River Mainstream from Bowers Road (T8S, R7W, S4) downstream to McKale Road (T7S, R9W, S8).	4
Unnamed Tributary (T6S, R10W, S26).	4

Van Buren

Lakes	Type
Shafer Lake	C

Streams	Type
Black River Mainstream from confluence of N. and S. Br. down to L. Michigan.	3
Brush Creek (except Reynolds Lake Drain) from 63rd Ave. downstream to confluence with Paw Paw River.	4
Dowagiac River (including Dowagiac Drain) from source downstream to confluence with St. Joseph River.	4
Pine Creek downstream limit is 101st Ave. (T1N, R12W, S32).	4
South Branch of the Black River from Hamilton Street Bridge (T2S, R16W, S1) downstream to confluence with mainstream (T1S, R17W, S2). Type 1 from Hamilton St. Bridge up to Bangor City Dam. Hook Restriction: South Branch Black River and all Tributaries upstream of Breedsville (Mill Str.) — it shall be unlawful to use other than one single-pointed unweighted hook measuring 1/2" or less from point to shank.	3
South Branch Paw Paw River (a.k.a. Gates Drain or West Branch) and tributaries downstream to the railroad bridge downstream of I-94 (T3S, R14W, S14).	4

Wayne

Streams	Type
Huron River from Belleville Lake Dam in Wayne Co. downstream to L. Erie.	4

Wexford

Streams	Type
Manistee River from Sunset Trail Rd. (CCC Bridge T26N, R6W, S26) downstream to M-115.	4
Pine River from Elm Flats Public Access Site to confluence with Tippy Dam backwaters.	2



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Michigan.gov/OutdoorSkills

Other sources of fishing and fisheries information

- Great Lakes Fishery Commission: GLFC.org
- Great Lakes Fishery Trust: GLFT.org
- Fly Fishers International: FlyFishersInternational.org
- Michigan Charter Boat Association: MichiganCharterBoats.com
- Michigan Council of Trout Unlimited: MichiganTU.org
- Michigan Steelhead and Salmon Fishermen's Association: MichiganSteelheaders.org
- Michigan Sea Grant: MichiganSeaGrant.org
- Michigan United Conservation Clubs: MUCC.org
- Recreational Boat and Fishing Foundation: TakeMeFishing.org
- Chippewa Ottawa Resource Authority: 1836CORA.org
- Great Lakes Indian Fish & Wildlife Commission: GLIFWC.org
- Michigan Department of Health & Human Services' Eat Safe Fish Information: Michigan.gov/EatSafeFish

Looking for a new location to fish?



Visit Michigan.gov/Fishing to search Trout Trails, Family Friendly Fishing Waters, Roadmaps to Fishing Michigan's Great Lakes and fishing locations by region.

Visit Michigan.gov/DNRRegs to view the digital version of this booklet for the most up to date rules and regulations.

Download and use the guide on the go.

Keep fishing regulations with you as you go on the water. Visit Michigan.gov/DNRRegs to conveniently access the fishing guide on your smartphone or mobile device and take them with you wherever you go.

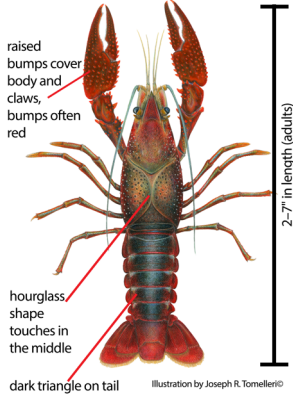
Aquatic Invasive Plants and Animals

Michigan’s waters are threatened by aquatic invasive plants and animals. Species such as the Zebra Mussel, Round Goby, Sea Lamprey, Eurasian Ruffe, European Frog-bit, Eurasian Watermilfoil, and Rusty Crayfish are causing significant damage to our waters, and others are knocking at the door. The DNR works alongside the Department of Environment, Great Lakes, and Energy (EGLE) and the Department of Agriculture and Rural Development (MDARD) to prevent, detect, and control invasive species when possible. Learn more at Michigan.gov/Invasives.

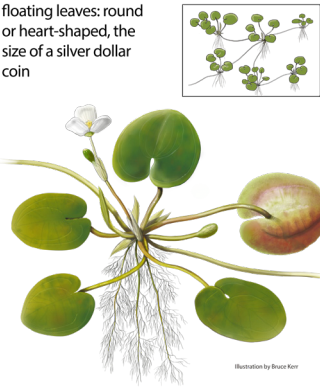
You can help reduce the spread of invasive species by properly disposing of bait in the trash, cleaning gear before leaving a waterbody, and reporting any potential invasive species at Michigan.gov/Invasives/id-report.

The following illustrations show a few of the most serious aquatic invasive species threatening Michigan. **The status of these species in Michigan waters is indicated as confirmed present (CP) or not confirmed (NC).**

Red Swamp Crayfish (CP)



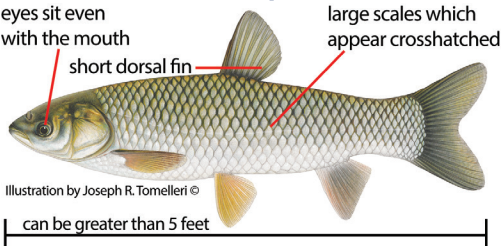
European Frog-Bit (CP)



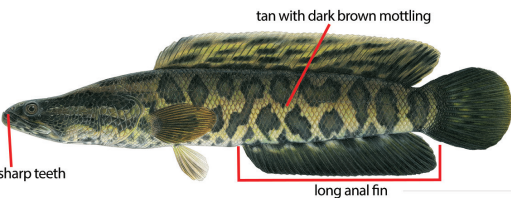
New Zealand Mudsnail (CP)



Grass Carp (CP)

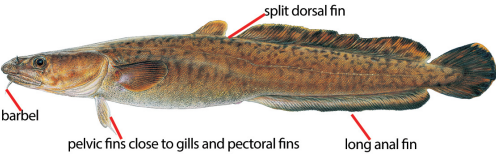


Snakehead (NC)



DON'T BE FOOLED by these native lookalikes

Burbot (Native)



Bowfin (Native)



Illustrations by Joseph R. Tomelleri ©

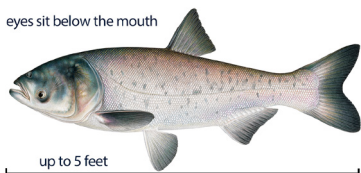
Invasive Carp Identification

Adult Bighead and Silver Carp are large fish that can be easily identified by the position of their eyes. Both species have eyes that are below a line from the fork of the tail to the mouth. Juvenile invasive carp can be easily confused with minnows and you may find one in your bait bucket. Please dispose of any unused bait in the trash to minimize spread of invasive species!

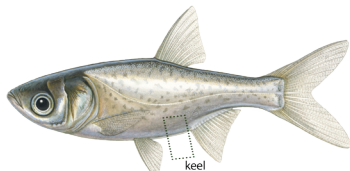
If you believe you have seen or caught an invasive carp, **DO NOT RELEASE IT**. Please **TAKE A PHOTO** and visit Michigan.gov/EyesInTheField to fill out an online invasive carp reporting form, or call the DNR at 517-284-5830.

Adult Bighead Carp (NC)

eyes sit below the mouth



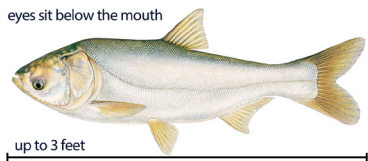
Juvenile Bighead Carp (NC)



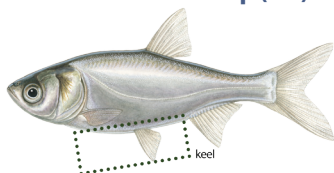
a noticeable keel (ridge on the underbelly) with no scales that extends from the pelvic fin to the anal fin
eyes are positioned below the line extending from the tail to snout

Adult Silver Carp (NC)

eyes sit below the mouth



Juvenile Silver Carp (NC)



a noticeable keel (ridge on the underbelly) with no scales that extends from the gills to the anal fin
eyes are positioned below the line extending from tail to snout

Adult Invasive Carp illustrations by Joseph R. Tomelleri ©

Juvenile Invasive Carp illustrations by Emily Damstra ©

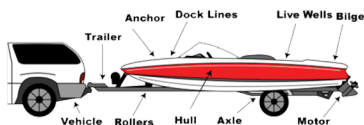
Help stop the spread — it's the law!

• Before transporting any watercraft over land, boaters are required to:

- **REMOVE** all drain plugs from bilges, ballast tanks and live wells and release the water
- **ENSURE** the watercraft, trailer and equipment are free of aquatic organisms, including plants.

• **DO NOT** release unused bait into the water.

• **DO NOT** move fish or fish parts from one body of water to another.



Being in compliance with the law is easy! Just remember to Clean, Drain, Dry, Dispose:

- **CLEAN** your boat, trailer and equipment.
- **CLEAN** waders thoroughly.
- **DRAIN** live wells, bilges and all water by pulling drain plugs.
- **DRY** boats and equipment for five days before moving to a new waterbody.
- **DISPOSE** of unwanted bait in the trash.
- **PURCHASE** live bait from a retailer or collect it from the same waterbody where you will be fishing.

Report anything unusual you see, including unidentified fish, making note of the day, time and location of the discovery and taking a photo, if possible. Submit reports at

Michigan.gov/Invasives.

Fishing Tournament Information

The following shall be registered online using the DNR's Michigan Fishing Tournament Information System:

1. All bass fishing tournaments
2. All Walleye fishing tournaments
3. All competitive fishing events targeting Muskellunge.

Tournaments and Muskellunge competitive fishing events must register online at: www.mcgi.state.mi.us/fishingtournaments. Tournament directors shall verify all tournament participants and provide a unique registration receipt to all participating anglers. Tournament directors shall report tournament results to the DNR by December 31, annually.

A fishing tournament is considered one that meets all of the following criteria: (a) the determination of a winner is based on the cumulative weight or length of the targeted fish species caught by an angler or team of anglers; (b) occurs during a defined period, which can be on one or multiple days but does not exceed five days; (c) is anchored to a single boating access site or designated nearby location where fish caught by participating anglers or teams are to be weighed-in, entered or the group is otherwise operating their event from; and (d) is limited to a single waterbody or connected waterbodies [ex: Lake St. Clair, Detroit River and Lake Erie] that are accessed by a common access site.

A fishing tournament is not where "winning" or prize distribution is determined solely on one or more of the following criteria: (a) who caught the largest fish or some combination of big fish awards; (b) who caught the smallest fish; (c) who caught the first fish; (d) who caught the most fish species; and/or (e) any other format that does not involve an angler or team of anglers entering a cumulative weight or length of the target species.

A competitive fishing event is considered to be any other organized competition among anglers involving prize distribution or the declaration of a winner that is not defined as a fishing tournament.

For more information, consult Fisheries Order 250 at Michigan.gov/FishingTournaments.

The Fishing Tournament Information System can be used by the public to determine where and when fishing tournaments are scheduled.

Boat Registration

For information about boat registration, please see "The Handbook of Michigan Boating Laws & Responsibilities" available online at Michigan.gov/Boating. Boat registrations are handled through the Secretary of State.

Charter Boat Captains and Inland Sport Fishing Guides

Inland sport fishing guides are required to acquire a license that is valid for 3 years. Additionally, licensed inland sport fishing guides are required to submit monthly catch activity reports to the Michigan Department of Natural Resources. For more information visit Michigan.gov/Fishing.

Lead Alternatives

The DNR would like to remind anglers that lead can cause mortality when ingested by mammals and birds. There are nontoxic alternatives to lead such as tin, bismuth, steel and tungsten-nickel alloy for use in jigs, sinkers and other gear. These materials can be found at established sporting goods retailers and online.

Ice Shanties

A person placing a shanty on the ice for fishing shall permanently affix their name and address OR drivers license number OR DNR sportcard number on ALL SIDES of the shanty in legible alphanumeric letters that are at least 2" in height. The letters shall be readily visible and consist of material not soluble in water. The information identifying the owner must be on the shanty and may not be placed on a board or other material that is then attached to the shanty. Tents or other temporary shelters must be removed from the ice at the conclusion of each day's fishing activity and do not require identification.

Persons placing a shanty on the waters of the Upper Peninsula shall remove the shanty by midnight of March 31 each year. Persons placing a shanty on Michigan-Wisconsin boundary waters shall remove the shanty by midnight of March 15 each year (see pp. 24-25).

Persons placing a shanty on waters in the counties of **Alcona, Alpena, Antrim, Arenac, Bay, Benzie, Charlevoix, Cheboygan, Clare, Crawford, Emmet, Gladwin, Grand Traverse, Iosco, Isabella, Kalkaska, Lake, Leelanau, Manistee, Mason, Mecosta, Midland, Missaukee, Montmorency, Newaygo, Oceana, Ogemaw, Osceola, Oscoda, Otsego, Presque Isle, Roscommon or Wexford** shall remove the shanty by midnight of March 15 each year. Persons placing a shanty upon the waters of the remaining portion of the Lower Peninsula shall remove the shanty by midnight on March 1 each year. Shanties placed on L. St. Clair shall be removed before sunset on the first Sunday after Feb. 20 each year. In all areas, a shanty must be removed if ice conditions become unsafe, regardless of the date. After the above dates, a shanty must be removed at the end of each day's fishing activity.

Parasites and Diseases of Fish

Occasionally anglers catch fish with black, pinhead-size spots which cause the fish to have a peppered appearance, or a fish may be caught which has white-to-yellow-colored grubs under the skin or in the flesh. Yellow Perch taken from the shallower waters of the Great Lakes often contain red worms coiled within the body cavity. These conditions are caused by common fish parasites. Fish with these parasites are safe to eat because the parasites are killed by cooking. Black spot and yellow grub parasites are most common in bass, sunfish (all species) and Northern Pike. These parasites may be found in other species of fish as well. Red worm is specific to Yellow Perch.

It is not unusual for anglers to catch Walleye with pink, whitish or yellowish wart-like growths on their bodies and fins. These markings are caused by fish viruses, the most common of which is called lymphocystis. This is primarily a skin disease, and the flesh is usually not affected. Lymphocystis is harmless to humans and affected fish are safe to eat. Skinning the fish usually removes all diseased tissue. If a legal-size fish is heavily affected and appears aesthetically unpleasing, it should be kept for disposal because a fish that is released will only spread more virus. Please note, if you keep a fish for disposal it is still part of your daily possession limit.

Northern Pike from some waters occasionally are caught with various size and colors of external tumors which may be whitish, creamy, pink or red. In advanced stages, the tumors are ugly open sores tinged with red and often are referred to as red sores. These tumors are caused by a naturally occurring virus which is specific to Northern Pike and Muskellunge. The disease is not known to be infectious to other animals or humans; however, affected fish are not aesthetically pleasing and should not be eaten. Affected fish (of legal size) should be kept for disposal because a fish that is released may spread the infection to other fish. Please note, if you keep a fish for disposal it is still part of your daily possession limit. Anglers are encouraged to

report unusual looking fish or fish with lesions or pathogens using the sick or dead aquatic species form at [Michigan.gov/EyesinTheField](https://michigan.gov/EyesinTheField).

Seasonal Fish Mortalities

Throughout the year, it is not uncommon to witness dead or dying fish in ponds and lakes across the state. Many incidents stem from natural causes such as winter kill, brought about by a depletion of oxygen supplies coincident with heavy snow and ice cover; stress (brought about by low oxygen levels); periods of unusually rapid temperature increase or natural stresses associated with spawning. The deaths may be viewed as nature's way of reducing the fish population and selecting those fish which are most fit for survival. If you suspect a fish kill is caused by non-natural causes, please fill out the sick or dead aquatic species form at [Michigan.gov/EyesinTheField](https://michigan.gov/EyesinTheField).



Free Fishing Weekend

Two weekends a year, residents and visitors can enjoy Michigan's abundant fishing opportunities for free!

A fishing license is not required on free fishing weekends, and anglers may enjoy fishing on inland and great lakes waters for all legally allowable species of fish. All fishing regulations still apply.

Learn more and find future Free Fishing Weekend dates at [Michigan.gov/FreeFishing](https://michigan.gov/FreeFishing) or scan the QR code.



Thank you for purchasing a Michigan Fishing License

Each year, 1.2 million Michigan residents and nonresidents fish Michigan waters. Recreational fishing is the largest and highest-valued use of the state's fishery resources. The economic impact of sport fishing in Michigan is \$3.9 billion annually and provides nearly 34,500 jobs. The mission of the DNR Fisheries Division is to protect and enhance Michigan's aquatic life and habitats for the benefit of current and future generations. Revenue from fishing and hunting license sales supports DNR activities to enhance Michigan's natural resources. The license sales also increase federal revenue to the State of Michigan for the management of these resources. Please help to support Michigan's abundant natural resources by purchasing a fishing and hunting license each year. Learn more at Michigan.gov/DNR/About/Funding.

Fisheries Division Appropriation Budget Fiscal Year 2025–2026 (\$35,994,700)

Funding Sources

Game and Fish Protection Fund:
\$21,276,600 (60%)

These funds are mainly derived from fishing and hunting license revenues and all monies are earmarked for fishing- and hunting-related operations.

Federal Funds: \$12,315,800 (34%)

Our primary federal funding source is the Sport Fish Restoration fund program, which comes from a federal excise tax on fishing equipment and a portion of the federal fuel tax revenue attributed to motorboats. Michigan received \$12.8 million in fiscal year 2025 (eighth highest in the nation) based on a distribution formula of land/water area and number of state fishing license holders. Of this amount, \$10.9 million was used for Fisheries Division programs. The remaining \$1.9 million was used by Parks and Recreation Division for projects in support of boating access.

Other Funds: \$2,102,300 (6%)

State general fund/general purpose, litigation settlement and private funds.

Appropriations by Program (Total: \$35,994,700)

Fisheries Resources Management: \$24,084,200 (67%)

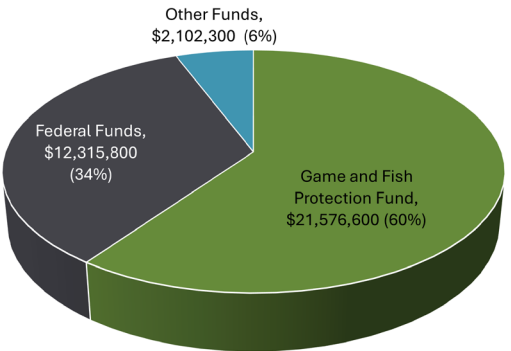
Expenditures are for the protection and maintenance of healthy Great Lakes and inland waters and fish communities.

Fish Production Program: \$11,173,300 (31%)

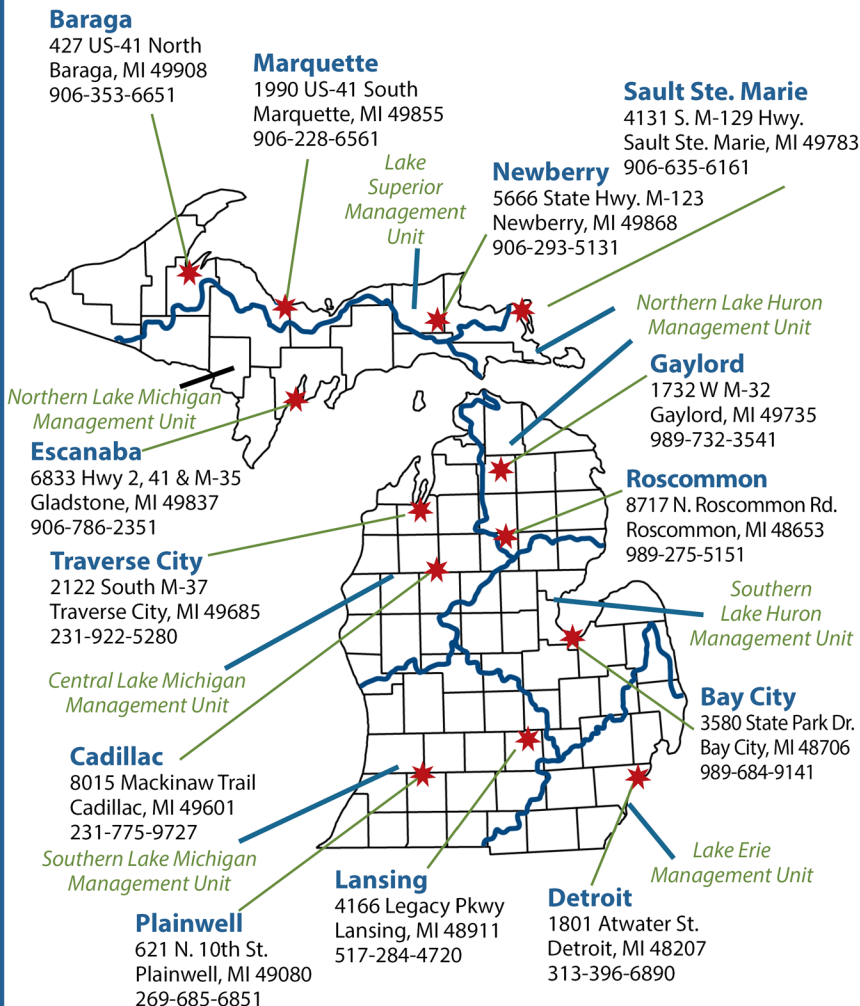
Expenditures are for the hatching, rearing and transportation of fish required for management of both the Great Lakes and inland fisheries.

Aquatic Resource Mitigation Program: \$737,200 (2%)

Expenditures are for the mitigation of damages related to the settlement of permit violations in Michigan waters. Funds are used for fish habitat rehabilitation, for the protection of intact habitat as compensation for damages, and to improve fishing access.



DNR Customer Service Centers



Fisheries Division's organizational structure is based on Great Lakes Basins, using watersheds as the fundamental ecological management unit. Check Michigan.gov/Fishing for possible changes.

RAP (Report All Poaching — Call or Text): 800-292-7800

**We can't help you with the
big one that got away,**



**but we can help you never lose
your license again.**



Download the Michigan DNR Hunt Fish app
to buy, store and automatically renew your
licenses, access regulations and more.